Long Time No See

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/68565851.

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Mermista/Sea Hawk (She-Ra), Netossa/Spinnerella (She-Ra)

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Lesbian Character, Non-Graphic Smut, Alternate Universe - High School, Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), POV Catra (She-Ra), POV Adora (She-Ra), Human Catra (She-Ra), Best Friend Squad (She-Ra), Catra is Bad at Feelings (She-Ra), Secret Relationship

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by shirkzstuff09

Summary

An alternate universe of She-Ra if it were set in a High School AU.

Catra and Adora were both raised in the orphanage together until Adora left her. Years later, they see each other again... They start reconnecting again and building a new relationship, but with more complicated feelings.

Notes

Hey guys! I'll be updating every week, hopefully I can manage to post two chapters a week. Still don't know how many chapters i'm going for but stay updated! <3

Chapter 1

Chapter 1

Catra's POV:

It has been six years since Adora left… We grew up in the orphanage together, talking about how we would get adopted together or even stay together until we're old enough to leave, until she got adopted and left me… Sure enough, I was adopted a year later by Sharron Weaver, and all I can say about her is… She's not a great parent.
There are a lot of situations where Sharron got mad at me, it could be for not getting a good enough grade in school or even for being in her way at the wrong time. Which is a lot of the time. There are times when I think about Adora and how her life is. I bet she got everything handed to her… After I was adopted, I got into music, especially guitar and songwriting. I would write songs that would remind me of Adora, hoping one day I could sit down in front of her and sing them to her, but I don't think that's gonna happen.

"Catra! Get here right this instant!" I heard Sharron shout from downstairs. I flinched at the thought of what I could've done wrong; did I fuck up my report card? I thought I put a lot of effort this semester… I ran down the stairs to greet her, "Yes, Miss Weaver?" It's a thing she makes me call her, but when we're in public, I have to call her 'Mother.'

"You're going to a private school, since you can't seem to do well in a public school." She slurred. Great, she's drunk.

"What?" I blinked in surprise. This was a little sudden. She shoots me a glare, and I hold my breath, already waiting for a lecture on 'talking back' or some other bullshit.

“You’re going to Brightmoon Academy, you start next semester and don’t even think about arguing with me.” I just nodded silently. “Oh, and you’re staying in a dorm. I don’t have to see you that often now.” She waves me off.

As I walked back upstairs to my room, I couldn’t help but feel excitement. I can finally escape from Weaver. No more screaming and… Well, yeah. I guess I'd better start packing since it’s gonna be next week.

…
A week later…

I arrived at the school, and it was pretty fucking big for a high school. I already located the cliques in the school, especially the jocks, and they weren’t hard to spot since they’re in bright coloured letterman jackets. I continued to follow Weaver to the office as I watched the jocks. I noticed one person who stood out to me, though. She was pretty tall and muscular, not as muscular as Scorpia, though. She was blonde, high ponytail, and seemed to be throwing a football back and forth with another jock. She reminded me a lot of Adora.

A few moments later, we entered the office. We were greeted by the principal, who seemed to be dealing with a student who had pink hair and looked very sparkly, already didn’t like her. “It’s not fair though!” The sparkly girl crossed her arms.

“Not everything is fair, Glimmer, now please, I have to do my work.” The principal said sternly. Jeez, sounded like she could be her mother.

“Whatever, Mum.” Glimmer rolled her eyes and walked outside. Oh, it is her mum.

“So sorry about that! You must be Catra, right? Welcome to Brightmoon! I’m sure you’ll settle in quickly.” The lady smiled and had a softer tone.

I smiled awkwardly, I felt Weaver's eyes stabbing me, "I'm glad to be here." I managed to get out, and I felt her eyes move away from me.

"Don't mind her, she's just… Shy." Weaver added.

The lady smiled and nodded, "That's okay! I'm Principal Moon. I know, quite fitting for the school's name." She chuckled, "I have your timetable and dorm key right here for you." She grabbed the items and handed them to me.

"Thank you." I smiled and took them out of her hands. "Do I have a roommate?" I asked, kind of hoping I don't.

"Yes, you do, I will allow her to introduce herself to you." She smiled. I pretty much just screamed inside, but I guess I shouldn't have my hopes up… "I will have someone escort you to the dormitories while I have people come to help get your stuff." She smiled.

I look over to see another lady approach me, "Hi! My name is Mrs Spinnerella!" Wow, she's fucking cheerful. She guided me over to another building that was a bit further from the school. "So, where did you come from?" She started small talk… Great.

"Uh, Horde High," I replied.

"Really? That's a pretty big change, welcome to Brightmoon though!" She replied, still cheerful. I just know she secretly hates her job. We arrived at the dorms, and she took me to my room. I turned around to see random people carrying two boxes. This school is pretty fancy… Weird. I opened my door and let the people place the boxes in my room.

"Thank you," I said to them before they left the room.

"So, there's orientation tomorrow. Just to give you a tour around the school so you don't get lost on your first day!" She smiles and hands me a piece of paper with information.

“Thanks,” I smiled. She leaves my room, Weaver walks in after, and I immediately feel my body stiff. I noticed her holding my guitar case, and she placed it on the floor.

“I expect nothing but good grades while you’re here. I will be calling once a week to check in.” She stated.

I nodded in response. I just wanted her to hurry up and get out, if I’m being honest. “Okay, I promise to do well.”

“I’ll send you money for emergencies only; if it’s used for anything other than food, I will be calling you.” She glared. If looks could kill.

“Yes, Miss Weaver.” She nodded and left my room, closing the door behind her. I turned to look at the boxes. I opened one of the doors to a room, and it was empty, so it must be mine. I looked over to the other room, curiously, and I peeked in. It was full of sporty stuff but also band posters, I’m stuck with a jock, lovely…

…

Once I finished unpacking and setting up my room, I heard the door close from outside. I felt my heart drop. I guess I have to introduce myself to my roommate… I slowly opened my door to enter the main room, and I immediately recognised the person from behind. It was the girl I saw earlier with the blonde ponytail. I took a deep breath and spoke up. “Hey, I guess you’re my roommate.”

I watch her turn around, making my heart drop once again after realising who it was… Adora.

“Catra?” She spoke up, obviously shocked too.

I looked into her deep blue eyes, and she didn’t change a single bit. “Adora…”

Chapter 2: Chapter 2

Chapter Summary

Catra and Adora reconnect.

Adora POV:

"Catra?" I looked shocked when I saw my childhood best friend, who I had left standing right in front of me. I feel guilty for leaving, but I didn't have a choice. I hope she understands it…

"Adora…" She said in an unreadable tone. We stared at each other for a good minute, and all the letters I wrote her came flooding back. I stopped writing a few months ago. I thought it was stupid since I knew I would never send them. I scanned her, messy wavy brown hair, two different coloured eyes, one hazel and the other blue, freckles and a slender but fit body. I felt all sorts of emotions as I looked at her, "Long time, no see…" She added.

I looked back up to meet her gaze, "Yeah… Long time. How have you been?" I noticed a shift in her facial expression; she looked away for a moment before facing me again.

"It's been fine, you?"

"Good," I replied. Fucking hell, I could practically feel the tension in the room punching me. It was obvious that Catra was feeling similar, "I've… Missed you a lot. I thought I'd never see you again." I blurted out.

"I… Same here." She responded.

I wanted to bring up her getting adopted, but I could sense that now isn't a good time. "Um, I was gonna order some food? Would you like anything?"

"Uh, I'll just get what you're getting." She gave me a soft smile. I swear I could feel my heart wanting to jump out of my chest at

the sight of it. I cleared my throat and tried to ignore the heat on my cheeks, "Yes! I can do that." I quickly turned away and ordered food from my phone. I decided to just order something safe, like pizza… So, I ordered two pepperonis. I remembered how much we got when the Orphanage surprised us with pizza, and we would always go for the pepperoni.

"So, what kind of food are we having?" Catra broke the silence while plopping herself on the couch. I looked over to her, watching her hair fall flawlessly over her shoulders and how the afternoon sun shined on her face, making her freckles show more. "Earth to Adora?" She chuckled.

"Oh! Um, just pizza." I cleared my throat.

"Okay, weirdo." Catra did her signature smirk and started watching something on the TV. I took a deep breath, trying to calm myself, sat down next to her and scrolled on my phone. It was a comfortable silence, and I looked up to see what she was watching. I noticed she was watching "The Legend of Korra." I couldn't help but smirk. Who knew she was still into Avatar… "You still watch Avatar shit?"

She glanced over to me, "What's wrong with Avatar?" She added a smirk. God, I'm gonna lose my mind over this girl.

"Nothing, it's just… Cute that you still watch it." I let out a chuckle. I noticed her words getting caught in her throat and a slight pink forming on her cheeks, "Whatever." She grumbled. I wonder what that was about…

…

There was a knock on the door, and I immediately shot up I practically sprinted over to the door and opened it. The delivery guy looked surprised by how quickly I opened the door, but softly chuckled to hand me the pizzas and drink. "Thank you!" I closed the door and walked over to the couch. I noticed Catra giving me a look. "What?" I was confused.

“I’ve never seen you run that fast in my life.” She started laughing as she took a pizza box. I rolled my eyes and sat down, and immediately dug in.

“Hm, wanna watch a movie?” I suggested.

She looked at me and handed me the remote, “It better not be anything dumb.” This was my chance to start brainstorming about something that she would like. I opened Netflix and started scrolling through movies. “Have you ever watched Clueless?” She gave me a “really?” look. Okay… not clueless. I continued scrolling and saw Suicide Squad, I immediately clicked on it without caring what Catra thinks.

“Suicide Squad?” I heard Catra speak up.

“Have you never seen it?” I looked at her with a shocked expression. She looked at me with a confused look. She hasn’t seen this.

“No? What the fuck is Suicide Squad about? Do they all commit—”

“NO!” I cut her off and let out a laugh, “It’s a DC movie.”

“What, like Batman?” She asked.

“Yeah, just watch. It’s really good.” I replied to her. We both sat in comfortable silence, only the movie filling the room with sound. I was smashing the pizza into my mouth after barely eating today, especially with soccer training draining the life out of me. I took a few glances at Catra; she was completely hypnotised by the movie, and I couldn’t blame her, but there was something about the lighting on her face that made me stare in awe. It’s been so long since I’ve seen her, I couldn’t believe she’s back in my life… I don’t even know if she likes girls, or even me as a friend, for that matter. I mean, I did leave her without being able to say goodbye since the Orphanage practically shoved me out.

“Take a picture, it’ll last longer,” Catra smirked as she glanced over to me.

"I- I wasn't even staring at you!" I cleared my throat and looked at the TV. I just heard her laugh, which made my heart flip in my chest. I slowly looked over to her and watched the laughs escape her lips.

"Sure, you weren't… Princess." She slowly stopped laughing and held her gaze on me. Princess!? What is she doing to me!

I rolled my eyes and ate the last slice of my pizza. "Can I ask you something?" I finally decided to go for it.

"Hm?" She mumbled as she chewed her pizza, looking at me.

"Are you mad at me?" I sighed and slowly looked up.

There was a long pause. Catra looked at me with hesitation. "I don't know… I mean, waking up one morning to not see you in the bed next to me was… Not a nice feeling." There it was… The pang of guilt struck through me.

"Catra… You need to know that I didn't have a choice…" I sighed.

"To say goodbye?" She snapped slightly.

"I didn't get a choice!" I snapped back. There was another silence; we just sat there, staring at each other as the movie continued playing in the background.

"What do you mean?" Catra finally spoke.

"When I found out I was getting adopted, I immediately wanted to come to you, I did, but the Orphanage was practically shoving me out," I explained.

Catra looked away for a moment before reconnecting with my eyes, "So, how's your new family?"

I paused for a moment, I was contemplating whether I should tell her… I don't know how her home life was, what if it was shitty, and I'm just ranting about how lucky I am. "It's… good. I have a

brother, Adam. He's not around much though since he's travelling around."

"Pretty normal home then?" Catra looked at me.

I just nodded, "Yeah… I can't complain about my life." I studied her face, and I could tell there was a hint of jealousy, and that's what I was afraid of seeing. "Can I ask the same?"

Catra paused but eventually answered, "It's… Not as great as yours." She let out a chuckle, a pretty short one, before going quiet again. "Her name is Sharron Weaver, and she's not exactly the 'motherly' type." She added.

"I'm sorry to hear that…" I responded, I wasn't sure what to say.

"Don't be, it's not your fault." Catra smiled and nudged me slightly, "Let's just continue watching the movie and not make our reunion so sappy."

I nodded and faced the TV, watching a fight scene happening. At least I know Catra isn't mad at me… That much.

…

Catra fell asleep on my shoulder, and I smiled at the warmth. I grabbed the remote and turned the TV off, slowly moving her head over so I could stand up. I slowly picked her up and carried her to her room, and gently placed her on the bed, draping the blanket over her. I looked at her for a bit, a part of me just wanted to kiss her forehead, but that's too weird… right? I just started walking out until I felt her hand grab mine.
"Stay." She mumbled.
I felt heat rise to my cheeks. Would she even like me waking up next to her in the morning? This is her just being tired… But she might understand if I told her why I was in her bed. I walked around and got into bed on the opposite side of her. I slowly started drifting to sleep, feeling happy with her warmth next to me.

Chapter 3: Chapter 3

Chapter Summary

School...

Catra's POV:

I got woken up by the sunlight shining directly on my face. I groaned and turned over just to be greeted by… ADORA!? I shot up and stared at her; she was completely knocked out… Why is she in my bed? I couldn't help but watch her chest rise slowly up and down, the way her hair falls perfectly on her face… Catra stop. I noticed her slowly starting to wake up.

Once she opened her eyes, she shot up as well in shock, "Catra! Listen, I swear there's a reason why I'm in your bed!" She quickly blurted out. I just sat there in pure silence, still unsure what to think of the situation. "I carried you to bed, and when I left, you grabbed my hand and told me to stay… So, I did." She blushed slightly… Probably from embarrassment?

"Oh, that's okay… Sorry, I don't remember." I muttered while scratching my head. "What time is it anyway?" I decided to change the subject.

She went to reach for her phone but realised it wasn't on the end table, "Ugh, it's probably still outside." I watched her get up and leave my room. I decided to get up as well to follow her out. "It's 7:30."

"Great, I have stupid Orientation to go to before class." I groaned.

"Ah, it doesn't take long, don't worry. It's mainly going over some school expectations and then a tour. That's it." She chuckles and walks over to the kitchen to have some breakfast. "You want some cereal?" She offered.

“No thanks… I don’t have breakfast.” I shrugged and grabbed a glass of water. I looked over to her to see a concerned look. Here we go.

“You should have breakfast, it’s important.” She suggested, but I had already heard this lecture before.

“I know, I’ve heard it all before, but… I just feel sick eating in the morning.” I replied, taking a sip of water and trying to ignore the look on her face. “I’m gonna get ready to go to this orientation.” I walked off to my room.

“Okay…”

…

I walked out of my room to be greeted by Adora in a sports outfit. She was doing some stretches, which was making it seriously hard not to stare. “Where are you going?” I cleared my throat, trying to sound nonchalant.

“Oh, I’m about to go for a run. Clears my head before school… Or a game.” She replies while turning to face me. She looks so fucking perfect with a messy ponytail.

“Oh, when’s the next game?” I asked, trying not to make it obvious that I just want to watch her play.

“Next week Friday night, I’m shitting myself about it.” She chuckles.

I smiled, “Why? I bet you’ll do fine.”

She shot me a wide grin, “Shut up, you’ve never even seen me play.” I rolled my eyes as I watched her put her shoes on.

“Maybe I will.” I shot her a wink and grabbed my dorm keys before leaving for this orientation. I didn’t let her give me a response as I closed the door, I couldn’t help but smile to myself

as I made my way to this dumb meeting.
…

I sat down at this round table, looking at the other new kids. I felt a presence sit down next to me, and it made me look over to be greeted with a tall woman with blonde hair who had a flower headband. She looked like someone Scorpia would like.

"Hey! I'm Perfuma!" She smiled cheerfully. Yep, Scorpia would like her.

"Hey… I'm Catra." I smiled a bit. I'm not a very chatty person. Thankfully, a teacher came in to interrupt us.

"Hello everyone! My name is Miss Casta. I will be the person leading orientation today, we'll just go over some policies and then go straight onto the tour!" She smiled.

She honestly gave me creepy vibes from how bubbly her voice was., I shrugged it off and started to zone off as she lectured on about policies and shit. I'll just have Adora tell me in a short sentence when I see her again… I immediately snapped back to reality when I saw people starting to get up I quickly got up and followed them outside for the tour.
On the tour walk, I spotted Adora resting near a bench, drinking water. I stared at her as she drunk the water and how it dripped down her chin and how the sun made her skin shine in the sun from the sweat on her body. She looked over to me and smiled and waved before running off. Fuck, she's going to be the death of me.

…
I arrived back at the dorms to grab my timetable and bag, and I heard shuffling coming from Adora's room before I turned to leave. I looked over to the door to see it slightly open, exposing a sight of Adora getting changed. I felt my heart start beating fast and my face heating up. I quickly looked away and took a deep breath. I heard the door swing open and felt my heart drop.

“Hey, Catra! You ready?” She said as she grabbed her bag.

I took a deep breath, trying to compose myself before answering. “Uh, yeah… I’m ready.” I managed to get out.

“You alright?” She nudged me, causing me to turn and face her.

“Yeah, I’m fine… Just a bit nervous, I guess.” I chuckled.

She gave me a cheeky smirk, “Wow, THE Catra is nervous? You’ve changed…” She let out a heartfelt laugh.

“Shut up, let’s go…” I muttered as I followed her outside. She grabbed my timetable out of my hands, “Hey!”

“Ooh! We have some classes together! You’ll be fine.” She smiled. “Math, History, and P.E,” She added and handed the sheet back to me.

“Great, you’re just gonna distract me with your annoying questions,s,” I smirked. This earned me a jab in the arm.

“I will not!” She laughed.

“We’ll see,” I smirked in return.

We continued walking together until we reached our math class. As I walked in, I immediately recognised the teacher… Mrs Spinnerella. “Catra! You can find your seat.” She smiled at me. I noticed a cocky smile Adora gave me, and I rolled my eyes and followed her to sit at a desk next to her. Once we took our seats, the teacher started to began class. “Today we have a new student joining us! Everyone, welcome Catra.”

“Kill me now…” I muttered as I sank into my chair.

“Care to introduce yourself?” She smiled at me. I looked at Adora, and she was holding back a giggle.

I stood up slowly, “Hey… My name is Catra, I moved here from Horde High, and I play guitar.” I immediately sat back down. It seemed to make the teacher pleased since she went to actual teaching and left me alone.

As I was taking notes, Adora dropped a note in front of me. I rolled my eyes and whispered to her, “I’m next to you, dummy.”

“She hates when we talk during our teaching, I’m NOT risking it.” She whispered back.

I rolled my eyes and read the note, “You play guitar?” I couldn’t help but smirk at this dumb question.

“Yeah, for a few years now.” I wrote it down and passed it back to her. I noticed her immediately start scribbling on the note. I smiled to myself, getting reminded of how we used to do this when we were younger at the orphanage. I suddenly get the note passed back.

“That’s so cool! Can I hear you play sometime?” She drew a doodle of herself next to it. What a dork.

“No way.” I wrote on the paper and passed it back. I noticed her shoot me a puppy-eyed look, and I rolled my eyes with an uncontrollable grin. She passed the note back.

“Pleaseeeeeeee?” I looked at her to find that she was still doing the look.

“Fine.” I doodled myself frowning and passed it back.

I saw her light up immediately at the response; she put the note in her bag, which I found odd. Why didn’t she just scrunch it up to throw away later?

The rest of the class was pretty boring; it was just taking notes and listening to boring lectures. Adora made it fun with doodles we drew for each other and passed them back and forth. The bell rang, which sent all the students standing up and packing away

their things., I did the same and waited for Adora to take her sweet ass time. Once she finished, we made our way out of the class. Walking down the hallway, “What class do you have next?” She smiled at me.

“Music,” I said while reading it from my timetable.

“By the way, you'd better show me your playing skills soon. You promised.” She shot me a wink and walked off to her next class, leaving me in a flustered mess.

What did I agree to…

Chapter 4: Chapter 4

Chapter Summary

Catra starts her songwriting again?

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra's POV:

Music class wasn't too bad, I wish it was better if I'm being honest. As soon as the bell rang, I never ran out of a class so fast in my life. I had one thing on my mind, and that was Adora. I just wanted to see her face again and hang out with her. I continued walking through the halls, making my way over to the cafeteria, and that's where I spotted her again... Tall, messy blonde ponytail with that stupid poof. I noticed she was talking to that hippy chick I saw earlier and some other people, as I continued walking over hesitantly, Adora spotted me and smiled.

"Catra!" She giggled and grabbed my hand to yank me over to her friends, "Everyone, this is Catra." She introduced me. I examined everyone's reactions; they seemed to be more surprised than welcoming... Did Adora talk about me to them?

"Hi..." I muttered.

Glimmer quickly snapped out of her shocked state and smiled at me, "Hi! I'm Glimmer, and this is my boyfriend, Bow!" She smiled, leaning onto Bow's arm. *Arrow Boy and Sparkles... Alright.*

Another pair approached me, "Good day!" He practically shouted, "I am Sea Hawk! And this is my lovely lady Mermista!" He got down on one knee, presenting her. I can tell she was annoyed by his behaviour.

"Ugh... Ignore him, please." She said in a bored tone.

Okay... What is up with Adora's friends...

"Yeah... Okay." I held back a chuckle. I could tell Adora was cringing internally, obviously embarrassed by her friends. "Um, I already met Perfuma at orientation..." I added.

Perfuma smiled, "Oh yes! Nice to see you again."

"You know... I have a friend named Scorpia. I feel like you two would hit it off."

She smiled, "Oh, that's nice! You should set up a hangout plan."

I nodded, looking at Adora, who was smiling at the interaction. It was hard to pinpoint her expression, but she looked proud. *What a weirdo.* "I'm gonna hang out with Catra this break, I'll see you guys around." She added before dragging me off.

"You're eager to hang out with me. Did you miss me that much?" I smirked.

Adora got a bit flustered, "No, you dork! It's just been ages since we saw each other."

"We were together in math this morning," I said bluntly. This caused her to shove me playfully.

"You know what I meant!" She laughed.

I've missed this... I missed her so much, *can't believe I'm gonna say this, but thank you, Sharron, for moving me here.*

...

Adora and I walked around the campus together, even though I already had a tour of this huge place... I didn't mind doing it again with her; she took me to the football field and guided me up the

bleachers to sit down. "So, this is where you play and practice?" I asked her.

"Yeah, I have practice this afternoon... Coach Huntara really has it out for us, since she added surprise practice days." She groaned. As she continued talking, I zoned her out. My mind wandered over to Adora running and doing workouts. I could feel myself heating up at the thoughts. "Uh, Catra? You still with us?" She giggled.

I snapped out of my thoughts, "Huh? Oh, yeah. Still here."

She gave me a look, "You alright? You seem out of it." She nudged me slightly.

"Yeah, I was just... Daydreaming." I smiled.

She rolled her eyes playfully, "As I was saying... This school sometimes does these 'school concerts.' They would just randomly offer some of the music kids an opportunity to perform in front of the school."

I snorted at the idea, "Seriously? For no reason, too?"

She laughed slightly, "Yeah, I mean... There are other occasions like prom, school talent show... blah, blah, blah." She added.

"This school is fucking weird." I smirked, "Horde was completely different; they barely did anything for the students. Except maybe prom, but I could imagine how it would look." I laughed at the idea of a low-budget prom; my old school wasn't exactly as rich and fancy as this school.

"It's not so bad..." She smiled, pulling out her lunch. *Fuck, I knew I forgot to pack something.* "Do you want some? I knew you forgot to pack lunch."

I chuckled slightly, "Yeah, that'd be great." We both sat in comfortable silence as we ate the food, watching a group of boys playing football and finding every excuse to tackle each other. "I

never understood why boys wanna tackle each other so bad." I laughed.

I heard Adora snort, "I just don't get them in general." For some reason, I felt a spark of hope wash over my body. *Does Adora like girls, too?* It would make sense. "Are you..." I heard Adora trail off.

"Am I what?" I tilted my head, facing her.

"Ah... Never mind." She shrugged. *I'm going to fucking strangle this woman.*

"I'm gay." I rolled my eyes and bit into the sandwich. I noticed her smile like an idiot in the corner of my eye, *huh... I guess I was right.* "I'm gonna guess you are too."

She laughed, "How did you know?"

"You play soccer, that's like... Lesbian central." I laughed along with her, "Plus, I think I know the real reason why you wanted to watch Suicide Squad." I smirked.

She crossed her arms and smirked, "I have no idea what you're talking about."

"Come on, admit that you have a fat crush on Harley Quinn." I shoved her, sending us both into hysterical laughter.

She shoved me back, "What!? You can't blame me! I mean, have you SEEN her?!" I continued laughing, which made her more flustered. "Okay, what about you and Korra?" She smirked.

Now I was the one speechless, "Shut up."

"I knew it! You were practically drooling over yourself every time she appeared on screen." She pointed her finger at me.

The bell interrupted us. "Whatever, what class do you have next?" I stood up and grabbed my bag.

"We both have History, it's not too bad. We have Bow's dad, Mr Lance." Adora smiled and walked down the bleachers with me, "Don't worry, he won't embarrass you." She teased me.

"Shut up! That was so annoying. Why do teachers even do that?" I crossed my arms and mumbled.

"It's just so everyone in the class can get to know you! It's not that bad, you're not the only one she did it to." She bumped my shoulder. *I swear she's finding any excuse to touch me... I mean, I'm NOT complaining.*

"Alright, lead the way."

...

We both made it to class, sitting down at the same desk. Thankfully, Mr Lance didn't care about singling me out in the class to humiliate myself. Instead, he just welcomed me and moved on. I watched Adora pull out a few books, but one caught my eye. It looked like a journal more than a school book. I shrugged it off and started to get my stuff out. I spotted a book in my bag that I didn't even realise was in there. Funnily enough, I was looking for it while I was unpacking stuff. It was my songwriting book, and I hesitated grabbing it out... I zipped my bag up instead and turned my attention to the board. The teacher was going over the history of the legend 'She-Ra,' and I could physically feel my brain shutting off because this class was so boring.

I felt a small nudge, "You still with us?" Adora whispered and put on her cocky smirk.

"Sadly," I whispered back.

"Don't worry, normally if we get through the work quickly, then he just lets us have time to do whatever." She smiled and went back to taking notes.

I sighed and went back to taking down notes as well.

Once Mr Lance finished, he told us to do our own thing until the bell rings. 15 minutes of free time didn't sound too bad, so I went to grab my songwriting book without even thinking. I flicked through the pages, catching glimpses of the songs I wrote for Adora. It's kinda silly seeing them now since she's back in my life. I turned to a new page and started writing words that flowed out of me. I felt a presence peek over my shoulder. "May I help you, Adora?" I chuckled.

"What are you doing?" She leaned her head over my shoulder, and I smiled at the warmth.

"Writing down words..." I stated the obvious.

I could practically hear her eyes roll, "No shit, why though?"

"It helps with my song writing, which I haven't done in a while," I mumbled, preparing for the reaction I'm gonna get from her.

"WHAT!?" She squealed in excitement, causing heads to turn to us. I shot her a glare. "Sorry!" She smiled awkwardly at the teacher.

"Inside voices, please." He nodded and went back to typing on his computer.

"You write songs? So you also sing too??" She smiled and talked in a lower voice.

I sighed, "Yes." She started shaking me, obviously finding it hard to contain her excitement. "Jeez, calm down."

"Sorry, sorry. How long have you been doing this?" She finally lets go of me, calming down.

"Uh, since..." I trailed off, I don't wanna make her feel guilty... "Since you left."

She fell silent for a moment, "Oh."

"Don't feel bad, I should honestly thank you." I joked. I saw her shoulders lift up, like the weight finally got lifted off her shoulders. Jeez, is she that guilty?

"Ha, yeah... You should." She smiled softly. My gaze went over to her book; I guess she could see my interest towards it. "Oh, this? It's honestly nothing, I just did some writing for a bit..."

"Writing?" I asked, I felt like there was more to the story.

"Uh... You know, notes." She shrugged.

Now I definitely know that there's more to this, "You're a bad liar, you know that?" I smirked. Now I've got her full attention, "Just tell me."

She groaned in defeat, "You suck, but I... It's just some letters I wrote to you that I know I would never send. It sounds dumb."

I felt my heart flutter, and I fell silent for a moment. All I can think of now is what exactly she wrote to me. *I guess this makes my songwriting about her not as crazy as I thought.* "Really?" I asked, finally snapping back to reality.

She was blushing from pure embarrassment, "It's stupid, I shouldn't have told you-" I cut her off by placing a finger on her lips.

"It's not dumb, if it makes up for it... I wrote songs about when you left. It was the only way I could cope with you being gone." I chuckled and rubbed the back of my neck awkwardly, looking away. When I slowly look back up at her, she has sparkles in her eyes. *What the hell?*

"Aww, you did?" She smiled widely, leaning close to me.

I groaned, "Don't make a big deal about it." I shoved her away.

"Rude." She chuckled, "If I show you one of my letters, show me a song?" She pulled out the puppy eyes again; she was a literal golden retriever.

I groaned, "Maybe."

...

The rest of the school day was boring, finishing it off with English. I walked into my dorm room to silence... *Oh, right. Adora has soccer practice.* I plopped my bag onto the kitchen counter and looked around the room, *fuck it.* I left the room to head down to Adora's practice. On the way to the field, I started to wonder if I should join any sports, as it could provide easy access to a scholarship. Then Miss Weaver could get off my ass... But then again, I've never played a sport other than basketball, and that was years ago. Plus, maybe it's not as easy as I think to get one. I arrived at the bleachers and sat right at the front, watching the girls' soccer team jogging out. My eyes immediately land on Adora, the way her hair bounces perfectly as she runs, and how the sports uniform fits her perfectly. I couldn't help but just admire her.

What is wrong with me? She's my childhood friend.

As I watched her do training drills, she spotted me. I could see that she was surprised, but she threw me a wink and continued practising. *Holy fuck.* I felt my cheeks go warm, I groaned and tried to hide my smile even though she wasn't paying attention to me anymore. I continued watching her practice until it was over; she didn't even think before running over to me when the coach announced training was finished.

"Hey, stalker!" She smirked and she hopped onto the railing.

I rolled my eyes, "I'm not a stalker."

"Oh? Then why are you watching my practice?" She smirked, *holy fuck... I'm actually melting.*

I cleared my throat, "I was just getting fresh air, which you kind of ruined for me now." I recovered myself.

She slapped my arm, "Are you saying I smell?"

"Well, you are dripping with sweat..." I glanced down. *BAD IDEA, BAD IDEA.* I was now staring at how the sweat droplets fell down her chest and arms. I couldn't break my gaze away from it until I heard Adora's voice.

"You're staring." She mumbled, I looked up and saw a flustered face.

"Um, sorry." I cleared my throat and looked away. *What the fuck is wrong with me? I just made her uncomfortable.*

"It's fine, don't worry." I heard her giggle, "It's flattering."

She added a smirk and hopped off the railing, running to the locker rooms. I was left in a gay mess and decided to head back to the dorms.

Do I like Adora...?

Chapter End Notes

Hope you enjoyed this chapter! I'll update it whenever I have the chance :)

Chapter 5: Chapter 5

Chapter Summary

Deep dive into Catra's past with Sharron Weaver...

TW! Talk about child abuse.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora's POV

After practice, I just decided to head straight back to the dorms to shower. I was never a fan of getting changed in front of the other girls or even showering near them... On my walk back to the room, all I could think about was Catra watching me practice. It was sweet, but I couldn't understand why, since it was so unlike her.

I opened the door to spot Catra passed out on the couch with her laptop still sitting in her lap; she must've passed out while doing studies. I quietly approached her and took the computer out of her lap to charge it. I heard her snoring softly, which made me smile. I glanced down at her, scanning over the awkward position she was in, still sitting up, but her head had fallen back on the couch. I gently moved her so she could lie down in a comfortable position, placing a pillow beneath her head. I walked off to grab a spare blanket until I heard her phone buzzing. I know I shouldn't be nosy, but I couldn't help but glance at who was calling her.

The contact name was "Bitch Weaver." The name almost immediately clicked in my head; it was her adoptive mother. I do

remember Catra telling me that she wasn't very motherly, so the contact name made sense in a way, even though I don't know much about her. I looked over to Catra, not sure if I should wake her up to tell her. More buzzing comes from the phone after the call stops.

"Answer, Catra."

"I'm getting annoyed with you."

"You better have a good reason not to be answering me!"

Jeez, Catra wasn't kidding. I started to worry; maybe I should wake up Catra. I decided to drop it and head off for a shower. I didn't wanna insert myself into her family stuff and make it worse. Feeling the warm water splashing my skin was exactly what I needed. I've been pushing myself too hard lately with soccer and with my studies. I want to get into college more than anything, and I'm willing to drain myself out of exhaustion to do it. I've been feeling like a burden my whole life since I was adopted.

Once I finished my shower, I heard talking coming from outside my room, shit, I guess Catra woke up. I got dressed in a pair of sweatpants and a black tank top before heading outside. I saw Catra with an expression I've never seen on her face before; it was pure fear. What the fuck has this woman been doing to her?

"Miss Weaver, I'm so sorry I missed your calls! I was studying and then I passed out." She was pacing around the room, completely unaware of my presence. "No, I know... I didn't mean to fall asleep, but I have been doing well in my classes and studies." She continued.

After a while, she got off the phone. I could see her shaking, literally looking like she was about to blow up with tears. I quickly

rushed over, "Catra... Are you okay?" As I placed my hand on her shoulder, I felt her stiffen up.

"How long have you been there for?!" She pulled away.

I froze, I knew I overstepped something... But I couldn't just watch her break down. "I... I heard a bit." I admitted.

Anger flashed in her eyes, "So what? You just spied on my conversation!? It wasn't for you to eavesdrop!" She snapped.

"I didn't mean to! I just walked out and saw you on the phone. I just froze and didn't know if I should interrupt or..." I sighed. I didn't want her to be mad at me. "Is she always like that...?"

For a second, I saw sadness in her eyes, but it immediately got replaced by anger if she was trying to hide her feelings, "That's none of your business, Adora." With that, she turned around and went into her room, slamming the door shut.

Fuck.

...

Catra's POV

I woke up to my laptop being gone, I shot up in panic searching for it, only for it to just be on charge on the table. *Weird, I don't remember putting it on charge...* I examined the area around me to noticed I was lying on a pillow as well. *Okay... This is getting weird now.* I heard the shower running in Adora's room. Did she do all this? I started hearing buzzing from my phone, which was flooded with messages from Weaver. FUCK. I immediately called her back, and she picked up almost instantly.

"Catra." Her cold tone sent shivers down my spine. I'm fucked.

"Miss Weaver, I can explain--" I was instantly shut down.

"You insolent child! Can't even answer a simple phone call, if I find out the reason why you weren't answering was because you were slacking off..." She slurred over her words; of course, she was fucking drunk.

"You're drunk." I let out a shaky sigh.

"And? You can't control me on what I do!" She snapped, "Think about all the things I've done for you, now explain yourself right this instant!" Her tone was getting colder.

I started to panic, "Miss Weaver, I'm so sorry I missed your calls! I was studying and then I passed out."

"So, you were slacking off. What did I expect from you, Catra? Sleeping isn't an excuse to ignore my calls!"

"No, I know... I didn't mean to fall asleep, but I have been doing well in my classes and studies." I explained.

There was a loud silence afterwards, and fear continued to eat Catra until she heard a sigh from the other side, "You're lucky I haven't heard anything bad from your school yet. I'll let you off this time. If this EVER happens again... I'm coming over for a not-so-friendly visit." She then hung up.

I slowly lowered my phone from my ear, my hands shaking as I stared at it. I felt a hand on my shoulder, and immediately stiffened. "Catra... Are you okay?"

What the fuck? She was there the entire time, no... She can't see me like this; this is so embarrassing. I pulled away instantly, "How long have you been there!?" I looked at her face, and all I could read was guilt.

"I...I heard a bit." She looked down a bit before meeting my eyes again.

Goddamnit, Adora. Why couldn't you just mind your own fucking business? "So what? You just spied on my conversation!? It wasn't for you to eavesdrop!" I was mad, not at Adora. I was mad at Weaver; if it wasn't for her, then Adora wouldn't have seen me in such a vulnerable state. I'm so fucking embarrassed right now.

"I didn't mean to! I just walked out and saw you on the phone. I just froze and didn't know if I should interrupt or..." I saw her pause for a minute, "Is she always like that...?"

For a moment, I wanted to just vent to her about all the shit she's done to me, but I couldn't... Instead, I just did what I always do best, and that's shutting people out. "That's none of your business, Adora," I said coldly, entering my room and slamming my door shut behind me.

I stood there in silence for a moment before sliding down the door and holding my knees to my chest. I started uncontrollably sobbing, feeling the tears fall down my face and tasting the salty tears. I heard a soft knock on the door.

"Catra, please... Just talk to me." I heard Adora's voice choke. Shit, she's crying because of me now.

I slowly stood up and opened the door to be faced with Adora, who already had red eyes. "Adora..." I let out a sigh before looking away.

"Talk to me, I'm not losing you again, Catra." She walked towards me and pointed a finger towards my chest, causing me to walk back into my room further.

She had determination on her face. Does she care about me that much? "I..." I couldn't get the words out, I want to tell her so bad.

"Please." She lowered her hand and just looked at me with sore eyes.

"I... Weaver hated me ever since I was brought into her home. At first, I thought she was nice. But it was only an act for the orphanage." The words just started flowing out of me, "Then drinking came along, it was bad... Like really bad. She would drink and drive most nights, leaving me worried that she would get into a car accident or... She would, uh." I trailed off; I didn't know how to talk about it.

Adora looked at me, and it wasn't just sadness. There was anger, and I got worried that I had done something wrong. "She's not a mother." She spat out, "She doesn't deserve you, Cat." The nickname... It was something I hadn't heard in a long time.

"She would hit me." It rolled out of my mouth, "Some nights when she came home late... She would just come up to my room and scream at me, telling me that I'm worthless and I didn't deserve anything. Then she would just... Hit me." I didn't realise tears were practically pouring out of my eyes.

Suddenly, I felt arms wrapping around me. Pulling me in close, "I'm so sorry, Catra." She was crying now, and I wrapped my arms around her and cried into her shoulder. We stayed in this position for a while, and I didn't want to pull away. I finally felt safe... "How about we order some food? Watch a movie and take a break?" She pulled away and smiled at me.

"That would be nice..." I softly smiled back.

"How about we have a sleepover in your room? You still owe me one of your songs." She smirked before she walked off to grab her phone.

I groaned at the idea but accepted it anyway, walking out with her to pick what we should order.

Adora's POV:

We settled on sushi, and Catra was practically inhaling her food while I watched in amusement. "Hungry much?" I laughed.

She rolled her eyes and smirked, "You can't talk! You do the same thing with any food." She countered.

I instantly said, "I do not!"

"Yes, you do!" She did a squeaky laugh, my favourite laugh... "Why are you looking at me like that?" She smirked while still giggling.

I got flustered, "I just... I haven't heard that laugh in a long time, it's my favourite." I admitted.

Now, Catra was the one blushing, "Shut up." She mumbled.

There was a comfortable silence while a movie continued playing on the laptop in front of us. I glanced over to her guitar case. It had some patches stitched onto it; there were a few bands that I recognised, but one stood out the most. *Arctic Monkeys.* I never heard of that band before, and the name sounded silly. "Who are Arctic Monkeys?" I spoke up, looking over to Catra shortly after, who just had a shocked expression on her face.

"Nuh uh, no way! You never heard of Arctic Monkeys?!" She looked beyond surprised.

"Uh... No?" I looked at her, confused.

"Oh, Adora..." She shook her head and grabbed her phone. "I'm sending you a playlist of my favourite songs from them, you NEED to listen to them." Shortly after she said that, I got a notification on my phone.

This made me chuckle, "Okay." I browsed over some of the song names... *"R U Mine?, Crying Lighting, She's Thunderstorms, Fireside, Dancing Shoes, 505..."* I couldn't help but smirk and face Catra again, "There's like... over 20 songs in here. How many favourite songs do you have?"

This caused Catra to roll her eyes, "They have like, zero bad songs. I would've sent you their entire discography."

"Whatever," I smirked and put my phone away, taking another bite of my food. "You should show me your song."

This caused Catra to choke a bit, "What?"

"Come on! I really wanna hear it!" I did my puppy eyes again; I knew it was Catra's weakness.

This earned a loud groan from Catra, "Fine, but this doesn't mean I like you."

"Oh, obviously not," I smirked.

I watched her stand up and grab her guitar, sitting back down in the spot while tuning it. I couldn't help but admire her while she was concentrating on tuning each string; a small smile appeared on my face, which she noticed. "What are you grinning about, princess?" That nickname...

"Ugh, stop calling me that." I turned away, flustered.

"Hm, seems like you secretly like it." She smirked, she finished tuning and took a deep breath and looked lost in thought.

I raised an eyebrow, "You alright?"

"Yeah, just think of what song to sing..." She hummed. "Okay, now... No judging."

I nodded and quickly shut my mouth, excited to see her play.

She began playing a few chords, and I rested my head in my hand and watched in awe. Soon after, she started singing softly.

"I lost a friend

Like keys in a sofa

Like a wallet in the backseat

Like ice in the summer heat..."

Her voice was shaky at first, and I could tell she was nervous, but she eased into it after a while.

"I lost a friend

Like sleep on a red-eye

Like money on a bad bet

Like time worrying about every bad thing that hasn't happened yet

I know I'll be alright."

I was completely in love with her voice. I paid attention to each lyric and felt my heart slowly break.

"But I'm not tonight

I'll be lying awake counting all the mistakes I've made

Replaying fights

I know I'll be alright

But I'm not tonight..."

She then slowly finished playing and cleared her throat, "Yeah, that's all you're getting." She looked away, embarrassed.

"Catra, that was amazing..." I smiled, staring into her different coloured eyes. There was a comfortable silence as she placed the guitar against the wall. As she turned back, she looked at me with an expression I couldn't figure out. "What is it?"

"I..." She trailed off; it looked like she was struggling to get the words out.

"You can tell me." I smiled softly, which caused her to lean in a bit too close. I instantly looked down at her lips as a force of habit, and as I looked back up, she was doing the same thing... *Wait, is she gonna kiss me?*

"Adora..." She let out a shaky whisper.

She grabbed my neck and pulled me into a kiss. I was surprised, but I immediately melted into it. My hand finds its way to her face, cupping it while my lips have a mind of it's own... The kiss turned into a make-out, and I didn't want it to end, but we both broke apart to catch some air.

"Whoa." I managed to get out.

I could see panic in her eyes, "Shit! I'm so sorry." She immediately stood up and left the room... Her own room, I might add. I quickly went after her.

"Wait, Catra!" I grabbed her hand.

"I liked it."

Chapter End Notes

I hope you enjoyed this chapter! I'm planning to update it every weekened :)

Song: I Lost A Friend - Finneas

Chapter 6: Chapter 6

Chapter Summary

Aftermath of the kiss.

TW! Mention of child abuse.

A bit of spice ;)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra's POV

"I liked it."

The words she never would've thought that would come out of Adora's mouth after doing the stupiest thing, I can't believe I just pulled her into a kiss like that!? I didn't even ask, I'm so stupid. But... She didn't push me away; she actually kissed me back, it was... nice.

"Catra?" I heard her voice snap me back to reality, "Are you okay?" She added with a concerned expression.

"I... I, uh. Yeah, I'm okay." I smiled softly. There was an awkward silence between us. I couldn't bear it anymore, and before she could say something, I cut her off. "Maybe we should head off to bed..."

I saw a flash of disappointment in her eyes, "Oh, yeah, right. Should probably head off to my room." She cleared her throat and

slowly walked off. A part of me wanted to grab her hand, stop her and say she can stay in my room, but I watched her walk off.

As the door closed, I immediately collapsed onto my bed and screamed into my pillow. Replaying the whole situation in my head, singing and playing guitar for her, and then... Kissing her. Which fucking turned into a make-out. I never wanted it to stop. What is wrong with me? Why didn't I just let her stay after she literally told me that she LIKED it? I slowly started crying, drifting off to sleep.

...

I walked through the front door of my house, spotting Weaver drunk again. I felt a cold shiver go down my spine, feeling her cold gaze rest upon me.

She stood up, holding a bottle of wine in her hands and approached me, "Where were you?" She said it in a cold tone that raised the hairs on my arm. I was scared.

"I'm sorry, I lost track of time at the library! I didn't set an alarm..." I looked down, knowing what was about to come.

I suddenly felt a sharp pain in my left cheek, making me drop to the ground and hold my face. I looked up to see her hand still raised, "You insolent child. You have been nothing but worthless and lazy! Can't even set an alarm on your phone!" She screamed. "I bet you were sneaking out, weren't you?! Being a slut and seeing guys."

"No! I swear I wasn't!" I cried out, watching her walk off to the kitchen.

"I don't want to hear it." She says coldly.

I quickly ran up the stairs to my room, closing the door. I sat down in front of the door, sobbing as I brought my knees to my chest. Soon enough, the banging started. Weaver started to bash on my door, trying to open it. The only dependent thing was me stopping it, but tonight... She was really mad, and I wasn't enough to calm her down. I fell forward as the door swung open, and she then grabbed my messy hair and yanked me up.

"How dare you!? Think you could just run away from me when I wasn't finished with you?" She screamed.

"I'm sorry! Please stop!" I was practically begging her; tears were streaming down my face.

"STOP!"

...

I shot awake, gasping for air, my heart felt like it was gonna shoot out of my chest. Once I looked around the room, I realised I was safe in my room. My breathing went back to normal, taking one final deep breath before getting out of bed. I checked the time, noticing it was 3 am. I walked outside to the kitchen to grab a glass of water, and I scrolled through my phone as I started taking sips.

"Can't sleep?" I heard Adora's voice appear behind me, making me choke on the water.

"Jeez, Adora!" I spun around as I continued coughing.

All I heard was giggling, which never fails to make my heart flutter. "I'm sorry! Why are you up?" She then leans forward

against the counter. It felt like she was putting all her attention on me, and it was... Overwhelming?

"I had a nightmare, needed a breather and grabbed a drink. What about you?" I said bluntly.

And there it was, there concerning gaze on her face that was piercing through my head. "Nightmare? Are you okay?"

As much as I didn't wanna talk about it, I feel like she deserves to know. "It was just a bad memory of... You know, Weaver." I clenched my jaw as I said her name.

"I'm sorry, Cat." There it was again, that stupid nickname.

"Don't worry too much, Princess," I smirked.

Adora's cheeks turned slightly pink; I guess that made her feel something, good to know... "Whatever, I'm here if you need to talk." Adora smiles softly.

"Thanks, Adora." I returned a smile, "I'm gonna head back to bed, see you tomorrow."

Adora nodded, "See ya." She went back to her own room.

I walked into the bathroom and looked at myself in the mirror, running my hand through my messy hair. Tears were already running down my cheeks, getting reminded of all the hair-pulling Weaver did to me. I started rummaging through the drawers until I came across scissors, slowly looking up in the mirror. I tied my hair up in a ponytail and grabbed the scissors, preparing to cut it all off. The scissors hovered over the hair for a few moments until I went for it, cutting it all off. I looked at the ground, seeing all the messy hair that was spread across the floor. I continued cutting my hair until it was a cute pixie cut. I grabbed a small garbage bag from under the sink and cleaned up the hair. Once I

was finished, I took one last look in the mirror, pleased with my work and headed off to bed.

...

I woke up to my alarm, and the smell of breakfast filled my room. I guess Adora's cooking breakfast, better get up quick before she manages to burn the place down. As I walked out, I was immediately glued to her; she was in a cropped tank top with baggy jeans. My eyes roamed over her. I never wanted to touch her so badly before; all I wanted to do was come up behind her and wrap my arms around her waist.

I snapped out of my thoughts, "Whatcha' making?" I asked, trying to sound natural.

"Oh, morning." She says, still concentrating on cooking. "I'm just making scrambled eggs on toast."

I sat down on a stool, leaning over the counter. "Smells good."

Adora grabbed the pan and started putting the eggs on pieces of toast, "Yeah, I made you a serving, so don't worry too much." She giggled.

"Yeah, I was hoping that would be the case," I smirked.

Adora finally turned around to face me, "Anyways, your breakfast is ser... YOUR HAIR?" She squealed. I jumped back at the sudden outburst. She quickly placed the food down and ran around the counter to get a closer look. "You did this last night?"

I felt a bit flustered, "Uh, yeah... After we split off to bed."

She suddenly ran her fingers through my hair, and I felt my heart stop and heat rising in my cheeks. I slowly looked up at her, her

expression was... Intrigued? She continued doing the same motion with my hair before she spoke up, "It's so soft..."

I cleared my throat, "You alright there, Adora?"

She quickly snapped out of it, pulling her hand away. I felt a wave of disappointment rush through my body. "Oh! Sorry." She chuckled awkwardly.

"It's okay, so, uh... You like it?" I smiled awkwardly.

"Like it? I love it! It looks amazing, Cat!" She smiles widely. "Can I ask... why you did it?"

I sighed, "Another time." I smiled gently.

She understood immediately and dropped it, and she walked back around the counter to grab her plate of food before sitting on the stool next to me. "What are your plans today?" She smiles before digging into her food.

I slowly started eating mine, "Um, I thought I might do some studying." I shrugged. "History test coming up."

Adora immediately groans, "Shit! I forgot about that! I haven't done anything yet." She sighed.

I chuckled, "Never a dull moment with you, Adora. You need help?"

Her eyes light up like a golden retriever, "Really!? That would mean so much!" She pulls me into a hug.

"Yeah, yeah. This is NOT because I like you." I smirked and playfully pushed her away.

She returned a smirk, "Oh, yeah? Last night told me something different..."

Holy fuck.

I never felt so turned on from a single sentence so fast before. Where did this confidence come from? "Damn, Adora." I looked back at my plate, stuffing my face to avoid talking.

I then hear a laugh, "Aww, what's wrong? Cat got your tongue?"

"Shut up," I mumbled, feeling flustered more than ever.

"You know, you look really cute when you're flustered." She leaned in.

"I am NOT cute!" I growled.

"The angrier you get, the cuter you are!" She giggles. I huffed and turned away, ignoring her comments. She smiled in victory, continuing to eat her food. "You know, I was expecting you to shut me up with another kiss, but... Guess I can't always get my hopes up."

I choked on my food, "What?!" I quickly turned to face her. I was greeted with her having a massive laughing fit, clearly enjoying herself. All of a sudden, I was mesmerised by her. I never thought I was so attracted to her laugh until now.

She calmed down and looked at me, still giggly. "What?"

I couldn't control my body. I grabbed her neck and pulled her into a passionate kiss, proud that I managed to shut her up. As I pulled away, I saw the flustered mess she was, and I never felt prouder. "Maybe you should keep your hopes up." I chuckled.

I finished up my breakfast and walked over to the sink to clean my dishes. I turned around to be greeted by Adora towering over me. I couldn't help but giggle. "What's the matter, Princess?" I smirked at her.

Suddenly, there was a look of determination on her face. She pins me against the counter and leans in. "You're just gonna leave after that?"

Fucking hell, she can just pick me up and throw me at this point.

Adora pressed her lips against mine, still pinning me against the counter. My hands make their way around her neck, keeping her towards me. It turned into an intense makeout session. She placed her hands on my waist while still pushing me slightly. Adora decided to be bold and made her way to my neck, and a small whimper escaped my lips. I felt embarrassed straight away. Adora pulled away and looked at me with a cocky smirk.

"Don't."

"Did you just?"

"Adora."

She chuckles, "That was so cute!"

"It was not! You weirdo." I hit her playfully while looking away, still flustered.

"It very much was... And I wouldn't mind hearing it again." She smirks.

"Fuck me..." I grumbled.

Adora laughs, "I mean... If you really want me to.." Blush rushes to my face almost immediately. *What the fuck!*

"Adora! That's not what I meant!" I shove her.

She laughs, "Alright!" She goes to grab her plate, nudging me away from the sink shortly afterwards.

"I'm gonna get my stuff so we can study."

Adora nods, "Sounds good."

As Catra walked into her room, she quickly closed her door and ran to jump onto her bed. Squealing into her pillow.

"Holy shit."

Chapter End Notes

So sorry for the lack of posting! I'm planning to post two more soon. I hope you enjoyed this chapter and let me know what you think of it so far! :)

Chapter 7: Chapter 7

Chapter Summary

Study date?

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora's POV

I was grabbing my laptop and my notebook from my room. It was getting a bit chilly, so I grabbed my favourite hoodie and walked outside to the lounge room. Catra still wasn't out yet, so I decided to make myself comfortable on the couch and make sure my laptop was on charge. The door opens, and Catra makes her way to the couch, setting everything up.

"Okay, blondie. How much have you done?" She breaks the silence.

"Uh..." I smiled innocently towards her.

She rolls her eyes, "Seriously... Nothing?"

"I'm sorry! I've been so distracted with soccer and... Ugh." I groaned.

She let out a squeaky laugh; I'd missed it so much. "Alright, whatever. I'll help you out; you should know the majority of World War II, I hope?"

"How the Treaty of Versailles was a reason why it started because of unfair terms, Hitler, the Holocaust... Nazi Germany." I shrugged.

Catra smirked, "More than I was expecting. Okay, luckily for you. Those are pretty much the topics that will be in the test." She laughed, grabbing her laptop and notebook. I started doing the same thing, logging into my laptop. When I turned to face Catra, she was holding a case... grabbing glasses out? Then, when she put them on, I felt like my heart was about to explode out of my chest.

"You wear glasses?" I almost stuttered at the sight of her. When she looked over, I stared in awe and was not even listening to what she was saying. The way they sat on her nose and made her look even hotter was incredible.

"Earth to Adora?" She snapped me out of my trance.

I cleared my throat, "Sorry, what did you say?"

Catra rolled her eyes and chuckled, "Reading glasses." She pointed to her glasses to state the obvious.

"Oh, right. When did you get them?" I tried not to make it obvious how much of an effect they were for me.

She hummed, "Like a year after you left, I got adopted, and there were signs of me struggling in class trying to read things on the board or... Squinting every time I was reading a book because it was blurry up close. Blah, blah, blah." She paused and stared at me. I felt my heart flutter and tried to calm myself. "Why? You like them?" She smirked.

"Shut up!" I looked away, pretending to be interested in my laptop.

She did another squeaky laugh, "I knew it!"

A groan escaped my mouth, "No, you didn't! It just... It's kind of hot." I mumbled. There was silence. I looked over to Catra, who had the biggest cocky smirk I've ever seen her do, here we go...

"Oh? It's hot, huh?" She teased.

I rolled my eyes, "Studying! That's what we should be concentrating most on at the moment, is it not?" I chucked a book at her and giggled.

"It's very hard to move on from the fact that you find me hot in glasses, never knew you were into nerds." She just doesn't stop. I just want to kiss that smug look off her face. It's all I've been wanting to do since I saw her again. "Maybe I can use it to some advantages..." She smirked. *Okay, that's it.*

I placed the laptop down on the coffee table, grabbed her shirt and pulled her into a kiss. She was caught off guard, but before I could let her melt into it, I pulled away. "Are you done?" I chuckled, slightly out of breath. She was silent, still trying to process what had happened. "That's my answer then."

"You... You're so annoying." She huffed and grabbed her notes.

"I try."

...

After hours of taking down notes, my stomach let out a loud growl. This caught Catra's attention and made her laugh, "I think we're done for the day. I'll order us something. Thank god, I thought I was never gonna be free from this torture.

"Thank you." I groaned and put everything away. "Wanna watch something?" I say as I grab the remote.

"Sure, put whatever you feel like on." She replies while scrolling on her phone. I nodded and scrolled through Netflix, spotting Brooklyn 99. Catra would love this show. I immediately put it on and leaned back into the couch. Catra then glances up. "What's this?"

"You'll love it, it's Brooklyn 99. It's like my favourite sitcom of all time." I smiled proudly.

She turned to face me, giving me a look. "Sitcom? You sure I'll like it?"

I gave her an offended look, "What is wrong with sitcoms!?"

This made Catra giggle, "Sorry! I just don't think I could get into it..." I gave her a look that made her trail off, "But... I guess I'll be willing to try it for you."

"For you."

Marry me already. You're willing to watch something for me? Wow, you must actually like me. How embarrassing for you." I smirked.

This earned me a shove from Catra. "Ugh, shut up. Let's just watch this dumb show."

"You're gonna regret that you said it's a dumb show..." I smirked confidently.

...

Later on, we were already nearly finished with the first season, and the empty takeout food was resting on the coffee table. That wasn't the only thing that was resting, though. Catra was lying her head on my lap and I gently brushed through her hair. I never wanted this moment to end, and Catra hasn't once complained about the show; in fact, she was actually laughing and enjoying it, which made me even more proud.

"So, are Jake and Amy gonna get together at some point? It's so obvious." She spoke up.

I chuckled, "I shall never spoil." This earned me a laugh from Catra, making my heart flutter at the sound.

"Whatever, dork."

Another comfortable silence fills the room, with only the show breaking the silence. I looked at the window to see it getting dark outside. It had to be at least 6 pm, but I couldn't check since my phone was on the coffee table and Catra was lying on my lap. Suddenly, I heard soft snores coming from her. I smiled to myself and gently grabbed a pillow to replace me with. I gently got up and placed the pillow under her head, then turned the TV off. I cleared the rubbish off the table and took it to the kitchen, dumping it in the bin and placing the plates in the sink for me to wash tomorrow.

I heard some noises coming from Catra. When I walked over, I noticed she was breathing heavily. I automatically knew she was having a nightmare, so I quickly rushed over to her and gently shook her. After a bit, she woke up, "Hey, it's okay. I'm here, you're safe." I smiled softly.

She eventually calmed down her breathing, "Sorry, I didn't mean to disturb you."

I chuckled, "Don't apologise, you want some water?" I offered.

"Yeah, that would be nice. Thank you." She nodded.

I came back with cold water and offered it to her, sitting on the coffee table so I could be face-to-face with her. "Was it... Her again?" I slowly looked up at her.

She just nodded, taking a sip of water. "These nightmares suck. I normally don't have them this often, but... I don't know, I guess something is just worrying me or the fact I haven't had my sleeping pills in a while."

I nodded, "Do you need to start taking them again?"

"Maybe, I'll grab some tomorrow." She sighed.

"Want me to take you to bed?" I offered, this caused Catra to choke on her water and gave me a confused look, "Whoa, you good?"

Still slightly coughing, "At least take me to dinner first." She laughs.

I felt words caught in my throat, "I didn't mean... You know... Ugh! You suck, you know that's not what I meant." I was clearly flustered, trying to calm down.

"Sure it wasn't..." She snickers, taking another sip of the water. "It's okay, I am hot. I don't blame you for wanting to bed me."

I stared at her, shocked for a moment, "I mean, only if you keep the glasses on..." *Whoa, where the fuck did that come from?*

Whatever I did, it definitely affected her. "Wow, I..." I noticed the blush rising on her cheeks. "Damn, Princess. You really know how to woo a girl, don't you?" She clears her throat.

I chuckled, "I try."

"You certainly do."

Another silence filled the room until I cleared my throat, "Um, seriously though. Would you like me to take you to your bed, *appropriately?"*

Catra chuckles, "Sure, dummy. Let's go." We both got up and went into her room.

"Anything else you need?" I shoved my hands into my pockets awkwardly.

"You." She said bluntly. There was silence. I looked at her like she had grown another head until she finally realised what she said, "No! I meant like... Can you stay, please?" She sighed. I started howling, bent over as I held my knees. I was practically wheezing

at this point. "Yeah, yeah. Laugh it up." She says, unable to hold back her own laughter, as she gets into bed.

Once I calmed down, I got into bed with her. "I would gladly accompany you on this lovely night."

"Oh, shut up." She giggles as she turns to face me.

I brushed a piece of hair out of her face, "I... Do you think we could talk about something tomorrow?" This leaves a worried look on Catra's face. "Nothing bad! It's actually... Good, don't worry." I chuckled.

"Oh, alright. Sure." She smiled.

I kissed her forehead and then brought her into an embrace. I felt her face snuggle into my chest; it was a nice, warm feeling throughout the night. I never felt happier. It was quiet until I heard her soft snores filling the silence. I smiled and drifted off to sleep.

Chapter End Notes

Sorry if this chapter felt short! I've been busy lately, but don't worry. There's still more to come ;)

Chapter 8: Chapter 8

Chapter Summary

Confession?

TW: Weaver, homophobic mentioned.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra's POV:

I woke up to the smell of bacon, the smell practically dragged me out of bed and into the kitchen. I spot Adora cooking breakfast; she has never looked so hot before. Her hair was up in a messy ponytail, and the tank top was showing her bare arms, and I admired her as she served two plates.

She slowly turned around, holding two plates. "Hey, Catra! Breakfast is--" She cuts herself off as she spots me leaning against the door frame of my bedroom. The look of surprise was immediately replaced with a stupid grin. "Oh, morning."

"Morning, I don't get how you get up so early... It's Sunday, you know?" I chuckled and sat down at the counter, admiring the food.

She shrugged and sat down next to me, "My body doesn't let me."

It went quiet as we both stuffed our faces. Every time I glanced over to Adora, I could tell something was on her mind. "Alright, you have that dumb look on your face." I turned to her, and she raised an eyebrow, trying to be clueless. "What's on your mind?"

"Ugh, how can you read me so well?" She mumbled.

I chuckled, "We grew up together, maybe? Just spit it out."

I could tell Adora was nervous; she started fiddling with her thumbs and taking deep breaths. "Well, I... Uh."

"Jeez, you didn't kill someone, did you? I am NOT helping you hide a body." I chuckled and took a sip of water.

"What!? No! I just..." Adora took another deep breath in, "I need to tell you something, I was gonna tell you last night..." She mumbled.

A memory popped into my head from last night, "Oh, yeah. What's up?"

"Catra, I like you," Adora said bluntly, looking down at her food.

There was a long pause until I started giggling.

"What's so funny?" She looked at me obliviously.

"Well, were the makeouts against the kitchen counter not enough?" I smirked.

This caused Adora to choke on her food, "Catra! You know what I mean, like... I really like you and I want to be with you." She let out a sigh.

I stared at her for a moment. Of course, I liked her back. But something inside me is afraid that if people see us together in public and Weaver finds out, I'm dead. Last time I tried coming out to her was a literal nightmare, if she finds out I'm actually dating a girl. I know there will be worse consequences.

I arrived home to see Weaver watching TV. Surprisingly, she wasn't drinking this time. Once I took my shoes off and walked into the living room, she turned to look at me.

"There's food in the microwave; heat it yourself." She mumbled and went back to watching TV.

Of course. I walked into the kitchen to heat my food, watching the food spin in the microwave. I looked over to Weaver, and she seemed to be in a better mood than last night... I looked down at my arm to see bruises, reliving the memory. I didn't realise that Weaver was walking up to me, "I am sorry about last night, I don't know what came over me..."

I looked up at her. It's just another repeat. Beating, apologising the next morning, then it will happen again eventually. I just sighed and gave her a weak smile, "It's okay, Miss Weaver. I'm fine."

She gave a sly nod, looking down at me while placing a hand on my cheek. "You will do great things, I'm sure of it. The only reason I'm so hard on you is that you remind me of myself; things were never easy for me either. So why should they be for you?" She rubbed my cheek.

I was surprised by this. I had never heard of this before... "Really?"

She nodded and pulled her hand away, "Positive."

There was a moment of silence before Weaver started to walk away. I spoke up, "Can I ask you something?"

She stopped to turn and face me, "Yes?"

"How do you know... If you like someone?" I slowly looked up at her. I had never asked for her advice before, but I'm hoping she won't get mad at me for something.

I could see a slight change in her face, but she quickly covered it up. "Well, shouldn't you be focusing on your studies more than boys, Catrina?" I winced at the name. I didn't like anyone calling me that.

"Well, that's the thing... What if it's... Not a boy?" I gulped.

That's it, I saw anger wash over her face, "There's no such thing for girls liking girls. It's sinful behaviour and I will not let you bring it into my household, do you understand me?"

I flinched at her words, "Yes... I'm sorry, Weaver." I turned to the microwave once I heard it beeping, I grabbed the food out and made my way over to the dining table. I heard her footsteps making their way behind me, and I turned to look up at her. "Yes, Miss Weaver?"

"If I ever hear you being in relations with a... girl. You will regret it." She glared at me before walking back to the living room.

"Hey, Catra? You okay? I'm so sorry for dumping this on you." Adora rambled, and before she continued, I cut her off.

"Don't worry about it, dummy. I like you too." I chuckled.

I swear I saw sparkles in Adora's eyes, the idiot. She just smiled to herself and continued eating her breakfast. I did the same. Once I was finished, I went to put my plate in the sink until Adora stopped me, "Nope, let me."

"Absolutely not, you dork! You cooked, I'll do the cleaning." I retorted.

Suddenly, I felt a kiss on my cheek, and the plate was taken off me. "I got it."

I was about to protest, but she already ran over to the sink to clean the dishes. "You're so annoying." I let out a scoff. Adora just poked her tongue out at me. I walked up behind her and wrapped my arms around her stomach, feeling her abs through the shirt. It made me slightly flustered, but I did my best to ignore it. "You seriously didn't have to, you know? I am not getting princess treatment in this relationship." I smirked.

Adora chuckled, "We'll see about that." She finished off the plates and turned to look at me with a stupid grin. A grin, I could easily kiss off her stupid face. I could tell she was teasing me. She started leaning in closer, holding my waist and pulling me closer. I rolled my eyes and pulled her into a kiss; it was passionate. I felt her pick me up and carry me over to the couch, laying me down. My stomach was doing flips. I love how strong she is.

She climbed on top of me, running her hand up my shirt. A soft moan escaped my lips. I could tell she was hungry. She made her way down to my neck, occasionally leaving small bites as she kissed my neck. "Wow, coming pretty bold, princess." I chuckled.

"I love it when you call me that." She murmured into my neck.

I quickly push her off, "Adora! You better not be leaving hickeys!" I watched her face form into a grin. "Adora..."

She started laughing, "I'm sorry! I can cover it up with makeup!" She dropped down and started laughing into my chest.

"Oh my god, you're so annoying!" I laughed, trying to lift her off me, but she was too heavy. "Get off!"

"Nooo, I'm too lazy." She lifted herself a bit to give me a smirk.

I was about to pull her into another kiss until her phone started ringing, "Ugh, way to kill the moment."

Adora chuckled and rolled her eyes as she got off me to answer the phone. "What's up, Glimmer? I was about to start doing something important." She smirked at me.

I felt a slight blush on my cheeks, I rolled my eyes and flipped her off.

"Oh, shit! I'm sorry, I didn't know that was today." I watch her smirk drop before running into her room, most likely to get dressed. Shortly after, she was dressed up and still on the phone. "I know, I know! I'm leaving now." She then hangs up to look at me.

"You good?" I chuckled.

"I'm so sorry! I forgot I had this thing with Bow and Glimmer. I have to go, but I'll see you later." She gave me a peck on the lips before sprinting out the door. I just laughed and decided to watch TV for the day.

Adora's POV

The next day, I was chatting with Bow and Glimmer in the hallway. I noticed Catra walking down the hall. I gave her a smirk, but it slowly disappeared when I noticed a change of emotion in her face. "Hey, Catra."

"Hey, buddy." She nodded as she continued walking past. *What the fuck?*

Hey, buddy? HEY, BUDDY? So she's just being a brat, then. It's clear she's not being serious about my feelings. I felt a wave of annoyance wash through me. I slammed my locker shut, which startled Bow and Glimmer. "Whoa, Adora. Are you oka--" I cut Bow off.

"I'm heading to class."

...

I arrived at class, and I spotted Catra in her usual seat. Unlucky for me at this point, they're assigned. I sat down next to Catra, not giving any of my attention towards her. I started pulling my stuff out, and I felt a tap on my shoulder, but I shrugged it off. "Adora? You okay?"

I scoffed, "Oh, yeah. I'm doing amazing, buddy." I shot her a glare until my gaze went back to my book. Catra was pretty much silent for the rest of the class after that.

Halfway through the lesson, there was a note that appeared in front of me. I shot a glance over to Catra, who just gave me a concerned look. I opened the note to it, saying, "Are you okay?" I wanted to write back, but I chose to ignore it again. I focused on the rest of the lesson.

Once the bell rang, I quickly packed my stuff up and left the room before Catra could stop me. I've never felt so mad in my life. I headed straight to the football field to clear my head by practising shooting goals.

"Adora!" I turned to see Mermista. I felt my shoulders drop; it was like relief.

"Hey, Mermista." I smiled, picking up the soccer ball. "Why are you here?"

"Well, Bow and Glimmer seemed worried about you, but didn't wanna annoy you or whatever." She said in her usual monotone voice. "So, what's happening with you?"

I sighed, "Okay, it stays between us for now. So, I told this girl I like her, and she said she feels the same way. And literally yesterday, we were making out on my couch!" Mermista gives me an intrigued look but doesn't interrupt, "But this morning, I said hello to her, but she completely ignored me and responded with, *'Hey, buddy.'* Like what the fuck?"

Mermista nodded, "Yeah, that's annoying. Maybe she's... I don't know, ashamed about something?" She suggested.

"What? Of me?" I glared at her.

"Didn't say that! But maybe this is something you should confront her about. Are you positive she likes you?"

"Yeah, I just... I'll talk to her," I mumbled and kicked the ball into the net.

"I'll see you later, Adora. I hope things go well." She smiled and walked off.

I grabbed my bag and sprayed deodorant on, getting ready for my next class. Thankfully, I'm not stuck with Catra. I guess it gives me time to think about how I'm going to approach her...

Chapter End Notes

Hope you enjoyed this chapter! Another one is coming soon ;)

Chapter 9: Chapter 9

Chapter Summary

First Catradora fight..?

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora's POV:

I was sitting with Bow and Glimmer for the study group, and my mind was still trying to unravel what had happened today with Catra. I didn't get it. She was fine yesterday. We confessed our feelings and had a makeout session on the couch. When I got back from the hangout with Bow and Glimmer, we just sat down on the couch and watched a movie, then split off to head to bed. What happened? Why did she feel so distant this morning and call me buddy? I mean, sure, I wasn't expecting a "Hey, hot stuff" or anything, but *buddy* really hurt.

"Adora?"

I was still spiralling in my thoughts to register anyone talking to me.

"ADORA!" Glimmer shook my shoulders.

Now that got me back to reality, Glimmer was always known to be aggressive, but damn. "Sorry, I zoned out. What's up?"

"Seriously, what is up with you? You've been distant and upset all day."

I paused for a moment. I knew I could tell them anything, but I didn't know how to talk about the situation with Catra just yet. Considering she just called me buddy in front of them. "It's just... I don't know, crush issues or something." I shrugged.

This made Glimmer squeal, "Adora! You have a crush?! And didn't tell me!?" She started shaking my arms.

"Glim, personal space, remember? And good for you, Adora." Bow smiled.

I let out a soft chuckle, "I would say 'thank you' but it's just complicated at the moment." I rest my head in my hand.

"Wanna talk about it?" Glimmer looked at me with a softer expression.

Okay, Adora. If I were to tell them, I would need to do it in a way that doesn't expose Catra. They heard the buddy situation this morning, so if I tell them what made me upset, they would figure it out straight away. "I'm just confused about how she feels."

"Hm, well. Only if you want, can you tell us what makes you confused?" Bow smiled.

I took a deep breath, "To put it quickly, we both confessed our feelings to each other. She said she likes me back. But then she just... I don't know, become distant the next day? It's just confusing."

Bow nods, "Maybe try talking to her later? Maybe even ask Catra for advice? I'm sure she will help."

I almost burst out laughing when he suggested Catra. Sure, I'll ask the person who I'm talking about for advice. "Yeah, I'll do that."

They both gave me a smile and a nod.

We continued studying after that, and I started counting down the minutes. I just wanted to talk to Catra now.

I arrived back at the dorm and saw Catra lying down on the couch, scrolling through her phone. I decided to get it over and done with now; otherwise, I would dwell on it too long.

"Hey," I started quietly. "I feel like we should talk."

Catra sat up on the couch, putting her phone down. "Sure... About what?"

I felt annoyed straight away. "Don't play dumb. Yesterday we told each other how we feel, and today you walk past me like I'm just some random friend. Do you have any idea how confusing that is?" I snapped, a little harsher than I intended.

Catra shifted, gaze falling to the floor. "I didn't mean to hurt you. I just… said hi."

"'Hey, buddy,'" I chuckled, my voice tightening. "That's not *hi*. That's you pretending we're nothing."

Catra flinched, but her reply was quick, defensive. "It's not like that."

"Then what is it like?" I asked, starting to feel frustrated. "Because from where I was standing, it looked a hell of a lot like you couldn't get away from me fast enough."

Catra pushed up from the couch and paced a few steps. "It's not you, okay? It's… It's complicated."

I scoffed, arms crossing. "Complicated? What does that even mean?"

"I just—" Catra dragged a hand through her hair, voice cracking with anger. "I just don't want someone to find out."

A froze, blinking. "What? So you just don't wanna be seen with me? I don't get it."

Silence.

Catra's mouth opened, then shut again, jaw tightening. "I can't… I can't explain."

The words landed like a slap. My eyes narrowed. "You can't *explain*? To me? The person you confessed to?" I let out another scoff. "God, do you even mean what you said yesterday, or was that just some joke to you?" I snapped.

Catra's head snapped up, her eyes blazing with anger. "Of course I meant it! Don't you dare say I didn't." She sounded hurt.

"Then prove it!" I shouted, stepping closer. "Because right now, all I see is you hiding me like I'm something you're ashamed of."

"I'm not ashamed of you!" Catra roared back, her voice echoing in the small room. "I just—" She cut herself off, fists clenched, chest heaving.

I just stared, stunned by the outburst, then shook my head slowly. "You won't even finish the sentence." My voice broke, quieter now but still edged with hurt. "And you wonder why I don't know how you really feel."

Catra turned away, shoulders tight; it looked like words were stuck in her throat. "It's Weaver." Words finally left her mouth.

I stood there, feeling like an idiot for yelling at her, "But, how would she even find out?"

Catra let out a sigh, "I might be paranoid, okay? But if you grew up with that *monster,* then you would understand why I'm so scared."

"Catra..." I looked at her with sad eyes.

"Listen, she is pretty good about finding out about stuff. She monitors my social accounts to make sure I'm not doing anything wrong. She'll go through your account and any of my friends' accounts to see if she can catch me doing something." She rambled, "If she finds out I'm gay, it's over for me. And I'm not being dramatic about it; she's made it very clear. And if everyone from our school finds out about us, it WILL spread since you're a popular jock." She scoffed.

I nodded, "I'm sorry, I shouldn't have snapped at you so quickly."

"No... It's fine. I understand why you were so pissed. As soon as I said it this morning, I immediately regretted it. But I just freaked out, and that was the first thing that flew out of my mouth." She chuckled slightly.

I smirked, "You could've just said 'Hey, Adora.' You know?"

"I knowwww." She whined. "I just panicked, I felt like everyone's eyes were on me in the hallway. And it's dumb because I've hung out with your friend group before, so I don't know why I freaked out then."

"Maybe because we told each other how we felt? So you had that pressure on you as well?" I shrugged. It was quiet for a moment until I pulled her into a hug. "I'm sorry for yelling at you."

"It's fine, dummy." She nuzzled her face into my neck.

An idea popped into my head, "So, crazy idea.." I smirked and pulled away.

Catra raised her eyebrow, "What?"

"What if we just secretly dated? You know, like in 'To All The Boys I've Loved Before.'" I grinned.

Catra stared at me dumbfoundedly, "Do I even wanna know what that movie is?"

"Okay, we're definitely watching those movies," I smirked.

Catra lets out a long groan, "I am NOT watching a dumb straight couple romcom movie."

"Please? It's so good!" I whined.

Catra sighed while looking at me. I was putting on puppy eyes. "How many movies are there?" She crossed her arms.

I smirked slightly, "Three?"

"THREE?" Catra groaned.

I laughed, "You'll enjoy it! It's sweet!" I pulled her hands closer to me, kissing the back of her palm. "I'll even buy takeaway tonight."

Catra smiled softly, "Fine, we can watch it."

I kissed her excitedly and started scrolling on my phone to order takeaway. I didn't even realise the flustered look on Catra's face.

We were both sitting on the couch watching the film while eating sushi. We had a blanket wrapped around us. I noticed Catra was glued to the film, and I was proud. It was a sweet moment that I wanted to hold on to forever. Now and then, I would glance at her and see how the TV light reflected on her face.

"Why are they actually cute together? I'm supposed to hate straight couples." She groaned.

I let out a laugh, "I told you that you would like it."

"Whatever," she smirked. "Also, I think you misunderstood what secret dating meant."

I looked at her, confused, "What do you mean?"

"You said earlier, what if we secretly dated like in 'To All The Boys I've Loved Before?' They're fake-dating." She laughed.

I rolled my eyes, "Ugh, I got confused!"

"Clearly."

"Wait! I can redeem myself!" I chuckled.

Catra just rolled her eyes, "What?"

"Chandler and Monica in Friends, boom. They were in a secret relationship." I smirked.

Catra chuckled. "Okay... Sure."

We continued watching the movie. Once Catra finished her dinner, she rested her head on my shoulder. I felt warmth inside. I never wanted to leave this moment. "So, a secret relationship starting now?"

Catra chuckled, "Starting now."

Chapter End Notes

Sorry if this chapter felt short!

I hope you enjoyed this chapter! :)

This is my first fanfic, so I'm open to hearing any feedback.

Chapter 10: Chapter 10

Chapter Summary

Just a sweet little chapter with these two lovebirds ;)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra's POV

I was lying on my bed, reading some random spicy romance novel that Scorpia recommended to me. I never thought I would be so into it, nor did I even think Scorpia reads this kind of book. But it's addicting, I don't think I've read this much. I heard a knock on my door, I quickly shoved my bookmark into the page and hid the book under my pillow before Adora walked in.

"Hey, Catra! I was just wondering if you've seen my-" She cuts herself off and just stares at me, and looks flustered. Damn, I haven't even done anything yet. "Glasses- You're wearing glasses, why?" She stuttered.

Ohh, I forgot she gets so damn flustered over my glasses. "I was... Reading something." I tried to act nonchalant.

Adora raised her eyebrow, "There's no book in front of you though...?"

Shit. "I was reading something on my phone." I quickly replied.

"But your phone is on your desk here... What are you hiding?" Adora smirked and approached me. I started getting flustered. She's definitely putting on her cocky persona. "I'm curious." She towered over me as I lay on the bed.

"I... Um."

"You look so hot with your glasses on, have I told you that?" She leans down towards me.

"You're such an idiot." I chuckled, trying to push her off.

She looked like she was about to say something until she spotted something under my pillow. "What's this?" Shit. I watch her grab the book, and I immediately pounce over to her, trying to reach for the book. "Whoa, down girl." She smirked as she raised her arm higher.

"Adora! Give it back!" I whined, trying to pull her arm down to grab the book.

She pinned me down on the bed, which caught me entirely off guard and made me forget what I was supposed to be doing. She straddled my hips, her thighs on each side as she examined the book. "Whoa, who knew you were so into... spicy novels." She smirked.

"Ugh! I'm not! This is literally the first time I've read those. Scorpia made me read one." I protested.

"Sure." She smirked, obviously not buying it.

"I'm serious!" I playfully smacked her arm. "I started reading it, but I didn't expect to get so invested in it; it's embarrassing." I groaned as I covered my face.

Adora let out a soft chuckle and placed the book back on the pillow. She then moved my hands away from my face so she could look at me, "I think it's cute."

"I am NOT cute." I glared at her.

She scoffed, "Uh, yeah, you are." She started getting off me, and I sat myself up. "Anyways, I was gonna ask if you've seen my hoodie? It's the white one with golden sleeves?"

Oh, I knew where it was. I might've stolen it last night when she went for a shower, I couldn't help it. "I have no clue what you're talking about."

Adora gave me a look, "Catra."

"Adora."

"Do you have my hoodie?" She stood in front of me and crossed her arms.

"...Maybe," I shrugged. "It was comfy."

Adora just rolled her eyes but didn't bother to argue about it, "Whatever, I'll deal with you later. We need to get to class."

I groaned but complied. I got up and walked over to my dresser to retrieve the clothes I needed for the day. I turned to see Adora still in my room, reading the back of the book. "Uh, why are you reading the back?"

"Can I borrow this after you're done? Sounds interesting." Adora smiled.

I just shrugged and started getting dressed, "Yeah, I don't care. I'll let you know when I'm done." I put on a bra and a new shirt while facing away from Adora, but I could feel her eyes piercing into my back, and I didn't mind at all.

She cleared her throat, "Yeah, I... I'll wait for you outside." She chuckled nervously.

I smirked to myself, "Whatever, dork. I'll be done in a minute."

Math class. Numbers everywhere. Equations sprawled across the board like some secret code only geniuses and masochists cared about. I twirled my pencil between my fingers, staring at the worksheet like it might solve itself. It didn't... Next to me, Adora was already halfway down the page, scribbling away with perfect

posture and neat handwriting. Her forehead was creased in concentration, her hand steady, like this was second nature to her. Classic Adora. She turns into a completely different person when we're in classes together; she's too focused on her work to keep up with a cocky attitude... It's adorable.

I leaned over and whispered, “So, what’s the answer to number three?”

She didn’t even look at me. “Try it yourself.”

“I did,” I said, doodling a cat in the corner of my page. “The answer is apparently ‘a cat.’”

Her pencil froze. She glanced at my paper, then back at me, and I caught the way her lips twitched. “That’s not even close.”

“Depends on your perspective,” I muttered, shading the tail. “Art is subjective.”

She shook her head, trying to look serious, but I could see the laugh she was holding back. I squinted at the board, frowning at the mess of numbers the teacher had scrawled. My eyes were starting to blur, so with a sigh, I dug into my bag and slipped on my glasses. Adora’s pencil slowed instantly. I caught her in the corner of my eye—she was staring.

I smirked. “What?”

Her cheeks flushed red. “N-nothing.” She ducked her head, suddenly scribbling furiously in her notebook like her life depended on it.

“Uh-huh,” I said, leaning closer, lowering my voice. “You’ve got that look. The one that screams, ‘Catra looks way too good in glasses.’ I mean, I did see it this morning, remember?"

Her whole face turned red. “I did not think that.”

I grinned. “Oh, so you did think something."

She groaned, pressing her forehead against her hand. “Why do you do this to me?”

“Because it’s fun.” I tapped her notebook with my pencil. “And because you’re cute when you get all flustered.”

Her eyes shot up, wide and warning, but her cheeks stayed bright pink. “Focus,” she whispered fiercely, though her voice was trembling slightly.

“On math, or on you?” I teased, pushing my glasses up the bridge of my nose for extra effect.

She let out a sound that was half groan, half laugh, and shoved my arm lightly. “You’re impossible.”

“And yet,” I said, bumping her knee under the desk, “you’re still sitting here.”

She nudged me back, eyes darting everywhere but at me. My chest did that stupid fluttery thing, the one I always pretended wasn’t real. The teacher kept talking and explaining equations to a few students. Adora was pretending to be focused, but I could see her sneaking glances at me, always looking away the second I caught her. I adjusted my glasses again to watch her bite her lip and look away, trying to focus. By the end of class, she’d filled two pages with perfect notes, and I had… a cat doodle, three half-finished equations, and the satisfaction of knowing I’d successfully flustered her the entire period.

Worth it.

Lunch was always chaos. The cafeteria was packed, the noise bouncing off the walls—laughter, shouting, trays clattering. I grabbed mine and headed toward our usual table, where the rest of the group had already claimed a spot. Mermista was slouched across two chairs, as if she owned them. Perfuma was arranging

her food to resemble some miniature garden. Glimmer and Bow were arguing over something on his phone. Sea Hawk was dramatically gesturing with his sandwich, as if retelling some heroic tale. And then there was Adora, sitting across the table, sunlight hitting her hair in that way that always made my chest do something weird.

I slid into the seat beside her, casually close but not *too* close. Couldn't make it obvious.

"Finally," Glimmer said, rolling her eyes. "Thought you were gonna ditch again."

"Relax, Sparkles," I muttered, stealing a fry off Adora's tray before she could stop me. "I wouldn't miss all this fun."

Adora swatted at my hand, cheeks a little pink. "Get your own."

"Yours tastes better." I popped the fry into my mouth, smirking when she gave me that exasperated look that was more fond than angry.

Perfuma leaned forward, watching us with a soft smile. "You two bicker like siblings. It's adorable."

I almost choked on the fry. Adora coughed into her drink. "Uh—siblings?" she said, voice a little higher than usual.

Perfuma nodded, all innocence. "Mmhm. That whole push-pull dynamic? Very sibling energy."

If only she knew. I had to bite my lip to keep from laughing. Adora kicked me under the table, eyes wide, like she was begging me not to say anything stupid. Bow was too busy showing Glimmer a meme to notice. Sea Hawk was still mid-saga about his "legendary victory" over some vending machine. Crisis averted.

I leaned closer to Adora, just enough that no one else would notice, and whispered, "Sibling energy, huh?"

Her blush deepened. “Don’t start.”

“Oh, I’m definitely starting,” I murmured, brushing my knee against hers under the table. She jumped slightly, quickly focusing on her sandwich as if it were suddenly the most fascinating thing in the world.

Mermista glanced up lazily. “Why are you smiling like an idiot, Adora?”

Adora nearly dropped her sandwich. “I-I’m not!”

“Yeah, you are.” Mermista yawned. “It’s weird.”

“I’m just… happy,” Adora stammered. “Is that a crime?”

I almost burst out laughing. I covered it with a cough, stabbing at my food while sneaking a glance at her. She was still red, still glaring at me like this was my fault, which—okay, maybe it was.

Perfuma hummed, setting a flower on her tray like it was a garnish. “It’s nice. We should all smile more.”

“Exactly,” I said, leaning back in my chair, smug. “See? Nothing weird about Adora smiling.” Adora shot me a look that promised vengeance later, but her knee stayed pressed against mine under the table. She didn’t move it away, even while Sea Hawk launched into another story about “the time he wrestled a kraken.” I just rolled my eyes as I listened to him, even though everyone knows he's bullshitting.

"Oh, whatever. Krakens aren't even real Sea Hawk." Glimmer giggled.

"Nonsense! They are very real!" He shouted.

Everyone just laughed and continued eating their food. I watched Adora talk to Bow and Glimmer; she never has a bad side. I could stare at her for ages, but I eventually snapped out of it as I realised where I am. I suddenly became more interested in Sea

Hawk's bullshit story. Honestly, I just zoned out until the bell rang.

We all got up, and I felt a tug on my arm. I look over to see Adora giving me a smirk, "All the teasing you've been doing to me today... Just wait until we get back to our room." She murmured into my ear. I felt goosebumps run across my arms. I looked at her in shock as she smirked and walked off to her next class.

Damn, princess.

Chapter End Notes

Feeling like spoiling you guys, so I'm planning to give you an extra chapter tomorrow! ;)

Chapter 11: Chapter 11

Chapter Summary

> Be aware... there's a bit of smut.
>
> Feel free to skip it! It starts at "Catra," I smirked, knowing very well what she wanted," and finishes at the start of the next section. :)
>
> Just a nice fluff chapter with a bit of spice! Don't worry, though, it will get intense soon ;)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora's POV:

Catra was a pain in my ass today, of course, she uses her advantage to tease me when I'm trying to concentrate during class. I was planning several different ways to get her back to our dorm later. In the meantime, I was busy practising my passing. Mermista always seems to find a way into my head; it's like she knows what I'm thinking or feeling without even trying.

"What's up your ass?" She smirked as she kicked the soccer ball over to me.

I snapped out of my thoughts, "Oh, nothing. Just planning revenge in my head." I kicked the ball back to her.

She had an unamused face, but then again, she never has many facial expressions. "Hm, interesting." She passed the ball back. "So, how did everything go with that girl?"

I froze for a second, looking at her. I quickly brought myself back to earth so I didn't look like an idiot, "Oh, it went fine. Just deciding to take things slow." It wasn't a massive lie... I mean, sure, I am in a relationship, but no one can know right now. Until Catra and I figure something out.

"When do I get to meet her?" She said in her regular brooding tone.

I kicked the ball over to her, "Probably not for a while, we're just figuring things out."

Mermista decided to leave me alone after that, and our coach blew her whistle, causing both of us to startle. She assigned us to run some laps and more workout drills; my legs are gonna kill me tomorrow.

By the time I got back to the dorm, my muscles were buzzing from practice, my shirt clinging to my back with sweat. I tossed my bag by the door, already thinking about a shower—until I caught sight of her.

Catra.

She was standing at the stove, hair tied up in a messy bun, sleeves of my old hoodie rolled up as she stirred something in a pan. The smell of garlic and onion filled the air, making my stomach growl, but it wasn’t the food that held my attention. It was *her*—the sway of her hips, the slight hum under her breath, the way she looked so damn at home in my clothes.

And after everything she’d put me through today, all I wanted was a little payback.

I leaned against the doorway, arms folded. “Well, well. Didn’t know you were such a chef.”

She jumped a little, then shot me a glare over her shoulder. “Don’t sneak up on me like that.”

“You didn’t hear me because you were too busy being cute,” I said, pushing off the door and striding closer.

Her cheeks flushed, but she turned back to the pan quickly. “Yeah, okay. Keep dreaming, and I am NOT cute."

I smirked. Slipping in behind her, I planted a hand on the counter beside her hip, leaning in so close my breath brushed her ear. “Mmm, smells good,” I murmured, lowering my voice. “But not as good as you do.”

The spoon clattered against the pan when her hand slipped. “Adora…” she muttered, like a warning, though her voice had dropped too.

“Payback,” I whispered, grinning as my other hand skimmed the side of her hoodie. “So, there's the hoodie I was looking for this morning. I gotta say it looks cute on you.”

She tilted her head, a smirk tugging at her lips. “So this is revenge?”

“Mhm.” I ducked my head, lips brushing just close enough to make her shiver. “How am I doing?”

Her breath hitched. Just the tiniest sound, but I caught it. I tugged gently at the hood until she looked at me. For once, she didn’t have a comeback ready—her smirk faltered. "I need to finish dinner." She muttered.

I rolled my eyes, "Fine, this isn't over yet." I walked off to the bathroom to have a quick shower before dinner.

...

We finished eating way too fast. I wasn't sure if it was because practice had left me hungry or because the food was actually that good. Probably both. Catra stacked her empty plate on mine with a smirk. "Since I cooked, you're on dish duty."

I raised an eyebrow. "That's not how this works."

She tilted her head, chin propped on her hand. "Uh, yeah, it is. Cook or clean. Pick one. You got sweaty running around with a ball for two hours, so congrats—you're the cleaner."

"You know, you'd make a great dictator," I said, grabbing the plates anyway.

"I'll take that as a compliment," she purred, trailing after me to the sink.

The water hissed to life as I started rinsing dishes. I felt her slide in next to me, leaning against the counter like she had nothing better to do. Her shoulder brushed mine—deliberately, because Catra never did *anything* by accident. "You're not even helping," I said, scrubbing at a plate.

"I helped earlier," she said smugly. "With the important part. You know, the *cooking*. Which you can't do to save your life."

I shot her a look over my shoulder. "I can cook."

"Instant noodles don't count." She countered. I snorted, flicking a few droplets of water in her direction. She squeaked, swatting at me. "Hey!"

"That's what you get for insulting my cooking skills," I said, smirking as I rinsed another plate. Catra narrowed her eyes, then slowly reached over, dipped her fingers into the running water, and flicked them right back at me. A cold splash hit my cheek. I gasped. "Oh, it's on."

Her grin was wicked. "Bring it."

For the next thirty seconds, it devolved into us flicking water at each other like children. The counter got soaked, the dish towel ended up on the floor, and I was laughing so hard I nearly dropped a glass. Finally, I grabbed her wrist mid-splash and tugged her closer. “Alright, truce.”

She smirked, her face inches from mine. “What, can’t handle me?”

“Not the words I’d use,” I said, voice low, still holding her wrist. I didn’t let go right away. Her eyes flicked to mine, sharp and amused, daring me to make a move. I leaned in, close enough that my breath brushed her cheek. “Payback’s not over yet, you know.”

“Good,” she said, tugging her wrist free with a sly grin. “Wouldn’t want you to get lazy.” She turned back toward the table, leaving me standing at the sink, heart pounding and cheeks hot. Somehow, she always managed to twist my own game back on me. I groaned and finished up the dishes.

Once I finished, I got started on some homework before bed. I glanced over to Catra. She was lounging on the couch for a while, flipping through her phone like nothing had happened. I tried to focus on homework, but every time I looked at her, she slouched there in *my* hoodie, legs curled under her.

It was late by the time we finally made our way to her room. She kicked off her socks and crawled into her bed like it was any other night. I jumped into her bed next to her, which made her startle.

She looked at me like I had grown another head. “Adora. That’s not your bed.”

“I know.” I shot her a cocky smirk.

She shifted onto her back, arms folding behind her head like she wasn’t the least bit bothered. “What do you think you’re doing?”

“Collecting my revenge,” I said smoothly, bracing one hand on the mattress beside her shoulder.

She snorted. “You’ve been saying that all day, but I don’t see it happening.”

My lips quirked. “You want proof?”

“Maybe I do,” she said, her voice low, challenging.

That was all I needed. I swung one leg over and straddled her, pinning her in place. She tensed beneath me, not in protest but in surprise. Her smirk faltered for half a second before sliding back into place, sharper now.

“Bold move,” she murmured. “Didn’t think you had it in you.”

I leaned down until my nose brushed hers, until I felt her breath against my lips. "Hm, I thought I made it clear at lunch that I was gonna get payback."

Her hands twitched against the sheets, like she couldn’t decide whether to shove me off or grab me closer. “That so?” she said finally, her voice a little rougher now.

“Mhm.” I pressed my forehead against hers. “You’ve had me flustered all day. Now it’s your turn.”

The silence stretched, hot and heavy between us. Then, slowly, her smirk softened into something else. "Adora..." She looked at me, filled with desire.

"Catra," I smirked, knowing very well what she wanted.

She scoffed and pulled my shirt towards her, smashing her lips onto my own. I was caught off guard at first, but quickly melted into it. Her hand ran through my hair while the other one was placed on my waist. She was hungry, and I couldn't lie and say that I wasn't either. I ran my hand up her shirt, realising she had

no bra on. She let out a soft moan that pretty much fueled me even more.

"This okay?" I murmured into her lips.

She nodded in response. I cupped my hand around her boob; she let out a soft groan at the touch. I could tell her nipples were sensitive. I used my thumb to make a circle motion around it, causing her hips to jerk upwards. I chuckled and kissed my way down to her neck. I could hear her breathing heavily into my ear.

"Adora, fuck." She grunted.

I slowly started nibbling at her neck, she gripped onto my shirt, and her hips buckled up once more. I repositioned myself and placed my knee between her legs, pressing up against her crotch. She let out a louder moan, and I felt her slowly starting to grind on my knee, and it was driving me wild.

I tugged on the hoodie, "Can I take this off?" I pushed myself up so I could see her face.

"Please." She muttered.

I wasted no time; she sat up a bit while I dragged the hoodie off. She wasn't wearing a shirt underneath, and I was greeted with her bare chest staring at me. "You're so beautiful, Catra." I leaned down to kiss her chest, making my way down to her tits. I felt her pulling my shirt off as well, I chuckled and sat myself up with my arms raised so it was easier to pull off. She looked at me in awe, "Cat got your tongue?" I smirked.

"Shut up, princess." She said, still staring at me.

I smirked and pushed my knee up, causing her to yelp in surprise. "That's not a nice way to talk, *wildcat.*"

She stared at me for a brief second, "How did you--"

"Know about the nickname? I saw your friend Scorpia call you it in one of your Instagram posts." I smirked, "I've just been waiting for the right time to tease you with it."

She groaned, and I leaned back down to kiss her neck. She dug her nails into my back as she continued to grind on my knee. I used my free hand to pin her hips down in place, causing her to groan in annoyance. "Not yet," I muttered, sliding my hand down to her waistband. "Okay?" I looked at her for approval.

"Yeah." She panted.

I smashed my lips against hers, sliding my hand down to be greeted with wetness. "Fuck, Catra," I muttered into her lips.

I started to use my fingers to slide onto her clit, she moaned at the sudden touch and dug her nails into my back again. I grunted at the pain, but it felt good in a way. I started to motion my fingers; her hips buckled up as she moaned into my mouth, pulling away from the kiss. As I started going faster, I could tell she was at her breaking point.

"Adora, shit. I'm gonna-"

"Let it happen," I whispered into her ear, picking up the pace with my fingers.

Loud moans started leaving her lips, her nails scratching my back in pleasure. I started slowing down as I watched her come undone. We were both breathing heavily, looking at each other for a while. "Wow," she managed to let out.

I just chuckled, kissing her forehead. "Wow, indeed."

There was another pause before she smirked at me, "Your turn?"

I smirked as she pushed me off, switching our positions. "Thought you'd never ask."

Sunlight was already creeping through the blinds when I woke up. My body ached in the best way, muscles heavy but loose, like I'd just come out of a long, perfect stretch. For once, I wasn't sprawled across my own bed. I was tangled up in Catra's.

She was still asleep, her hair a complete mess, one arm flung across my stomach as if she'd claimed me as hers in the night. Her hoodie—my hoodie—was crumpled on the floor, along with several other articles of clothing.

I lay there for a minute, just staring at her. The rise and fall of her chest, the way her lips parted slightly when she breathed, the faint crease between her brows, even in sleep. She looked peaceful, though—calm in a way I almost never got to see. I couldn't resist. I brushed a strand of hair out of her face, letting my fingers linger against her cheek. Her eyes cracked open immediately. Sharp, even half-asleep. Typical Catra.

"You're staring," she muttered, her voice rough with sleep.

"Maybe I am," I said softly, grinning.

She stretched like a cat, arching into me before flopping back down with a groan. "You're too chipper for this hour. Didn't I tire you out last night?"

Heat crept up my neck, but I refused to give her the satisfaction. "Please. If anyone was worn out, it was you."

Her smirk appeared, slow and lazy, like she had all the time in the world. "Big talk for someone who couldn't keep her hands off me."

I rolled my eyes, but I was smiling. "You make it sound like you weren't just as bad."

"Mm." She shifted closer, her nose brushing my collarbone. "Guess we'll call it even."

The room was quiet except for our breathing and the faint hum of the heater. It should’ve felt strange, waking up tangled together like this, the night before still humming in the air. But it didn’t. It felt… natural. I pressed a kiss to the top of her head. “Morning, kitcat.”

She groaned into my chest. “Don’t get all sappy on me. And don't ever call me that again."

“Too late,” I whispered, pulling her tighter against me.

"As much as I would love to stay like this, we have to get ready for school." She murmured into my chest.

I let out a long groan, "Fine." I sat up in the bed, grabbing my clothes off the ground to cover up.

"Well, there goes my view," Catra grumbled.

I flipped her off and started making my way to my room. "You want breakfast?" I turned to face her before heading out.

"That'd be nice, thanks." She smiled.

...

I was dressed and ready for the day. I padded into the kitchen, poured out two bowls of cereal, and dropped a couple of spoons in. It wasn’t exactly a gourmet breakfast, but after last night, I figured a simple one would do. “Breakfast is ready,” I called over my shoulder.

From the other room, I heard a muffled groan. “If it’s cereal, it doesn’t count as breakfast.”

I smirked, setting the bowls on the table. “Oh, so suddenly you’re a critic? Didn’t hear you complaining when I carried you to bed last night.”

That got her moving. She shuffled into the kitchen, hair sticking up in every direction. She plopped into the chair across from me and squinted at the cereal like it had personally offended her. “This is your idea of post-game recovery?” she asked, poking at it with her spoon.

“It’s efficient,” I said, grinning as I took a bite. “Besides, you weren’t exactly in any shape to cook.”

Her eyes narrowed, but the corner of her mouth tugged up. “Careful, Blondie. Keep talking like that, and you’ll have to prove it again tonight.”

I choked on my cereal, coughing into my hand while she smirked. "You suck." I managed to get out between coughs.

We finished our breakfast and headed to school.

...

It was a boring day. Catra and I only had one class together. After lunch, Catra disappeared, which was random. I saw her head off in front of me, but she must have vanished into the crowd. I went to my locker to grab a few books for my next class before heading off. The hallways between classes were packed, students crisscrossing in every direction, chatter and footsteps echoing against the lockers. I was walking with my books balanced against my hip, Adora beside me, when I felt a sharp tug on my wrist.

“Catra—?” I started, but she was already dragging me out of the flow of people.

Before I could protest, she yanked open the door to an empty classroom and pulled me inside. The door clicked shut behind us.

I blinked in the dim light, still clutching my books. “What are you __”

Her mouth was on mine before I could finish.

The books slipped from my arms, hitting the desk with a dull thud as she backed me against the wall, her fingers curling into my collar. I gasped against her lips, surprised by how rough and sudden she was being, but then my hands found her waist, and the shock melted into something hotter, hungrier.

"Catra," I murmured between kisses, my voice shaky with a laugh. "What's gotten into you?"

"You." She smirked against my mouth, then kissed me again, this time with more force.

Her body pressed flush against mine, her hands sliding up to cup my jaw like she couldn't get enough. I tilted my head, letting her deepen the kiss, my fingers tightening on her hips until she let out a quiet sound that made my stomach twist in the best way.

"You're blushing," she teased, brushing her nose against mine.

"You dragged me in here out of nowhere," I shot back breathlessly. "What did you expect?"

Her smirk softened into something more dangerous. "I expected this." She kissed me again, slower now, savouring it. "And I was right."

The bell rang in the distance, muffled through the walls, but neither of us moved.

I smiled against her lips. "We're gonna be late."

"Worth it," she whispered.

Moments later, the doorknob rattled.

We both froze. My heart leapt into my throat, and before I could even gasp, Catra's hand shot up to cover my mouth. Her eyes were wide, sharp, no trace of her usual smug grin, just pure panic. We stood perfectly still, every muscle locked tight.

Outside, someone groaned. “Why is this one locked? Ugh, whatever, let’s go to the other lab.”

Footsteps shuffled away. Voices faded. Silence wrapped around us again. Catra held her breath another second longer before finally pulling her hand from my mouth, exhaling hard. “Shit,” she muttered, her voice low and tight. “That was too close.”

I stared at her, still pressed against the wall, adrenaline buzzing through me. Her hair was a mess, her cheeks flushed, and she was visibly rattled in a way I almost never saw. The absurdity of it hit me all at once. My hand flew up to cover my mouth, but it was useless—laughter burst out of me anyway, sharp and uncontrollable.

Catra’s head whipped toward me, eyes narrowing. “What the hell are you laughing at?”

I doubled over slightly, trying to catch my breath. “Y-Your face!” Another laugh broke out. “You looked like you were about to die!”

Her glare lasted all of three seconds before her own laugh slipped. She shoved my shoulder, grinning despite herself. “You’re such an idiot.”

"We should really get to class. See you later." I chuckled and kissed her lips.

"See you, princess." She smiled softly as she watched me leave.

Chapter End Notes

Hope you enjoyed this chapter! I will post again next weekend. Also I'm not too into writing smut but I do make sure not make it boring for some people!

Thank you for the kudos and for reading this chapter! :)

Chapter 12: Chapter 12

Chapter Summary

Weaver is being a bitch once again, causing Catra to shut down from Adora...

TW: emotional abuse.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra's POV:

It's been a few weeks since Adora and I started secretly dating, and things have been amazing. I've never felt this happy in my life. I never thought I would even see Adora again, nor date her. I was writing some lyrics in my room since Adora had soccer practice, and I heard my phone go off. The results were sent out for our recent math exam, and I felt my heart drop immediately because all I remembered from the test was me blanking out. If I got a bad result, it would not go well with me because of Weaver.

I took a deep breath and opened the email, scrolling through and opening the results. The screen showed "D." I nearly dropped the phone out of my hands, and my heart started pounding so loud that I could hear it in my head. I wanted to scream or throw my phone across the room, not long after my phone started ringing. The screen read "Bitch Weaver." I knew exactly what it was about; there's no way it could be a coincidence that she hasn't seen it yet, and she's just calling to check in. I took a deep breath and swiped to answer the call.

"H–hello?" I whispered.

"Don't 'hello' me, Catra." Weaver's voice was sharp, cutting through me like a knife. "I just got a call from your teacher. Care

to explain why you failed your math test?”

My eyes dropped to the half-finished songwriting on my desk, the words swimming in a blur. I swallowed hard. “I… I tried, Weaver. I studied, I swear. It was just—”

“You *studied?* Don’t lie to me.” Her voice grew harsher, every word like a slap. “Do you have any idea how humiliating this is? You’re at that school to prove you’re worth something, but all you do is disappoint. Lazy, careless—pathetic.”

I gripped the edge of the desk so tightly my knuckles turned white. My chest felt heavy, tight, like I couldn’t get enough air. “I’ll do better,” I whispered.

“You *better,*” she hissed. “Or I will make you regret it.”

The line went dead with a sharp click.

Just like that, I broke down. I felt my chest tightening as sobs left my body, and I got out of my chair and sat on the floor, curling up into a ball. I immediately grabbed my phone; my hands were shaking badly. I called Scorpia. I held the phone up to my ear until she answered.

"Hey, Wildcat! I haven't heard from you in a bit. How are you?" The familiar cheery voice spoke into my ear.

I tried getting words out, but they got caught in my throat, and only a sob escaped.

"Wildcat? Are you okay!?" Scorpia's voice changed from happy to concerned in a matter of seconds.

"It's... I just." I choked out.

I heard a sigh come through the phone, "I'm coming down tomorrow, I'm gonna take you out for lunch."

"You don't need to drive that far..." I let out a sad chuckle.

"Don't be ridiculous, I wanna see you anyway. It's been so long!" She picked up her cheery voice again.

I shook my head and laughed, "Okay."

...

The little bell above the café door jingled as I pushed it open. I spotted Scorpia immediately—she was waving both arms like I might somehow miss her.

“Catra! Over here!” she called, loud enough for the whole place to hear.

I rolled my eyes but couldn’t help smiling a little. I slid into the booth across from her, setting my bag down on the seat beside me. “Subtle as always.”

“Hey, you found me, didn’t you?” she said, grinning widely. There was already an empty mug on her side of the table. “Okay, I *might* have had one hot chocolate while I was waiting, but don’t worry, I saved room for another.”

“Yeah, sure. I’ll believe that when I see it.” I ordered a latte when the barista came by, then leaned back. For a moment, I just stared at Scorpia. Same old Scorpia—big smile, enormous energy, filling up the room like she didn’t have a care in the world.

She tilted her head at me. “So… how’s school treating you? Surviving math?”

The question made my stomach twist. Weaver’s voice flickered in my head, sharp and cold: *lazy, careless—pathetic.* I looked down at my hands, fiddling with the napkin. “It’s fine,” I muttered. “Just… you know. Tests.”

Scorpia didn’t buy it. Her grin softened into something gentler. “You don’t have to play tough with me, Catra. That call last night

sounded serious.”

I shrugged, staring at the swirl of foam the barista set down in front of me. “It’s nothing. Just messed up a math test. Weaver found out. She… wasn’t happy.”

Scorpia’s smile faded, her eyebrows furrowed together. “She gave you a hard time, didn’t she?”

I bit the inside of my cheek. I didn’t want to say it out loud, didn’t want to hear the words again. But Scorpia’s eyes were steady, kind, like she could hold whatever I gave her without dropping it. “She called me useless,” I finally said, my voice flat. “Said I was a failure.”

Scorpia leaned across the table, lowering her voice. “Hey. Please don’t listen to her. You’re not useless. You’re one of the strongest people I know. And failing a test doesn’t change that.”

I swallowed hard, blinking down at my latte. Compliments always made me feel exposed. But with Scorpia, it didn’t hurt. Not as much. “Thanks,” I mumbled.

“Anytime,” she said, grinning again, softer this time. “Now, tell me something good. I wanna hear about that girl who sings in the shower at your dorm.”

I laughed at that. Not long ago, I was on a call with Scorpia, and Adora was singing very loudly in the shower; even Scorpia managed to hear it. "She's doing great."

She smiled, "I'm happy you're seeing someone, Wildcat."

I groaned, "Stop looking at me like that, I'm happy too. It's just..." I trailed off.

"What?" She picked up on my tone.

"I'm worried that I'm gonna be too much for her, she's already dealing with me having nightmares at night. I feel like she

deserves someone less... Complicated." I stared at my drink.

Scorpia held my hand, "Hey, don't think like that. You're a person, Catra. Everyone is complicated in their own way. I can tell she likes you, no matter what, Wildcat."

I smiled gently, but the guilt didn't lift off me. "Thanks."

Adora's POV:

I watched Catra enter the dorm room as I was lying on the couch. She seemed a bit down, but I didn't want to push her. I watched her put her stuff down and made her way over to me. I flashed her a smile as she nudged me up so she could sit down.

"Hey, Kitkat. How was the catch-up with your friend?" I smiled as I lay back down, throwing my legs over her lap.

"It was nice, haven't seen her in a while." She smiled softly.

It was a comfortable silence; the only thing that was breaking the silence was the TV. She gently rubbed her thumb on my leg as she watched what was playing. It wasn't a massive gesture, but I still felt warm inside and relaxed. "What do you wanna do for dinner tonight?" I broke the silence.

She hummed a bit, "We can do something easy if you want. I have no motivation to cook anything."

I nodded, "Alright, I'll just order takeout."

"Sounds good." She responded emotionlessly.

I would be lying if I said I wasn't worried about her; she's been distant since I got back from practice last night. I leave it for a conversation for later; I didn't want to ruin this moment right now.

About two hours later, I had to force myself to get up. I knew something was up the moment I started walking away. Typically, Catra would pretend to be upset and drag me back on the couch, but this time, she just sat there. Didn't even look at me. I felt a pang of disappointment wash through me as I went to my room to get ready for practice.

As I walked out, I grabbed my bag and looked at Catra. "I'm off to practice. Can I grab some food on the way home for dinner?"

Catra looked over, "Yeah, that'd be nice." She offered a fake smile.

I'm definitely confronting her about this later.

...

After doing laps, the coach assigned Mermista and me to practice kicks.

As I practice my goal kicks, my mind is too preoccupied with Catra. Did I do something wrong? It was such a sudden change out of nowhere, I couldn't think of anything that I would've done to upset her, so it had to have happened while I was at practice last night. Right?"

"Adora!" Mermista shouted at me.

I quickly snapped out of my thoughts, "Huh?"

"Maybe ease up on the kicks? I swear you're kicking hard on purpose." She crossed her arms.

I offered an apologetic smile, "Sorry, just in my head at the moment."

"What's up?" She threw the ball back over to me.

I caught the ball and dropped it to my feet, "It's just complicated at the moment, it's hard to talk about, I guess."

"Hm, is it that girl?" She questioned, but I had a feeling she already knew.

"Yeah." I kicked the ball, managing to get past Mermista.

She grunted and picked up the ball, "Yeah, you're in a secret relationship, aren't you?" She smirked and threw it back over.

I froze, letting the ball hit me square in the face. "Ow! And... No! I'm not." I'm such a horrible liar.

Mermista laughed, "I knew it! You're such a bad liar. You don't have to say who it is, but what's going on? Wait, she's not making it a secret cause she's ashamed of you or something, is she?" She gave me a look.

"No! It's complicated; she can't have someone finding out. And no, it's not an ex or whatever." I kicked the ball, but she blocked it.

"Interesting." She threw it back over.

I smirked and rolled my eyes, "She's just been distant, and it's recent too. I noticed it last night when I came home from practice."

She nodded, "Maybe something happened while you were at practice?"

"That's what I thought!" I kicked the ball, successfully scoring.

Mermista hummed, "Talk to her when you get back? 'Communication is key,' as Bow always says." She threw the ball back.

"Yeah, I will."

I pushed open the door to our dorm room, balancing a bag with takeout boxes in one hand and a bottle of water in the other. The smell of pizza and garlic bread hit me, but I barely noticed it. My eyes immediately went to Catra, sitting at her desk with her back slightly hunched, staring at her textbook like she wasn't mentally here.

"Hey," I said softly, opening her room door and setting the bag down on her bed. "Brought dinner."

She didn't look up. "Mm," she muttered, her voice clipped.

I frowned and put the bottle of water on her desk, trying to get her attention. "Catra… what's going on?"

She finally glanced at me, her eyes guarded and sharp. "Nothing," she said quickly, almost harshly. "I said I'm fine."

"Catra, you're not fine," I said, stepping closer. "You've been off all day. You're avoiding me. Since last night."

She shrugged without meeting my eyes. "I said I'm fine. Can we eat?"

My chest tightened. "No. I can't just let this go. Please, tell me what's wrong."

Her hand twitched toward her pencil, and she clenched it like she could make the words disappear. "I said it's nothing. Stop asking."

"Catra, come on! You don't have to carry everything by yourself!" I raised my voice slightly, frustration creeping in.

Her jaw tightened, and she looked away, her voice low and bitter. "I don't want to drag you into my problems. You don't need this."

"Drag me?" I said, hurt, cutting through my anger. "Catra, I'm your girlfriend! I care about you! Whatever it is, it's not too much for me!"

She flinched, but didn’t soften. “It’s… It isn’t very easy. And I said stop, Adora.” Her words were sharp, final.

I sank onto the edge of her bed, trying to meet her gaze. “Look, I’m not going anywhere. But you can’t just shut me out. I want to help. I want to be here for you. You don’t have to deal with stuff alone.”

Her eyes flicked toward me, almost defiant. “I *can* deal with it. I don’t need anyone.”

“You’re pushing me away!” I said, exasperated. “I just want to be with you, Catra. I want to help you, not be a burden!”

She didn’t answer, just turned back to her desk, tucking her chin slightly into her chest. Her shoulders were tight, her hands gripping her pencil like it was a shield. The tension between us was thick, heavier than the takeout on the bed. I let out a shaky breath, my frustration softening into concern. “Catra… I’m not going to give up on you. But you can’t keep shutting me out. I..." *love.* " Like you too much for that.”

Her silence was answer enough. She didn’t look at me again, didn’t speak. She was closed off, distant. I picked up a slice of pizza from the box, but I didn’t eat it. All I could do was sit there and wait, hoping she’d let me in, even a little. "Then maybe you shouldn't." She said coldly, not even looking at me.

I felt my heart drop, "What? Catra, can you just tell me what the fuck is going on with you?"

"I can't!" She finally looked at me, and tears were pouring from her eyes.

"Catra, what happened?" I demanded.

More silence.

"You know what? Fine! Don't tell me." I said, frustrated, grabbed my food, and started to leave the room until I felt her grab my

arm.

"I'm sorry, just... Please, stay." She looked at me.

My eyes softened at the state of her; she was a mess. "Can you please tell me what's going on?"

She paused for a moment.

"I got a call from Weaver, again."

Chapter End Notes

Scorpia is here!!

I hope you enjoyed this chapter! :)

Chapter 13: Chapter 13

Chapter Summary

> This chapter is a bit dark, so here comes the trigger warnings!
>
> TW: Abuse, Self-harm, and a homophobic slur mentioned.
>
> If this chapter upsets you, don't feel bad skipping it! I hope you enjoy this chapter :)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora's POV

"I got a call from Weaver, again."

I immediately felt scared for Catra. I've heard the things Weaver has done to her, and it made me feel sick to my stomach. "Are you okay? Why did she call?" I sat down and spoke to her in a gentle tone.

"I failed my math exam, so she didn't take it well." She curled up, bringing her knees to her chest.

I pulled her into a hug, "It's okay, you're safe here."

I felt her sobbing into my shoulder; she was genuinely terrified, which makes me wonder how bad Weaver is to her. I continued to comfort her, rubbing her back gently while reassuring her. I looked at her, "What did she say to you?"

"She just... Said I was a disappointment to her, saying I was lazy, careless and pathetic." She pulled away, not wanting to look me in the eye.

“She doesn’t know you,” I said firmly. “She doesn’t get to define you. You are *not* useless. You’re smart, you’re strong, and you’re worth more than anything she’ll ever see.”

Her lips trembled, and she tried to scoff. “Strong? I’m sitting here falling apart over a stupid test. Over her.”

I shook my head, gently resting my hand over hers. “You’re not falling apart. You’re surviving someone who tears you down every chance she gets. That’s strength, Catra. Letting me in, even a little—that’s strength too.”

Her eyes finally spilled over, tears sliding down her cheeks. She didn’t sob, didn’t collapse into me like in the movies. She just leaned forward, letting her forehead rest against my shoulder, quiet but shaking.

I wrapped my arms around her, holding her tight. “I’m here,” I whispered into her hair. “You don’t ever have to go through this alone. Not anymore.”

Eventually, Catra muttered into my shoulder, her voice hoarse, “Sorry for being… difficult.”

I pulled back just enough to look at her. “Don’t apologise. You don’t have to be perfect with me. You have to be you.”

She sniffled, half-smiling through the tears. “You’re annoyingly good at this, you know.”

I laughed softly, brushing a strand of hair out of her face. “Only because I love you.” I quickly realised what I said.

Her eyes softened, and she let herself really look at me. “I love you too,” she whispered. All the nerves immediately washed out of my body. I smiled and kissed her gently. She melted into the kiss and held my cheek. Once she pulled away, she let out a chuckle. "You're such a dork."

"Yeah, I know." I smiled, "Now, I think we should eat our dinner?"

She rolled her eyes and nodded, "I guess, what did you get anyway?"

"Just pizza, something easy. I got you your favourite." I nudged her slightly while grabbing a pizza box to hand to her, "Wanna continue watching Brooklyn 99?"

"Duh." She smirked and walked out of the room.

I grabbed the rest of the food and followed her out to the lounge room.

The rest of the night was calm. It was nice to help Catra take her mind off Weaver.

Catra's POV

I was in a familiar setting, and it wasn't one where I wanted to be. The long hallway, peeling wallpaper and the smell of alcohol and cigarettes filled the room. I felt panic rise through my body as I took in the surroundings, searching for her. I heard someone clear their throat, making me jump and turn around to spot her finally. She leaned against the kitchen doorway with a bottle in one hand, a cigarette in the other. Her silhouette was all jagged edges, shadows wrapped in smoke. I froze.

She took a drag, then looked at me. Eyes bloodshot. Mouth twisted. “I know,” she said.

My stomach flipped.

“You think you can run around holding hands with that little blonde girl like it’s cute?” She sneered, her voice cracked and mean. “You think I wouldn’t find out?”

I couldn’t breathe. Couldn’t blink. Couldn’t move.

“You disgusting little dyke.” Her words hit harder than fists. She stepped closer. Her bare feet smacked the tile with that awful, familiar sound. “You’re disgusting. I took you in. I fed you. I kept a roof over your head. And this is how you repay me? By crawling into bed with some girl?”

“She’s not...” I tried, but the words caught in my throat. “She’s not like that. She loves me.”

She laughed. Laughed so hard she had to wipe tears off her face with the back of her hand. “You don’t get that,” she spat. “You don’t get love. Not you. You ruin everything you touch.” The bottle came flying. I didn’t even see it leave her hand; it just exploded against the wall next to me. Glass rained down all around me. I ducked too slowly, and a shard bit into my shoulder. I felt it — warm blood mixing with cold sweat. “You think she’s gonna stay? She’s just playing house. Wait until she sees what you really are.”

She moved again. Her hand came down hard across my face. I felt it like fire. Not just the pain, but the shame. “She’ll leave. Like they all do.” She grabbed my hair and yanked me to the ground, putting her cigarette out on my arm, which made a painful scream leave my body.

I shot up in my bed, screaming.

Adora quickly placed a hand on my shoulder, "Hey, hey, hey. It's me, you're okay. You're safe."

My breathing slowed down as I turned to face Adora, realising I wasn't in the nightmare anymore. "It was horrible, god." I started sobbing into her arms.

"She's not here, she won't hurt you as long as I am here. I promise." Adora whispered into my ear as she rubbed my back.

"She found out about us, and... She got furious, threw a bottle at me, and the glass cut into my skin... And then she..." I said in between sobs.

"Shh, it's okay. You don't need to think about it anymore, I'm here." Adora comforted me, pulling me into a tight hug.

We both lay down next to each other until we both fell asleep. The rest of the night went smoothly.

...

The next morning, I woke up to Adora still having her arms wrapped around me. I slowly got out of bed to go and get ready, when Adora grabbed my hand.

"Noooo." She whined.

I let out a chuckle, "Come on, Adora. We're supposed to be having brunch with your friends today. It's almost eleven in the morning."

Adora let out a groan and got out of bed, "Fine, I'm surprised I slept this long anyway."

We both headed to the bathroom to get ready, brushing our teeth, brushing our hair, and I started doing my eyeliner. I could feel Adora staring at me as I was trying to concentrate. I sighed and looked over to her, "I can feel you staring, princess."

She did her signature stupid grin, "I can't help it if you look gorgeous."

"Softie," I smirked and continued doing my eyeliner.

"You love it." She wrapped her arms around my waist from behind and kissed my neck.

"Adora!" I squealed, "You almost made me mess up!" I laughed and tried pushing her away.

"Wow, just say you don't want my love then." She smirked and did a final kiss before walking away, "I'm gonna get changed."

"Alright, I'll be ready soon."

I finished up and headed back to my room to get ready. I changed into a casual outfit, complete with my signature Converse shoes, and walked out to see Adora already dressed and ready to go.

"You look good," she said with a smile as she put her phone away. "Ready to go?"

"You look nice too, princess. I'm ready when you are." I grabbed my phone and wallet as I left the room with her.

...

The café was already bustling when we got inside, and the smell of fresh coffee mixed with warm pastries filled the atmosphere.

Glimmer was already there, bouncing with her usual energy, telling Bow about some event she was scheming up. Sea Hawk was halfway through a story about a treasure map he'd found in a textbook, animatedly flapping his arms. Mermista sat quietly, scrolling on her phone, occasionally glancing up with a small smile. Perfuma was sipping tea, smiling while listening to the conversation.

"So," Glimmer said, eyes sharp, "Catra, you said you invited someone?"

"Yeah," I said, folding my napkin. "She's on her way."

Everyone turned to look at me.

Perfuma's eyes brightened. "Oh! I love meeting new people."

“Scorpia’s cool,” I said.

The conversation picked up again, louder and messier now. Bow debated waffle toppings with Glimmer. Sea Hawk tried to convince Mermista that his pirate theory was something to be taken seriously. Adora leaned close enough to whisper something funny in my ear, and I almost forgot Scorpia wasn’t here yet. Then the bell above the café door jingled. And there she was. Scorpia, smiling widely, holding a bag of muffins and a slightly crooked bouquet of sunflowers. “Hey!” she called, striding over like she owned the place.

I stood to meet her. “Glad you made it.”

“Wouldn’t miss it.” She smiled.

At the table, I introduced her to everyone. “This is Scorpia. She’s a friend from back home.”

Scorpia’s grin was infectious. She shook hands, exchanged shy smiles, and slid into the empty seat beside Perfuma. They immediately fell into a quiet conversation about plants and the best spots to find wildflowers around campus. Perfuma’s eyes sparkled in a way I hadn’t seen before, and Scorpia kept stealing little glances at her. I watched them for a moment, then looked over at Adora.

"They're getting pretty close, huh?" I whispered to her.

She chuckled softly, "I think they're a match made in heaven."

I chuckled at the comment, digging into the food in front of me. It was a lovely brunch, and Adora's friends were... A lot, but nice. A few moments later, I stood up to go to the bathroom.

"Just heading to the bathroom," I announced before walking off.

I started washing my hands until I saw Mermista walking in, she exchanged a small look with me. Obviously wanting to talk to me, I looked over and cleared my throat. "Are you wanting something...?"

Mermista hummed, "I wanted to ask you something."

"Shoot." I leaned against the counter.

"Are you the girl Adora's secretly dating?"

My heart dropped. Was I that obvious? If it's that obvious, then I need to take more precautions. "Uh, why do you ask?"

"Well, that wasn't a no. So I'm gonna assume you two are dating." She smirked.

I sighed, "There's a reason why we're keeping it a secret for now, okay?"

She nodded, "All I'm gonna ask is if you really like her, and are not ashamed of her."

I shot her a glare, "I love her. She's the best thing that's ever happened to me, and I would show her off to everyone if I could." I snapped.

Mermista didn't react, maintaining her usual resting bitch face. "Okay, I'm glad." She paused for a moment, "I won't ask why you're keeping it a secret because it's yours and Adora's business, but... I can see she's gotten happier ever since you showed up, so you're in my good list. Just don't hurt her."

I nodded, smiling a little. "I won't."

Mermista cracked a small smile, "Good, now I need to pee so... I'll see you out there."

I nodded and left the restroom, walking over to the group and sitting back down next to Adora.

"Everything good?" She smiled.

"Everything is perfect," I squeezed her hand underneath the table.

Back at the dorm,

Adora went out for a soccer team hangout. She said she'll be back before dinner. It gave me some time to focus on my studies; I can't have another call from Weaver. The thing is, it's been an hour, and I have been stuck on the same subject. Math. I was getting frustrated and even started crying over it. I began to think that maybe Weaver was right about me being pathetic. I couldn't even study properly.

I glanced over at my lighter on my desk; it's been a while since I've burned myself. Memories flooding back to me, sitting in my room back at Weaver's place, blocking the door while I used the lighter on myself after every meltdown I had after a fight with Weaver. It was the only escape I had when I felt like there was no way out. I picked it up and stared at it for a few moments, flicking it on and off and watching the flame rise and go out. I lifted my shorts up to see the old burn marks from previous burns.

I took a deep breath, flicking the lighter on. Letting the flame heat the metal of the lighter before flicking it off and pressing it against my thigh, I winced at the pain as I kept it pressed onto my thigh before pulling it away. I looked at the small blister it left, after that... I did it a few more times. Tears slowly fell on my face as I continued to do it. I heard the door open, and I quickly jumped, putting the lighter away and fixing my shorts. I wiped my face before Adora knocked on the door, slowly opening it.

"Hey, Kitkat. I'm gonna... attempt to make some dinner, are you up for pasta?" She smiled.

I chuckled, "Oh, hell no. I need to supervise you so I can make sure you don't burn the kitchen down!"

"I would not!" She laughed.

I stood up and followed her out to the kitchen, giving her a playful nudge. "You so will."

We both made pastabake together, Adora did, in fact, almost burn the kitchen down. I don't even know how she managed it either.

Chapter End Notes

Sheesh.

Hope you enjoyed this chapter! I'm sorry for the late post; it's been a busy weekend, but I'll see you next weekend for the next two chapters!

Thank you for the support on previous chapters :)

Chapter 14: Chapter 14

Chapter Summary

Soccer game!!

Just a nice short chapter... with a bit of drama obviously ;)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora's POV:

I got up early this morning, having cereal while scrolling on my phone. Catra was in the shower, and I could hear faint singing, which made me smile a bit. Today was game day, and I was nervous as fuck, even with the amount of practice I had... I always have doubts that I won't be good enough. I heard the bathroom door open. I turned to see Catra with damp hair, but she was dressed up.

"Hey, princess." She smirked and grabbed a bowl of cereal before sitting on the kitchen counter.

I smiled and looked at her, "Hey, Kitkat." I put my phone down so my full attention was on her.

"You nervous about the game tonight?" She said before scooping a mouthful of cereal into her mouth.

I shrugged, "I mean, yeah. I'm always nervous before big games. I'm worried I'm gonna screw up."

Catra looked at me for a moment, "You'll do great, I know you will." She hopped off and walked over to place a kiss on my

cheek.

The gesture made me smile, "Thanks, you're my good luck charm." I chuckled.

She rolled her eyes and smirked, "You have shit taste in good luck charms then, dummy."

Catra went into her room to start getting ready for school. I checked the time on my phone, "10 minutes..." I hummed to myself. I got up to place the dishes in the sink for later, and then I went into my room to make sure my hair wasn't messy and that I looked presentable. Once I finished, I walked out to find Catra still not outside her room and ready to go. I let out a groan, "Catra! We're gonna be late!"

"Hang on! I can't find my book!" She shouted back.

I rolled my eyes and entered her room, "Cat, we need to hurry it up. Where did you see it last?" I started to help search her room.

"I don't know! I swear it was on my desk, but now it's not there!" She groaned.

I walked over to her messy desk and started looking. I opened up a drawer, and obviously, there was the book. But I also noticed a lighter, weird. I'm positive Catra doesn't smoke or use candles. I grabbed her book and smirked, "I swear, what would you do without me?"

"Okay, it wasn't there when I looked." She grumbled and took the book from my hands to shove it into her bag.

"Why do you have a lighter? I never see you smoke or even use candles." I asked. For some reason, I felt nervous to ask.

Catra seemed to tense for a moment before answering, "Oh, that old thing? I had it for a while. I used to smoke for a bit last year. Mostly just weed."

I looked at her, but I didn't push further, "Alright, it's a cool lighter design." I glanced at it again, and it had an engraving of a cat skull on the silver lighter.

"Thanks, now we should go before we're late." Catra smiles slightly before walking out of her room.

I followed her out and we both made our way to class.

...

The clock on the classroom wall ticked in that slow, uneven way that made every second feel like a full minute. History was never my favourite subject, but I was trying to force myself to pay attention. Tonight was my big soccer game, and the last thing I needed was Mr. Lance pulling me aside to lecture me about slipping grades.

Catra pushed her glasses up the bridge of her nose, eyes scanning the page like she already knew every word before reading it. She wore them rarely, usually only in class or when we studied together, but I'd secretly grown to love those moments. They made her look sharp and serious, like she could take on anything and win.

Mr. Lance launched into the lecture. "As we discussed last week, World War II shifted dramatically in 1944. Now, let's talk about the D-Day invasion that happened on June 6th, the same year."

I tried to follow along, but Catra nudged my notebook with the eraser of her pencil, pulling my attention back down to earth. She didn't look at me, just kept her eyes on the book while murmuring, "You're spacing again, princess."

"I'm not spacing," I whispered back, scribbling a half-formed note just to prove it.

Her smirk tugged at the corner of her mouth. "Really? Then tell me what date he just said."

I froze for a second, brain blank, before admitting, "Uh… June something?"

"June 6th, 1944," she said instantly, tapping the page. "The Allies stormed Normandy. Big deal, Adora. You should probably remember that for the test."

I rolled my shoulders back and shot her a sidelong look. "That's what you're for. My personal history tutor."

Her eyes flicked toward me, amused, as she leaned a little closer. "More like your safety net. You'd fail without me."

I raised a brow, jotting down the date in my notes. "That's debatable. I've been improving."

"Because of me," she countered, her voice low but playful. "Don't forget who drilled you on the difference between the Axis and the Allies."

I chuckled under my breath, remembering the late-night study session where she quizzed me so relentlessly I almost threw a pillow at her. "Alright, fine. You've got me there."

For a moment, the classroom noise faded. It was just the scratch of Catra's pencil, her elbow resting close enough that it brushed mine whenever she shifted. She had that look of complete focus that came so naturally to her, while I fought to split my mind between the lecture, the game tonight, and her. Always her.

"You nervous?" she asked suddenly, so quietly I almost thought I imagined it.

I kept my eyes on my notebook. "About the game? A little. It's the semifinals, and the coach keeps telling me I need to lead the team tonight."

"You'll do fine," she said, matter-of-fact, like it wasn't even up for debate. "You always step up when it counts. Just like you do in class when I force you to actually remember things."

I smirked, finally glancing her way. "Are you comparing World War II flashcards to the semifinals?"

Her lips curved into that sly grin again. "You'd be surprised how similar they are. Both involve strategy, pressure, and the occasional disaster if you don't pay attention."

I laughed softly, shaking my head. "You're impossible."

"And you'd be lost without me," she teased, tapping my notebook again. "Now write this down before Lance calls on you."

The scoreboard displayed 2–1, the final minutes dripping away. Every breath I took burned hot in my chest, and sweat stung my eyes, but I refused to slow down. The semifinals weren't over yet, and if we slipped now, everything we'd worked for would collapse. The crowd was on their feet, stomping, chanting, shouting. I could hear the thrum of my name being yelled in waves, but it was Catra's voice I found every time. Sharp, cutting through the chaos, like she was the only one on my frequency. She leaned so far over the railing I worried she'd fall, hair messy from the wind, eyes never leaving me. It was like she was willing me to stay on my feet, to keep pushing no matter what.

The other team was pressing hard, desperate for the equaliser. Their forwards were ruthless, bodies colliding with ours at every chance. I dropped back into defence, my legs heavy but still moving, adrenaline forcing me forward. Every play felt like it lasted hours, every second dragging the end closer.

Then it happened.

A fast break from their midfield. I sprinted across the turf, lungs on fire, cutting the angle as the ball raced toward their striker. I got there just in time to block her, but another defender barreled in, reckless, too fast. Her cleat slammed into my shin, hard. The pain was instant and brutal, ripping through my leg like fire. I hit the ground, breath punched out of me, clutching at the spot instinctively. For a moment, I couldn't even hear the crowd, just the rush of blood in my ears, the throb of pain radiating up from my shin. The whistle shrieked. My teammates swarmed me, voices panicked, hands hovering as if they didn't know where to touch. Coach and the nurse rushed out, the game frozen around me.

"Don't move," the nurse ordered firmly, already kneeling at my side.

"I can keep going," I gritted out, trying to sit up. But the second I tried to put weight on the leg, it screamed back at me, a deep, searing pain that made my vision blur. I sucked in a sharp breath, biting hard on my lip to stop from crying out.

From the corner of my eye, I found her. Catra was pressed against the railing, eyes wide, her mouth moving around my name like she was shouting it over and over. Her hands were clenched into fists, her body leaning so far forward she looked seconds away from storming the field. There was no teasing smirk, no playful grin, just pure worry in her face.

"We're taking her off," the nurse said, signalling to the cart.

"No—" I tried, my voice hoarse. "There's barely time left, I can..."

"Adora," Coach snapped, crouching close. "That's an order. You're not making it worse out here."

The nurse and Coach helped me sit up, every movement sparking sharp pain in my shin. Not broken—I knew that much. But strained, bruised deep, maybe something torn. Bad enough that even I couldn't argue. My teammates stepped back, their cheers

turning into a protective wall around me, clapping and shouting encouragement as I was helped toward the cart. I felt embarrassed as I was getting taken away, and I didn't dare to look at the crowd.

...

"Well, it's not broken. You'll just need to rest up and take a break from soccer for a bit." The nurse smiled as she stood up.

I nodded, "Thanks."

The nurse walked out, probably to call the coach. I sighed as I stared at my bandaged-up leg that had an ice pack on it. I never felt more useless in my life. I needed to be more careful with soccer since it's my only shot at a scholarship. The door creaked open, and I looked over, expecting the nurse again, but it wasn't. Catra slipped inside, her hood pushed back, her short hair wild from the wind. She glanced over her shoulder as if expecting someone to stop her, then shut the door quickly and leaned against it.

"Pretty sure you’re not supposed to be in here," I said, voice raspy from everything—shouting, breathing hard, the pain.

She arched a brow, crossing the room in three strides. "Pretty sure I don’t care."

The chair beside the cot scraped as she dragged it closer and sat down. Up close, her eyes scanned me, flicking to the bandaged ice pack on my shin. Her smirk was gone, her jaw tight. "You scared the hell out of me," she muttered, almost too low to hear.

I tried to smile, though it felt weak. "Sorry. Not exactly how I pictured the semifinals ending either."

"Sorry?" She leaned in, eyes flashing. "Adora, you went down and didn’t get up. I thought..." She cut herself off, pressing her lips into a hard line. "You should’ve stayed down the second you felt

that hit. You’re always trying to play through everything, like you’re invincible."

I met her glare steadily, though my chest twisted at the worry under her words. "I couldn’t just quit. The team needed me."

Her hands clenched on her knees, shoulders hunched like she was holding herself back. "You don’t get it. Watching you lying there-" She shook her head, exhaling sharply. "I wanted to jump the railing and knock that defender out myself."

That made me laugh, even though the motion tugged at my ribs. "Would’ve paid money to see that."

Catra shot me a look, but the corner of her mouth twitched, betraying the edge of a smile. She leaned back, finally letting some tension ease from her shoulders. "You’re ridiculous."

"And you’re dramatic," I countered softly, shifting to adjust the ice pack. The pain flared, and I sucked in a breath through my teeth. Immediately, her hand hovered over mine, like she wanted to help but didn’t know how.

"You are such an idiot," she said quietly. "Why would you try to get up again? It obviously looked painful." She let out a chuckle.

"I didn’t want to let you down," I admitted before I could stop myself.

Her eyes widened just a fraction, then softened in a way that made my chest ache worse than my leg. "You never let me down, dummy," she said, voice low. "I just… I just want you to be okay."

The silence that followed was heavy but not uncomfortable. She stayed close, her knee brushing the edge of the cot, her eyes never leaving me. I let myself relax against the pillow, exhaustion pulling at me now that the adrenaline was gone. Outside, the muffled roar of the crowd echoed; my team must have scored again, sealing the win. I smiled faintly, then looked at her. "Guess we’re going to the championship."

Her smirk finally returned, sharp but softer at the edges. "Guess so. But you’re not stepping foot on that field again until you’re healed. I’ll drag you back here myself if I have to."

I chuckled, reaching out with my free hand to nudge hers. "Deal."

She takes my hand and kisses it gently, sitting in comfortable silence until the nurse walks in. Catra and I quickly pulled our hands away, trying to act normal.

The nurse raised her eyebrow, "I'm pretty sure you're not allowed here."

"I'm her roommate, the coach sent me to make sure she gets back to the room okay." She flawlessly lied.

The nurse paused but nodded, "Alright, over the weekend, make sure she doesn't put pressure on the leg. She should stay in bed and rest up." She grabbed a wheelchair. 'I'll take her up to the dorm room." She smiled.

...

After a struggle to get into my bed, the nurse left painkillers on my desk before leaving.

Catra lied down next to me, "So, want to watch a movie? I can grab the laptop?"

I smirked, "Obviously."

She came back into the room later with her laptop and pulled up a movie called 'The Wedding Singer.' I gave her a look, clearly not expecting her to choose a movie like this. "Don't even." She rolled her eyes, like she knew what I was thinking.

"I mean, I didn't say anything..." I smirked and got comfortable in the bed.

It was a nice movie, filling the room without complete silence. We both fell asleep while watching the movie.

Chapter End Notes

I hope you enjoyed this chapter! The next chapter is coming tomorrow.

Thank you for the kudos :)

Chapter 15: Chapter 15

Chapter Summary

TW! Mentions of self-harm.

Just a small chapter of Catra looking after Adora :)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra's POV:

I woke up next to Adora, and the laptop we had been using the previous night was turned off and likely out of battery. I watched Adora's chest slowly rising and falling back down, and my eyes trailed to her face. She looked so peaceful when she was sleeping. I got out of bed to get ready, thankfully, it was the weekend, but I wanted to go out to grab breakfast for Adora... Since I was too lazy to cook. Once I finished brushing my teeth and got dressed, I grabbed the dorm keys and headed off to the nearest cafe that was near the school.

As I was walking over to the cafe, I noticed that it was unusually busy. I never really saw big crowds on the street this early on a weekend. I let out a long sigh. Crowds weren't my specialty. I tried pushing past a few people, saying soft sorrys as I accidentally bumped into them. I looked up to see how close the cafe was now, but my heart quickly stopped when I noticed a familiar figure. It looked like Weaver.

There was no way it was her; she couldn't be here, but damn, it really looked like her. I felt my heart racing as I watched the figure slowly turn around. The lady turned around, but thankfully, it wasn't Weaver. I felt like my brain was playing tricks on me

lately. I let out a deep breath that I didn't realise I was holding. I quickly pushed my way into the cafe and headed straight for the bathroom to lock myself in. I pushed my back against the door as I closed and locked it. Slowly sliding down, bringing my knees up to my chest as I let out sobs I couldn't control. My breathing started to quicken until I was struggling to take deep breaths. I felt like I was going to die, and I quickly started to do a technique that Scorpia helped me with.

Something I can see... A toilet, sink, mirror... Tiles. I tried taking deep breaths as I scanned the room. Okay, now something I can hear... Coffee machines are going off in the cafe, and people are talking. I took a deep breath, finally composing myself. I stood up and splashed my face with water. I looked in the mirror and took one final deep breath before telling myself that "I'm okay." I walked out of the bathroom to place an order.

...

The dorm hall was still hushed with the heaviness of early morning. I kept my steps quiet as I balanced the takeout tray in one hand, the paper bag of food in the other. My own nerves still hadn’t settled, but I forced them down, keeping my shoulders squared and my expression calm. Adora didn’t need to see any of that. Not after last night. I set the food down on her desk, careful not to make too much noise. The scent of coffee and warm bagels filled the air. For a moment, I just stood there, watching her chest rise and fall, reminding myself she was okay. That she’d made it through the game, through the night.

“Adora,” I said softly, perched on the edge of her bed. No response. I leaned closer, brushing a few stray blond strands from her face. “Come on, princess. Wake up. I brought food.”

She stirred, mumbling something into her pillow, before her eyes blinked open slowly. Still half-asleep, she squinted at me. “...Catra?”

“Yeah.” I gave her a small smile, keeping my voice light. “And before you ask, no, you’re not dreaming. I actually woke up early and went to the cafe.”

That got her attention. She pushed herself up on one elbow, wincing slightly at the movement. Her leg was still sore; I could see it in the way she held herself, careful and stiff. “You? Up early? That’s suspicious.”

I rolled my eyes, but the teasing was a relief. “Don’t get used to it. I just thought you could use breakfast delivered after, you know, being carried off the field like some tragic sports movie hero.”

Her cheeks warmed with that sheepish grin she always got when people fussed over her. “You didn’t have to.”

“Yeah, well,” I said, standing to grab the tray, “I wanted to.” I set the coffee cup in her hands first, watching her fingers curl around it like it was the only thing tethering her to the world. She hummed softly at the warmth, the corners of her mouth tugging into a smile. I unwrapped the bagel and pushed it toward her. “Eat. The nurse said you’ve gotta keep your strength up if you’re gonna keep wrecking your legs on the field.”

Adora laughed softly, the sound rough from sleep. “You’re bossier than Coach.”

“I take that as a compliment,” I said, settling beside her again.

For a while, it was quiet, her sipping coffee, me pretending not to stare at how she relaxed with every bite. I let myself breathe, slow and steady, letting the rhythm of her calm seep into me. She leaned against my shoulder halfway through her bagel, her eyes still heavy. “Thanks, Catra,” she murmured.

“Anytime,” I whispered back. "I'm gonna head into my room for a bit, I need to finish up something." I got up and took my food with me.

"Noooo," She whined. "Come back, I want company."

I chuckled, "It won't take long, promise."

...

I walked over to my room and closed the door; my mind was only focusing on the lighter. I placed the food on my desk as I grabbed the lighter from my drawer, staring at it as the flame was moving. I rolled my shorts up, flicking the flame off as I pressed the top against my skin. I winced at the burn. I held it for a few moments before pulling away.

I went to do another, but I heard commotion coming from outside my room, like someone falling. Shortly after, I heard a low, "Owww."

I shoved the lighter back into the desk before rushing out the door. I saw Adora lying on the ground. I ran over to her and kneeled beside her. "What the fuck are you doing!? Are you okay?" I placed my hand on her back.

"I'm... Fine." She tried to push herself up but miserably failed, face-planting on the floor. "My body is betraying me..." She said in an exaggerated voice.

I smirked and rolled my eyes before helping her up, "You're not supposed to walk, dummy. Ever heard of resting?" I put her arm around my head, onto my shoulder.

"Ugh, I needed to go to the bathroom." She groaned.

I nodded and helped her over to the bathroom. I sat her down on the side of the bathtub, "Are you okay from here?" I glanced at her.

"Yeah, thanks for the help." She smiled warmly at me.

I nodded and left the bathroom. I went to my room to grab my food, taking it out to the lounge room. I needed to focus on Adora, it's probably the only way to distract myself today. I sat down and started eating while scrolling on my phone, and I heard the toilet flush and the sink running not long after.

"Catraaaaaa." I heard Adora groan.

I let out a laugh before heading over to her. I opened the door to see her leaning over the sink. "Yes, princess?" I leaned against the doorframe.

"I need help..." She mumbled quietly.

I tilted my head, "I didn't quite hear that. Can you speak louder?"

"Catra." She looked at me with a glare.

I smirked, "What? I don't know what you need."

"I NEED HELP!" She yelled.

I laughed and wrapped her arm around me, "Jeez, I'm not deaf."

"Asshole."

I sat Adora on the couch, walking into her room to grab her breakfast, which she had left in there. "It's gonna be a chill day for us," I said as I gave her the food and drink.

She hummed, "I guess."

I sat down next to her, "What is it?" I gave her a look.

"Huh? What do you mean?" She tilted her head.

"You have that look on your face, the one when you obviously have something on your mind." I crossed my arms.

"I thought we could... I don't know, have a study date? I could help you out with math?" She smiled.

I smirked and rolled my eyes, "You just wanna see me in glasses."

She let out a playful scoff, "I do not! Well, yes. But I wanna help you! It'll be fun!"

"I really don't know how math could be fun, but whatever, let me grab our stuff..." I walked off.

“Okay,” she said, tapping her pencil against the paper. “You keep messing up here, see? You’re distributing wrong.”

I groaned, slumping into the couch. “Maybe the numbers are just messing with me on purpose. Ever think of that?”

She rolled her eyes but smiled. “Pretty sure that’s not how math works.”

“Pretty sure I don’t care,” I muttered, letting my head thunk against the couch dramatically.

Adora laughed, the sound low and warm, and for a second, I almost forgot how much I hated what we were doing. She reached over and nudged my arm gently. “Come on. You’re not bad at this, Catra. You just get frustrated too fast.”

“Gee, thanks, motivational speaker,” I said, lifting my head. “What’s next, a pep talk about how numbers are my friends?”

She smirked, but there was something soft in her eyes. “You’re impossible.”

“You love it,” I shot back automatically.

Her cheeks went pink, and she had a wide grin on her face, but she didn’t deny it. Instead, she turned the notebook toward me

and scribbled another equation. “Okay, try this one. Slowly. Step by step. No rushing.”

I stared at the mess of numbers like they were plotting against me. Still, she was sitting there patiently. I walked through each step, muttering under my breath, glancing up at her every time I hesitated. She didn’t laugh or snap when I messed up. She just pointed gently, her voice steady.

“Good. Almost. You forgot to subtract here. Try again.” It took forever, but I got it. And when I did, Adora grinned at me like I’d just scored the winning goal at one of her soccer games. “There!” she said, proud, almost bouncing in her seat. “See? You did it!”

Her excitement was ridiculous—but it was also contagious. I felt my own grin creeping in, despite myself. “Yeah, yeah. Don’t faint or anything.”

She leaned closer, her ponytail sliding over her shoulder, eyes sparkling. “Told you you could do it.”

I stretched, "I think I'm finished with math for today, wanna watch Brooklyn Nine-Nine?"

"Obviously!" She smiled.

I turned on the TV and opened Netflix, "Do you want me to grab you snacks?" I stood up after I pressed play for the show.

"Yes, please!" She smiled widely.

I grabbed some snacks and plopped down on the couch.

After a while, we were snuggling together on the couch. Adora throws some chips into her mouth as she stares at the TV. I feel my phone buzz, I glance at the notification, and it was from Scorpia.

"Hey, Wildcat! So, remember that brunch you invited me to, and I was talking to Perfuma? Well, she and I really hit it off, and I need help... BADLY."

I raised my eyebrow as I read it, and I started typing back.

"What do you mean?"

Not long after, another text came through.

"I really like her, Catra."

I let out a laugh, which caused Adora to look at me with a puzzled look on her face. "Uh, what's so funny?"

"Scorpia is asking for help with Perfuma because she got a big crush," I smirked.

Adora's face went from confused to happy in a matter of seconds, "I knew it! I got serious vibes at that brunch!"

I paused the show and started calling Scorpia. After a few rings, she picks up.

"Catra! You HAVE to help me. I don't know what to do." She said in a panicky voice.

"Calm down, you're fine. Why don't you just ask her out somewhere?" I suggested.

She let out a sigh, *"I don't know how to, what if she thinks I mean it as friends?"*

I rolled my eyes and gave Adora a look before answering, "Then make it forward, like... *'Hey, I like you a lot, and I was wondering if you wanted to hang out sometime. Like a date.'* Not that hard."

There was a pause, *"Alright. I'll try, thanks, Wildcat."*

I didn't even look at Adora after Scorpia said the nickname; I already knew what expression she had on her face. "Anytime, Scorps," I said before hanging up.

"How do you think it's gonna go, *Wildcat?"* Adora smirked.

I let out a grumble, "First of all, don't call me that. Second of all, she's gonna be fine, I could tell Perfuma likes her back."

Adora laughed before pressing play, "Okay, I think I prefer Kitkat for you anyway."

I rolled my eyes, but eventually went back to snuggling with her.

Later on, after a few laughs that the show earned from us, I noticed Adora went quiet. I glanced down. Her head had tipped against my shoulder, blond hair falling loose across her face. Her breathing was steady, her mouth just barely parted in sleep. She was out. Completely.

“Of course you’d fall asleep mid-episode,” I whispered, not that she could hear me.

Careful not to jostle her too much, I shifted. Her head dropped a little, and I caught her gently, guiding her down so she was lying along the couch instead of slumped uncomfortably against me. She mumbled something in her sleep but didn’t wake, one arm flopping onto the cushion. I grabbed the blanket draped over the back of the couch and spread it over her, tucking it lightly around her shoulders. She looked so peaceful that it almost didn’t feel real. I brushed a stray lock of hair from her face, careful and light, then settled on a chair next to the couch. I started watching a movie, just to keep her company.

Chapter End Notes

Thanks for reading this chapter! I hope you enjoyed it. I'm sorry if it felt short. :)

Next chapters are next weekend! :)

Chapter 16: Chapter 16

Chapter Summary

Winter break!!

Adora is inviting Catra to spend winter break with her.

Just a nice, small cozy chapter. :)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora's POV

Finally, the last week before Christmas break. All exams are finished, and Catra seemed to be happier after she passed all her classes, with my help, of course. Her mood seemed to change; she looked lighter and happier. Weaver really affected her. I've been looking at colleges to apply to; obviously, Bright Moon University is my top pick. Still close to home, and I'm familiar with the area. As I was looking at photos of the campus, Catra walked in with a cheese platter in hand.

"What's up, dork?" She smirked.

I rolled my eyes and glanced over to her, "Just looking at universities and stuff." I glanced at the plate she was holding, "What do you have there?"

She smirked, "I made a cheese platter for myself earlier, but I'm full now. You want the rest?" She placed the plate down on my desk, as if she already knew the answer.

"Obviously!" I immediately shoved the food in my mouth, and I looked up at her after swallowing the food. "What are your plans for the holidays?"

She dropped her smile a bit before letting out a sigh, "I don't know, not particularly wanting to go home. Might just stay here over the holidays." She shrugged as she looked out the window, pretending something was interesting out there.

I looked at her for a bit. I could just invite her to mine, I could even introduce her to my family. "Why don't you come with me over the holidays then?" I smiled.

She looked at me, surprised. "Huh? What about your family and stuff, I don't wanna intrude."

I shook my head, "They'll love you, trust me, it will be fine."

She paused for a moment, "Okay."

I smiled and grabbed my phone straight after, sending a message to Hope letting her know that I'm bringing someone for the holidays. She responded almost immediately, saying it's fine, and I gave Catra a nod, saying everything is settled. "Alright, I'll help you pack."

...

I sat cross-legged on the floor of Catra’s room, surrounded by the chaos of her “packing system,” which was really just a pile of clothes spilling out of her dresser and onto the floor. She stood over me, arms crossed, pretending she wasn’t secretly watching to see if I’d fold her shirts better than she did. Spoiler: I did.

“You don’t have to do this, you know,” Catra muttered, tossing another hoodie in my direction. It hit me in the face, soft and warm, and I caught it before it landed in the mess.

“Yes, I do,” I said, giving her my best serious voice. “If I leave you to your own devices, you’re going to pack nothing but three T-shirts, a single sock, and some sarcastic attitude.”

Her mouth curved into that smirk I loved, the one she always used when she was trying to cover up how much she liked something. “Sarcastic attitude packs light,” she shot back.

I shook my head, folding the hoodie neatly and placing it in the half-organised suitcase. “My mum’s already excited to meet you, Catra. You can’t just show up looking like you wrestled your clothes out of a dumpster.”

“Who says I didn’t?” she teased, and then she sat down beside me, brushing her knee against mine. The tiny touch made my chest feel ridiculously warm.

I tried to keep my focus on her clothes, but I could feel her watching me closely. She was nervous, even if she’d never admit it. Coming home with me over Christmas break—it was a big deal. For her, even bigger than for me. She didn’t want to go back to Weaver’s, and I wasn’t going to let her spend the holidays alone.

“You really think your family’s gonna like me?” she asked suddenly, her voice quieter now.

I looked up at her and caught the flicker of uncertainty in her golden eyes. My heart squeezed. “Of course they will. They’ll love you. I mean, how could they not? You’re… you.”

She just looked away quickly, muttering, “You’re such a sap.” But her hand brushed mine, a little shy, a little deliberate, and I curled my fingers around hers before she could pull back. We stayed like that, side by side on the floor, folding and packing. Every so often, she’d lean against my shoulder for a second too long, and I’d pretend not to notice. At one point, she tried to sneak a bright red sweater into the pile—the one she’d stolen from me weeks ago—but I caught her.

“That’s mine,” I said, tugging it back.

“It looks better on me,” she replied smoothly, tugging harder.

“Maybe,” I admitted, cheeks warming, “but my mum knitted this for me. She’ll notice if it’s missing.”

Catra’s grip loosened, and she smirked. “Fine. But only because I don’t wanna outshine you in front of your family.”

By the time the suitcase was packed neatly, Catra looked a little less tense. I zipped it shut and sat back with a triumphant sigh. “There. Now you’re officially ready for Christmas at Casa Adora.”

She nudged my knee with hers again, her voice softer this time. “Thanks, dummy. For… y’know. Not making me do this alone.”

I smiled, heart swelling, and leaned in close enough that my forehead almost brushed hers. “Of course, Kitkat.” I stood up and helped Catra up, "Alright, ready for a road trip?" I smirked.

"Not exactly, but it's with you, so I know it won't be so bad." She smiled.

I felt my heart flutter. I had never heard Catra sound so affectionate before. "Are you being a sap right now?" I smirked and crossed my arms.

"What!? No! Get a hold of yourself." She blushed and pushed past me.

I started laughing and followed her out, "Sure, sure. I'm gonna grab my stuff and then we can load up my car."

The suitcase felt heavier than it had any right to be, and I shot Catra a look as I wrestled it down the dorm steps. “What did you pack in here? Bricks?” I huffed, trying to maneuver the thing without falling.

Catra followed behind me, carrying a much smaller duffel bag slung lazily over her shoulder. She smirked like she was enjoying the show. “Maybe I packed a few books in there. Y’know, just in case I need some light reading.”

I smirked, "Hm, what type of books?”

She quickly turned her head around, "Shut up! You're never gonna let that go." She huffed.

I let out a laugh, "Oh, come on! It's funny!"

"Yeah, yeah. Just keep carrying the suitcase." She rolled her eyes.

I groaned as I dragged it down the steps, "It seriously weighs a shit ton."

"Good workout for you, muscles,” she teased, her voice low and playful.

"Whatever."

When we stepped outside, the December air hit us sharply and coldly. Catra buried her hands deeper into her hoodie pocket, and I shifted the suitcase so I could walk closer, bumping her shoulder with mine. “Not too late to change your mind,” I teased. “You could always stay here and survive on vending machine chips.”

She snorted. “Tempting. But then I’d miss out on seeing how red you’re gonna get when your mum starts pulling out baby pictures.”

I groaned, dragging the suitcase toward the parking lot. “Please don’t encourage her.”

“She doesn’t need encouragement, does she?” Catra smirked.

By the time we reached my beat-up little car, the sun was dipping low, painting the sky in streaks of orange and purple. I popped the trunk and wrestled the suitcase inside, making sure it fit with my own bag already in there. Catra leaned against the car, arms crossed, pretending she wasn't watching me struggle with the straps.

"You know," she said casually, "this is a lot of effort for someone who claims she's not in love with me."

I nearly smacked my head on the trunk lid. "Catra!"

She just laughed, the sound bright in the crisp evening air. I wanted to say something back, something smooth, something that wouldn't give me away too much—but all that came out was a helpless laugh. I slammed the trunk shut and turned to face her. Her smirk softened just a little, and in the fading light, I could see the nerves again under all the bravado.

I stepped closer, nudging her arm with mine. "Hey. It's gonna be fine, okay? My family's gonna love you."

She tilted her head, eyes catching the last bit of sunlight. "Yeah, well. They'd better. I'm giving up vending machine chips for this."

I shook my head, grinning. "You're impossible."

"Duh, can't let it be easy for you." She smirked as she got into the car.

I got into the driver's seat, started up the car and turned the heater on. "Do you wanna grab some food before we go? At the diner?"

"Are you trying to ask me out on a date, princess?" She smirked.

"Catra, I swear." I sighed and face-palmed.

She let out a laugh, "Yeah, let's go."

I nodded and drove off. I watched as Catra hooked up her phone to my car. The first song that played after she turned off her phone was *"No.1 Party Anthem"* by Arctic Monkeys. It was nice and peaceful; we didn't really say much to each other. Just admired the atmosphere.

...

We pulled into the diner's parking lot, and we both got out and walked into the warm, cozy atmosphere. We both sat down at a table as we waited for someone to take our order. I looked at Catra and how the sunset light reflected on her face, which exposed her freckles more and lit up her hazel eye.

"You're staring." She mumbled as she glanced over the menu.

"Well, it's hard not to when you look gorgeous." I huffed and looked at the menu as well. I could hear her words getting caught in her throat. earning a smirk on my face. A waitress walked over and took our orders. Once she walked off, I turned to face Catra. "So, are you nervous?"

She let out a hum, "Yeah, I'm not good with parents." She chuckled.

I smiled, "Don't worry, Hope and Mara will love you. I'm just hoping Razz bakes one of her famous pies again."

She raised an eyebrow, "Famous pies?" She smirked.

"You haven't lived until you tried one, trust me." I chuckled.

The waitress came back with our food, and the rest of the evening was nice. The diner wasn't too busy, thank god. I looked at my phone, seeing posts from Glimmer. She and Bow went to her house to spend Christmas there since his dads and her family are close. I smiled and liked the post. I continued scrolling to see other people's activities until I heard Catra let out a long breath.

"I am full." She chuckled.

I nodded, "Same here, ready to hit the road?"

Catra stood up, "I guess so."

I paid for the food even though Catra tried to fight me so she could pay instead. We both headed out and got in the car.

"I swear, you never let me pay." She huffed as she put her seatbelt on.

I smirked, "I was the one who wanted to do it." I turned the engine on.

We then drove off, preparing ourselves for the long road trip.

Chapter End Notes

> Sorry for the late post! I have been going THROUGH it. I'm currently a bit sick, but I will try my best to post the next chapter tomorrow! :)

Chapter 17: Chapter 17

Chapter Summary

ROAD TRIPPPP

Just a nice cozy chapter with our favourite girls. Enjoy! :)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra's POV

The heater in Adora's beat-up car rattles like it's about to give up on life, which is pretty on brand for it. Honestly, I think the only thing holding this tin can together is Adora's blind faith in "old reliable." Personally, it should have been scrapped ten years ago, but whatever. She drums her fingers against the steering wheel, humming to some cheesy holiday song on the radio. Of course, she knows the words. Of course, she sings them on-key.

I sink lower in my seat, pulling my jacket tighter around me. "You do realise the heater isn't working, right? This isn't 'cozy winter vibes,' this is hypothermia waiting to happen."

Adora shoots me a side glance, grinning. "It's working fine. You're just dramatic."

"Dramatic?" I scoff, breath fogging up in front of me. "Adora, I can literally see my soul leaving my body."

She laughs, big and stupid and warm. "Oh, come on, Catra. It's not that bad. And anyway, we'll be at my parents' place in a couple of hours. You'll survive."

“Easy for you to say,” I mutter. “You grew up in this icy wasteland. My body is designed for… heated apartments.”

She reaches over and flicks my forehead. “You’re just mad you lost the coin toss.”

“Damn right I am. You cheated.” I scoffed.

“I did not cheat!” She laughed.

“You called it in the air *and* caught it.”

“Because you would’ve snatched it and claimed victory no matter what.”

I smirk, crossing my arms. “Sounds like you’re admitting defeat.”

Adora groans, but the corner of her mouth curves upward. It’s unfair how she manages to look so annoyingly pretty even while arguing. My chest warms in a way the heater never could, which is exactly why I snap my gaze back out the window. Snow drifts lazily past, the whole world muted and white. Peaceful. If it weren’t for the nerves clawing in my stomach, I might actually enjoy it. Meeting her parents. Winter holidays. Family dinners. All while pretending I’m just Adora’s… friend. Because stars forbid Weaver from catching wind of me being anything else. Maybe telling Adora's parents wouldn't be so bad, though.

Adora notices my silence. “Hey.” Her voice softens. “You okay?”

I shrug, not looking at her. “Just thinking about how your mum’s gonna hate me.”

“She’s not going to hate you,” Adora says firmly. “She’s going to love you. Everyone does.”

I snort. “Yeah, sure. Tell that to Weaver.”

Adora’s knuckles tighten slightly on the steering wheel. She exhales and glances at me with that stupidly soft expression that

makes my heart trip over itself. “You don’t have to tell anyone,” she says. “Not until you’re ready. I just… wanted you there. With me.”

I roll my eyes, but it’s half-hearted. “You’re such a sap.”

“Maybe.” She grins, teeth flashing. “But I’m *your* sap.”

I groan loudly and cover my face with my hands. “I can’t believe I agreed to this road trip.”

Adora chuckles, reaching over to squeeze my knee before turning back to the road. “Yes, you can.”

...

The sky’s already turning that depressing shade of grey that means night’s not far off. Snowflakes thicken against the windshield, and the wipers squeak in protest every time they swipe.

Adora leans forward, squinting at the road like sheer willpower will make it clearer. “Yeah, so… maybe it’s gonna take more than a couple hours.”

I raise a brow. “Translation: you got us lost.”

“I didn’t get us lost!” She scoffed. “The GPS just… recalculated.”

I smirk. “Uh-huh. You keep telling yourself that.”

Her jaw tightens, and I know I’ve won this round. She hates admitting when I’m right almost as much as I love rubbing it in. Another thirty minutes crawl by, and the snow’s coming down harder. My toes are numb, and the heater’s still doing jack.

Adora finally sighs. “Okay, fine. We’ll stop for the night. There’s a motel a few miles ahead.”

I sit up straighter, feigning horror. “A motel? Like, one of those murder horror movie ones?”

She shoots me a look. “It’s not a murder scene.”

“You don’t know that. Those beds have seen things, Adora. *Unspeakable things.*” I smirked, throwing in a wink.

Adora laughs, shaking her head. “Would you rather freeze out here?”

“…Depends. Does freezing guarantee me not sleeping on sheets some trucker named Gary drooled on?”

She snorts. “You’re so dramatic.”

“Realist,” I correct.

But when she glances at me again, her grin softens. “Don’t worry. I’ll protect you from Gary’s ghost.”

I roll my eyes, though a smile tugs at my lips. “Great. My knight in shining armour, saving me from a haunted motel ghost.”

“Exactly,” she says proudly.

We pull into the nearest Motel, the car shudders as she parks. She turns off the engine, and the sudden silence makes the snowfall outside feel even heavier. Adora rubs her hands together.

“Alright. One night. Warm bed. Then tomorrow, we’ll make it to my parents’.”

I sling my bag over my shoulder, muttering under my breath, “Yeah, nothing like a haunted motel to start the holidays.”

She bumps her shoulder against mine as we step into the freezing night. “You’ll live.”

"Yeah, whatever. Let's just get a room." I rolled my eyes and followed her to the building. She talked to the receptionist; luckily,

there was a room available. I was honestly imagining a worst-case scenario that there weren't going to be any rooms.

She gets the key in under a minute. “Room 6,” she says, jangling the brass key like she’s proud of it.

I trail after her down a narrow hallway that smells vaguely of bleach and bad decisions. “Room 6,” I mutter. “That’s either lucky or cursed. Probably cursed.”

She glances back at me, fighting a smile. “You’ll survive one night.”

“Survive? I’m not sure. End up possessed by the spirit of Gary the trucker? Very likely.”

She laughs and unlocks the door, swinging it open with a dramatic action. “Ta-da! Our palace.”

The “palace” is a shoebox with a faded floral carpet, a buzzing ceiling light, and exactly one bed. The kind of bed with a sagging mattress that screams of broken springs and questionable history.

I stop in the doorway, crossing my arms. “Nope. Absolutely not. I’m not sleeping on that.”

Adora tosses her bag onto the chair and flops down onto the mattress, bouncing a little. “Come on, it’s not that bad.”

“Not that bad?” I lift an eyebrow. “That bed has *seen* things. I’m gonna need at least three exorcisms before I touch it. Or at least a clean...”

She smirks, patting the space beside her. “Guess you’ll just have to share with me. Safety in numbers.”

My stomach does a little flip that I immediately squash. I roll my eyes, trying to sound casual. “Smooth, Adora. Real subtle.”

Her grin widens, but she doesn't push it. Instead, she pulls off her jacket and sets it on the chair. The lamplight catches in her hair, and suddenly this tiny, ugly motel room feels… less awful, which is annoying.

I drop my bag near the foot of the bed and kick off my boots. "Fine. But if I wake up with a ghost standing over me, I'm haunting you next."

"Deal." She slides under the covers, patting the other side. "Now come on before you freeze."

Grumbling under my breath, I climb in. The mattress dips toward her, forcing me closer. I swear the universe is laughing at me. The heater sputters to life in the corner, rattling just like the one in the car. It fills the silence with a low hum. Outside, the snow taps against the window, muffled and constant. For a while, neither of us says anything. I lie stiff on my side, staring at the faded curtains. But then Adora shifts, her hand brushing mine under the blanket, tentative but deliberate.

I glance at her, and she's looking at me like she always does—like I'm something worth staying for. The tension in my chest loosens, just a little.

I sigh, turning onto my back. "You're lucky I like you, you know. Otherwise, I'd have ditched you and your murder motel hours ago."

Her laugh is quiet, warm, almost sleepy. "Yeah. I'm really lucky."

We got closer and cuddled, eventually falling asleep to the hum of the old heater in the corner of the room.

The morning after, I wake up to the sound of the heater coughing its last breath and Adora humming quietly as she digs through her bag. The motel curtains do a terrible job of blocking out the sun,

so the whole room is bathed in pale winter light. Adora's already dressed, her hair damp from the world's probably questionable shower. She looks way too cheerful for someone who slept in a bed I'm convinced had someone die in it.

"You're up," she says, tossing me my jacket. "Come on, Kitkat. We've got a long drive ahead."

I groan, pulling the blanket tighter around me. "Pretty sure I need medical attention. That bed tried to kill me."

She smirks, slinging her bag over her shoulder. "You snored through the night. Sounded like you were in a coma."

"I do *not* snore," I snap, sitting up. My hair's sticking up in about twelve different directions, which doesn't exactly help my case.

Adora raises an eyebrow. "Want me to record it next time?"

"Don't even think about it, princess." I shove my feet into my boots and stand, stretching with a wince. "That mattress was awful."

She laughs and grabs the key from the nightstand. "Breakfast is included. Want to risk it?"

"Risk food from *this* motel?" I point dramatically at the stained ceiling. "I value my life."

"Suit yourself," she says with a shrug, but the way she eyes the cracked coffeemaker by the lobby on our way out tells me she's reconsidering, too.

Outside, the snow has piled up higher, sparkling under the morning sun. It's stupidly pretty, in that postcard kind of way. Our car is half-buried, and Adora immediately gets to work brushing it off with her sleeves.

I shove my hands in my pockets and watch. "You know, if this thing actually starts, I'll believe in miracles."

She flashes me a grin over the roof. “Old reliable’s never let me down.”

“That’s a bold-faced lie, and you know it.”

Still, after some protesting groans and a dramatic cough or two, the engine rumbles to life. Adora beams, as if she has just won an award, sliding behind the wheel. I get in on my side, trying not to admit the blast of warm air feels like heaven.

The road stretches ahead of us, lined with snow-heavy trees. Adora taps the steering wheel in rhythm with the radio, some upbeat holiday song crackling through.

“So,” she says, glancing at me, “a few more hours and we’ll be there.”

I lean back in my seat, smirking. “Can’t wait to see the look on your parents’ faces when you drag in your sarcastic, half-frozen ‘friend.’”

Her smile softens, but she doesn’t push. “Yeah. My favourite friend.”

The word twists in my chest, heavy and light all at once. I pretend to look out the window, hiding the small smile I can’t quite fight off.

...

We pulled into the driveway of Adora's house, and now I felt my heart beat even faster than before. I was so fucking nervous, I stared at the front door from inside the car. As I was contemplating my life choices, I felt a hand touch my shoulder.

"You okay?" Adora asked softly.

"Never better." I chuckled nervously as I got out of the car.

We both approached the door. Adora knocked on the door, which made my heart drop. This is it, no turning back now. The door opened to a tall lady, who had short hair, with a warm purple cardigan wrapped around her. She had a warm smile on her face. Suddenly, a shorter lady popped up. She had tan skin with long braided hair. I looked between them awkwardly, not exactly knowing how to start a conversation.

Luckily, Adora jumped in. "Hey, guys!" She hugged them both. "This is, Catra! My..." She turned to look at me.

I let out a breath I didn't know I was holding, "Her girlfriend." I smiled.

Chapter End Notes

> Ooooh, cliff hanger! Catra finally told someone about her relationship!
>
> Thanks for reading, I will be posting the next two next weekend :)

Chapter 18: Chapter 18

Chapter Summary

> Nice, cute chapter! Adora shows Catra her childhood bedroom, also Mara and Hope are excited to meet Catra.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora's POV:

Did I hear that correctly? Did Catra actually introduce herself as my... Girlfriend? I'm not complaining, but I'm surprised. I hope she didn't feel pressured into saying it. She was so insistent on being secretive about our relationship, but then she pulls that out? I just stared at her; she looked surprised, but covered it with her signature smirk as she looked at me.

"Oh! What a nice surprise!" Hope smiled widely.

Mara joined in and hugged Catra and me, "Oh, I am so happy for you guys! I remember Adora talking about you all the time when we adopted her."

I immediately felt embarrassment rise to my cheeks, "Mum..." I groaned.

I heard Catra laugh, "Oh? I need to hear more about this." She smirked at me as we walked inside the house.

Hope giggled, "I like her already."

I covered my face in embarrassment as we made it to the kitchen, they seemed to of made lunch for us and right on queue, my

stomach let out a rumble. I heard Catra chuckle behind me quietly as she walked up next to me.

"Shut up," I rolled my eyes.

"So, you talk about me, princess?" She said in a low husky voice with a smirk.

I felt my cheeks heat up, making me turn to look away quickly.

"So, do you two want some lunch before bringing all your bags in?" Hope smiled as she set the table.

I looked at Catra, who just nodded, "Yes, please. We haven't had a proper breakfast."

Hope nodded, "I made some sandwiches, have as many as you like." She set down some plates.

Catra and I sat down at the table, and I immediately started to dig in. I heard a giggle coming from Catra, and she took her time with the food.

"So, how did you two meet, well, again I mean." Mara smiled and sat down at the table.

I looked at Catra with my mouth stuffed with food. She rolled her eyes and decided to answer for me.

"I moved to Bright Moon Academy this semester. I was really lucky since I got Adora as my roommate; even if I didn't, I would've still had classes with her. But we met each other when I moved in; ever since then, my life has been better." Catra smiled at me.

I blushed as I swallowed my food.

"Aw, that's so sweet. We should get to know each other during dinner. For now, Adora can show you her room." Mara smiled and left the two of us alone.

"Uh… this is it," I said, nudging open the door to my childhood room.

The warmth of embarrassment hit me instantly, like a blast of heat against the cold air. Catra stepped in ahead of me, her sharp golden and blue eyes scanning the space with obvious amusement.

The walls were still painted a pale blue, the same shade I'd begged for when I was eight. A faded poster of Brightmoon's women's soccer team hung crookedly by the window, curling at the edges. My bookshelf sagged under the weight of paperbacks—half-finished adventure stories, a collection of fairy tales I'd never donated, and the diary I hoped she wouldn't spot.

Catra smirked and picked up the stuffed horse sitting neatly on the bed. Its mane was frizzy from years of use, its stitched eyes slightly loose. I wanted to melt into the floor.

"Oh. My. God." She held it up like some rare artifact. "You kept this?"

"I-It was a gift," I stammered, reaching out to snatch it back, but she sidestepped easily.

"A gift you clearly cuddled to death," she teased, pressing her cheek against the horse's threadbare fur. "What's its name?"

I groaned. "Why does that matter?"

Her grin widened. "Because it definitely has a name. Let me guess… something heroic? Sparkle Charger? Captain Hooves?"

"…It's Swift Wind," I muttered under my breath, already regretting bringing her here.

Catra's laugh filled the room, bright and sharp, and my face burned even hotter. She set Swift Wind gently back on the pillow, though, with a surprising kind of care. She moved next to my desk, fingers trailing across the carved initials etched in the wood.

"You did this?" she asked, pointing to the awkwardly scratched letters: '*A + C*.'

My stomach dropped. "That was—when I was twelve. It was—"

"Uh-huh," Catra interrupted, her smirk softening. "So you were already a little sap back then."

I wanted to argue, but she was right. My room betrayed me. On the dresser sat framed photos: me missing teeth in my smile, me in a too-big jersey with my team, me in middle school with awkward bangs. Catra lingered at each one, her expression shifting from amusement to something quieter, something almost tender.

Finally, she sat on the edge of my bed, patting the space beside her. "Honestly, Adora, it's… cute. I mean, it's so *you*."

I hesitated, half-expecting another jab, but she just leaned back on her hands, watching me with that steady gaze that always made me feel like I was standing under a spotlight.

"It's embarrassing," I admitted, sitting down beside her. "Like this room froze in time, and now you're seeing every awkward part of me laid out on display."

Catra tilted her head, and her smile softened. "Yeah, but I like the awkward parts of you. They're real. And… I don't know. Makes me feel like I'm seeing the whole picture."

Her words lingered in the quiet, mixing with the muffled sound of my parents talking downstairs.

I looked at her—really looked at her—and realised that for the first time, I wasn't ashamed of the stuffed animals, or the crooked

posters, or even Swift Wind. Not with her here. Not when she was looking at me like that. “You’re impossible,” I whispered.

“And you love me,” she shot back without missing a beat.

I rolled my eyes, but my hand found hers anyway, hidden between us on the blanket. “Yeah,” I said softly. “I do.”

A brief silence filled the room before Catra spoke up again, "So, *'A+C'* huh?" She smirked, "Can I guess who the 'C' is?"

I let out a groan, "Stop, it's obviously you! I just missed you a lot..."

She gave me a soft smile, "I missed you too."

Another small pause.

"So, you told them about us?" I looked at her.

She chuckled nervously, "Uh, yeah... I guess so. I just felt safer here for some reason, which is weird because I've never been here before."

I smiled at her, "I'm glad. You didn't seem nervous talking to my parents, though."

"Oh, I was shitting myself. I'm just better at hiding it, unlike you." She smirked.

I rolled my eyes, "Oh, really?"

"Yeah, really." She countered.

I smirked and pounced on her, tackling her down to the bed. "You're looking pretty nervous now."

Catra's smirk faltered a bit, just staring at me in awe. "You look pretty."

I chuckled and brushed a piece of hair out of her face, "Not so bad yourself."

Catra smiled and looked over to the end table, "You have a Polaroid camera?"

I looked over in her direction, reaching over and picking it up. "Man, it's been a while since I've seen this bad boy."

"Does it have any film left?" She rested her hands on my hips.

I hummed, opening the back to see. "Yep, got three left. Surprisingly."

"Take a photo." She smirked.

I let out a laugh and held up the camera, looking through it. Catra did a silly pose, holding a peace sign to her lips and poking her tongue through it.

"Catra! No!" I laughed.

She groaned and settled on a cheeky smirk, showing her cute small fang tugging a bit on her bottom lip. I took a photo, a small flash hitting her face before the photo started printing out. I took it out and placed it on the end table.

"My turn." Catra took the Polaroid camera.

"Ugh, nooo. I look awful." I laughed and covered my face.

"You never look awful," Catra said so sweetly.

I sighed and dropped my hands, making a small smile while Catra took my photo. After it printed out, Catra set the camera and Polaroid to the side.

I hopped off Catra and lay down next to her, "I guess people are gonna know who's top and bottom." I laughed.

Catra scoffed and shoved me, "I am NOT a bottom! You just... Looked good on top." She crossed her arms.

I chuckled, "You wanna just watch something, and cuddle before dinner?"

"Yes, please." She smiled.

...

We'd queued up some random movie on my laptop—something we weren't really paying attention to—but it gave us an excuse to stay close, to let the world outside the door fade away.

Catra's head rested against my shoulder, her hair tickling my neck. One of her hands idly traced patterns across my stomach, making my heart race faster than the muffled action scene playing on screen.

"Your bed's squeaky," she murmured, smirking without lifting her head.

"It's old," I defended. "And… fine, yeah, it squeaks."

She shifted a little, testing it on purpose, making the frame creak under us. Her laugh was low. "Damn, it's gonna make it harder then."

"Catra!" I squeaked. I nudged her side, but she only curled closer, sliding her leg over mine until she was practically wrapped around me. I let her. I wanted her there, as close as possible.

The movie flickered on, forgotten. I caught myself staring at the ceiling, trying to steady the warmth that kept rising in my chest. This wasn't just sneaking a kiss in an empty hallway at school or brushing hands under a cafeteria table. This was her in my house, in my room, her heartbeat steady against me.

"Bet your mom's gonna come in and catch us like this," Catra teased, though her voice had softened, lazy and content.

I swallowed, cheeks burning. “She won’t. She knows to knock.”

She leaned up and kissed my lips, "Good."

I smiled and kissed her back.

We continued to watch the movie, not moving from the position we're in. It was comfortable, I never want this moment to end.

Chapter End Notes

Next chapter is family dinner! I hope you enjoyed this chapter. I enjoyed writing it. :)

Chapter 19: Chapter 19

Chapter Summary

Another fluff chapter.

Warning: there is a small bit of smut; feel free to skip it. :)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra's POV:

We were all sitting down at the dinner table, and I could practically feel the sweat dripping from my forehead. I just had to shove the nervousness down and talk to Adora's parents. How hard can it be? They seem nice enough already.

"So, what are your intentions with my daughter?" Hope asked, her full attention on me.

"Mumm." Adora groaned.

I let out a soft chuckle, "I am planning to give all my love and affection towards her. Ever since she returned to my life, I've never been happier. I'm just really lucky to have her." I smiled towards Adora, holding her hand.

I watched Adora's face get flushed, a small goofy grin appearing on her face.

Mara was practically squealing, "You two are so cute!"

Hope nodded at me; she seemed pleased with the answer. "What are your plans after school?"

I let out a small breath, "Um, honestly, my dream goal was to pursue becoming a musician. But I know it's a difficult career to get into, even if you have talent; it requires a lot of luck." I chuckled, "But I wanna use my talent to become a music teacher as a backup plan if my 'dream' doesn't work."

Hope nodded, "I'm glad you have a plan."

"Music teacher, huh? That's pretty cool, Catra." Mara chimned in.

"Thanks," I chuckled. "It's something I wanted to do for a while. My uh, Weaver wanted me to do something different." I felt Adora's hand rest on my thigh. I know she was trying to comfort me, but all it's doing is driving me insane.

"Weaver?" Hope looked confused.

"My adoptive mother, she's pretty strict on what I do." I rubbed my neck.

Mara and Hope shared a glance before Mara spoke up, "What did she want you to do?"

"Lawyer," I scoffed. "She's set on it."

Adora squeezed my thigh, and I shot her a flustered glare. She looked confused, but quickly understood the message. She removed her hand, clearing her throat. "So, how's Razz been?" Clearly wanting to change the subject.

Hope smiled, "She's been great! She left some pie for us. You guys can have a slice after dinner if you like."

Adora lit up like a kid on Christmas, "Yes!"

I chuckled and continued to eat my dinner; it was smooth after that. It was safe to say that Adora's parents liked me.

...

Adora and I went back to her room after finishing dessert.

"Dude, that might have been the best pie I have ever tasted." I chuckled and leaned against her desk.

Adora smirked and started leaning against the desk next to me, "Told you, it's a masterpiece."

"Yeah, yeah." I rolled my eyes, grabbing the Polaroids from earlier and examining them.

Adora moved closer to me, resting her head on my shoulder. "These are cute."

I smiled, "Yeah, they are. I'm keeping yours; you can have the photo of me." I gave her the picture.

"Deal." She smiled and stared at the photo.

I flopped onto her bed, arms behind my head, and grinned at her. “So, your mums are sweet. Totally ate it up when I told Mara that you never stop talking about those soccer trophies.”

Adora groaned and faceplanted into the blanket beside me. Perfect. I leaned over, enjoying the way her ears turned pink. “What? You mean you *don’t* talk about yourself all the time?”

She muffled something into the blanket. I didn’t catch it, but I didn’t need to; I could see the red creeping down her neck. I rolled onto my side, closing the space between us, until I was close enough to feel her warmth. “God, you’re easy to fluster,” I murmured, brushing a strand of her hair back just to watch her freeze. “It’s adorable.”

Her eyes shot to mine, wide and nervous, and it just made me want to push her further. I let my lips ghost over her jaw, just close enough to feel her shiver.

“You’re insufferable,” she muttered, but her voice cracked halfway through.

“And you love it,” I whispered back, letting the words sink in before I pulled away with a grin.

Adora was halfway between glaring and melting. “You’re going to get us in trouble if my parents—”

I cut her off, laughing under my breath. “Bed’s already squeaky. Might as well make it worth it.”

The way her whole face turned crimson? Worth it. She squeaked out my name, tried to shove me, but I caught her hand and tangled our fingers together instead. Then I kissed her—slow at first, just to tease, then deeper, until she leaned into me without even thinking.

When I finally pulled back, I licked my lips, smirking. “See? Way better than dessert.”

Her forehead pressed to mine, her breath uneven. “You’re unbelievable,” she whispered.

I softened, just a little, brushing my nose against hers. “And you’re stuck with me,” I said.

Adora rolled onto her side, propping her head on her hand, glaring down at me. “You know, I could still kick you out of my bed.”

I grinned, leaning closer. “Please. You’d last ten minutes before dragging me back in.”

She opened her mouth, ready with a comeback, but I cut her off by brushing my lips against hers—just a quick peck this time. She made this startled little noise, then laughed, pushing at my shoulder. “You don’t fight fair.”

“Nope,” I agreed, catching her wrist before she could pull away. I tugged her until she was practically draped over me, her hair falling around us like a curtain. “But you don’t seem to mind.”

Her cheeks were pink again, and I couldn’t resist trailing my fingers along her jaw, down to her collarbone, just to watch her shiver. “You drive me crazy,” she whispered, voice lower now.

I smirked, letting my forehead rest against hers. “Good. Then we’re even.”

For a long moment, we just stayed like that—breath mingling, hearts racing, the whole house quiet except for the faint hum of the heater. I could feel her relax against me, the tension from dinner finally gone.

Then, because I couldn’t help myself, I whispered, “Bet Swift Wind's really jealous right now.”

Her eyes flew open wide, horrified. “Catra!”

I burst out laughing, catching her before she could actually shove me off the bed. “Kidding, kidding! …Mostly.”

The glare she gave me should’ve been deadly, but the smile tugging at her lips ruined the effect. And when she leaned down to kiss me again, I knew she’d already forgiven me.

The kiss started soft, almost careful, but I wasn’t in the mood to play nice. I tangled a hand in her hair, deepening it until she let out this tiny, breathless sound that went straight to my chest. She shifted closer, practically straddling me now, and I smirked against her lips.

“Thought you were gonna kick me out of your bed,” I teased, voice low.

She pulled back just enough to glare down at me, though her face was flushed and her breathing uneven. “Shut up.”

“Make me,” I shot back, tugging her down again.

Her weight pressed me into the mattress, warm and solid, her hand slipping under the hem of my shirt to rest against my waist.

It wasn’t anything scandalous, just her palm flat against my skin—but the way she touched me, careful and desperate all at once, made my pulse trip over itself.

“You’re trouble,” she murmured against my neck, lips brushing over sensitive skin.

“And you’re into it,” I managed, though my voice cracked when her mouth lingered a little longer, a little lower.

She laughed softly, her breath hot against my skin, before meeting my eyes again. There was something wild in the way she looked at me—like she couldn’t believe I was real, like she wanted to memorise every part of me before someone knocked on the door.

I hooked a finger in the collar of her shirt, tugging her closer until there was no space left between us. “Dinner was fine,” I whispered, grinning. “But this? Way better.”

She kissed me hard then, nothing shy about it, and I let myself sink into it, into her, the whole world narrowing down to the heat of her hands and the creak of the bed beneath us.

She brushed against my bottom lip, "Do you wanna..." She said, slightly out of breath.

I chuckled, "Yes. Please."

She let out a soft sigh, running her hand up my shirt, cupping my breast while kissing me again. I let out a soft moan and ran my hand through her hair, slowly taking out her ponytail. As we parted, I watched her hair flow down. I felt my heart skip a beat.

"You're so beautiful, princess," I said, out of breath.

I watched her cheeks turn pink. I chuckled, running my hand down her body until I reached the waistband. Playfully tugging on it. She gave me a nod, and without hesitation, I ran my hand underneath her waistband. She leaned down to kiss me again,

giving me easier access to her. I ran my finger between her slit. Her hips buckled at the touch, letting out a small gasp.

"Easy, princess." I let out a low chuckle.

I started doing a circular motion on her clit, and her breathing started getting faster. "Catra." She let out in a soft moan.

I started going faster. She pressed her lips against mine, trying to hide her moans, even if it didn't exactly work. I could tell she was getting close, so I went faster, and she pulled away, throwing her head back in pleasure. I watched her come undone. She gripped onto my hips and tried to keep herself quiet. I started slowing down, watching her catch her breath before collapsing onto my chest.

"That was... Fuck, Catra." She chuckled.

I let out a soft chuckle, "I don't think we did too badly with the noise, managed to keep the squeaking down." I joked.

Adora laughed, "Shut up." After a short silence, Adora pushed herself up again. "Your turn?" She smirked.

I quickly nodded, "Go for it, princess."

Adora's POV

I wake up to sunlight spilling through the blinds, warm against my face and way too bright for this early. My arm's heavy, numb — because it's under Catra. She's sprawled halfway on top of me like she owns the place. Which, judging by how smug she looks even in her sleep, she probably thinks she does. Her hair's a mess, worse than usual, wild curls sticking in every direction. There's a faint red line along her neck, and my brain unhelpfully reminds me **I** put it there.

I should probably move. Or breathe. Or something. Instead, I stay perfectly still, watching her nose twitch as she stirs. She opens one eye lazily, squinting at me like she's deciding whether I'm worth talking to before noon.

"Morning, blondie," she rasps, voice rough from sleep and… well, last night.

I swallow hard. "Hey, uh, you're crushing my arm."

She smirks. "Maybe you shouldn't have fallen asleep *under* me, then."

"Pretty sure you dragged me down."

"Eh, same thing." She stretches, and the blanket slips just enough to make my heart do a weird backflip. She catches me staring and grins. "You're blushing again, dork."

"I'm not!" I shot back.

Catra props her chin on my chest. "You totally are. It's cute."

"I—" I try to come up with a comeback, but she interrupts by poking my cheek. "You were *way* more confident last night."

"Catra," I grumbled.

"What happened to that girl, huh? The one who—"

I grab a pillow and shove it in her face before she can finish that sentence. She bursts out laughing, muffled by the pillow, then tackles me back into the bed, pinning me down easily. Her grin softens a little when our eyes meet, though. There's still the teasing glint, but underneath it, there was warmth.

For a second, neither of us says anything. I hear her breathing, feeling her heartbeat pressed against mine.

Then she says, softer, “You know… I kinda like waking up like this.”

I smile, brushing a strand of hair from her face. “Me too.”

She grins again, that familiar, mischievous Catra grin. “Good. Because I’m not moving until you make breakfast.”

I scoffed. “You’re unbelievable.”

“Mm-hm. And you love it.” She smirked before getting off me.

I hummed, "What time is it?"

I watched Catra grab her phone to check the time, "Eight." She yawned.

"Hope and Mara should be making breakfast now anyway, wanna get dressed and head down?" I nudged her.

"I am so comfortable right now, Adora. If you drag me out of bed, you will suffer consequences." Catra warned.

I rolled my eyes, "Tough luck." I got out of bed, walking over to my bag to grab new clothes. "I'm gonna take a shower."

"Guess I can't join?" Catra smirked.

"Unless you want to get caught and have a long, awkward conversation with my mum, go ahead." I shot back.

"Fine." She got up and stretched, putting some clothes back on.

...

After my shower, I headed back to my room to see what Catra was doing, but to my surprise, she wasn't there. I shrugged it off and headed downstairs. That's when I spotted Catra laughing with

Mara; they seemed to be getting along well. As I approached them, I realised they were looking through a photo album.

"Mara!" I groaned.

"Hey, Adora." Catra said with her signature smirk, "I didn't know you were such a horse girl."

I felt blush rising to my cheeks, "Shut up! Who doesn't like horses?"

Hope chuckled from the kitchen as she was walking out with a stack of pancakes. "I remember your first riding lesson. I could tell you were a natural the second you hopped on it." She set down the plate on the dining table.

"That would explain Swift Wind," Catra smirked.

"Don't even." I shot back.

"Swift Wind? I can't believe you still have that, Adora." Mara smiled.

"Of course I still have it!" I scoffed.

"Now, now. Let's have breakfast, we don't want hangry Adora."

Catra gave me an amused smirk before sitting down at the table.

The rest of breakfast was fine; Mara and Catra kept talking about stuff I did as a kid. Making me wanna sink into my chair more, I know that Catra enjoyed this. I watched the interaction continue with Catra and my parents and couldn't help but smile. I was really proud of Catra. I'm also proud of my parents for being so kind towards her; it made things so much easier, and I couldn't be happier.

Chapter End Notes

Hope you enjoyed this chapter! I'll see you next weekend with two new chapters :)

Chapter 20: Chapter 20

Chapter Summary

> Heading back home from Adora's parents' house! Just a small chapter :)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra's POV

A few days have gone by since we arrived at Adora's parents' house. It was our last day before we headed back to school, and Adora was hugging her parents goodbye with tears in her eyes. I loaded the last bag into the back of the car and closed the back door.

Adora walked over and kissed my cheek, "Ready to roll?"

I rolled my eyes, "Yes, I'm 'ready to roll'" I chuckled as I got into the passenger seat.

Adora got into the car and honked the horn as she waved goodbye to her parents while we drove out of the driveway. I turned the radio on to fill the quiet atmosphere in the car; it was some random pop song, but I didn't mind. I watched as the cars flew past the window. I heard Adora humming along to the song, which made me giggle.

"What are you giggling at?" Adora looked at me, confused.

"Hm? Oh, nothing. Just the fact that you're humming a Taylor Swift song right now." I smirked.

Adora scoffed dramatically, "And what is wrong with Taylor Swift?"

I let out a cackle, "No way! You're a Swiftie?"

I saw embarrassment wash over Adora's face, "No! I am not!" She huffed.

"You so are, I bet you secretly dance to 'Shake It Off' in your room while I'm out," I smirked, teasing her further.

"I don't!" She said defensively, and rather too quickly.

"Uh-huh, sure." I chuckled.

There was a long pause before Adora spoke up again.

"You know... I did hear you listening to Mariah Carey one time when you thought I was at soccer practice..." She smirked.

I felt heat rise in my cheeks, "So what?! She's actually good!"

"Oh, I know, I just wanted to tease you about some of the moves you were doing." She sounded like she was fighting back a laugh.

I covered my face with my hands, knowing damn well what moves she was talking about. Let's say I pretended the broom was a stripper pole. "Okay! You know what! It's a sexy song to dance to!" I crossed my arms.

"Oh, yes... 'Touch My Body' is definitely fitting." She hummed.

"The song name is literally called 'Touch My Body', I think it's perfectly fitting for a sexy song." I rolled my eyes.

Adora went quiet. I looked over to see her 'thinking' face.

"What are you thinking about?" I raised an eyebrow.

I saw her blush a little, "Nothing, just stuff." She concentrated on the road.

"Oh, nuh-uh. You're gonna tell me, especially since you're blushing right now!" I demanded.

"Catraaa, it's too embarrassing to say." She whined.

I smirked, "Oh? I'm very curious now."

"I... I was just thinking about you dancing again, but... In front of me." She muttered, refusing to look at me.

"Adora Grayskull! You dirty dog, thinking about me giving you a lap dance?" I started wheezing.

"Shut up! I need to focus on driving." She said defensively.

"Uh-huh, or need to concentrate harder on me giving you a lap dance?" I smirked.

She just scoffed, "Whatever."

...

We pass a sign, twenty minutes until we reach the school. The thought makes my stomach twist a little. Back to crowded hallways, essays, pretending we're just friends when we walk across campus.

Adora must sense it, because she glances at me and says, "We'll be okay. It's just another semester."

I nod. "Yeah. With worse food and more gossip."

She laughs. "And Bow trying his hardest to make you join us during activities."

"Don't remind me," I smirked.

Adora reaches for my hand where it rests on the console, her fingers brushing lightly against mine. The sun glints off the

windshield, and for a second, everything slows down. Just her, me, and the road ahead.

“This was the best Christmas I’ve had in a long time,” she says softly.

“Even after I beat you at Mario Kart?” I smirked.

She sighs dramatically. “You cheated.”

“Using skill isn’t cheating, Princess.” I shrugged innocently.

“You shoved me.” She shot me a glare.

I chuckled. “It’s called strategy.”

She’s laughing now. “You’re impossible.”

“And yet,” I say, smirking, “you keep me around.”

“Unfortunately,” she teases, eyes shining.

There was a short pause before I spoke up again.

"Can we get food on the way home? I'm starving." I groan dramatically.

She chuckled, "Sure, what do you want?"

"I'm craving a burger so bad right now, so probably just get McDonald's?" I smiled.

Adora rolled her eyes, "You know that stuff is bad for you, right?"

"Adora, pleeeease!" I whined and gave her sad eyes.

She just sighed and turned a corner, going to the nearest McDonald's.

"Yes!" I smiled.

We later arrived back at the school. The dorm parking lot's half-empty, most students aren't back yet. Snow's melting in uneven patches, leaving muddy streaks of slush along the pavement. Adora parks near our usual spot and cuts the engine. For a moment, everything's quiet. The heater clicks off, the music fades, and it's just us in the stillness of late afternoon.

I crumple the empty wrapper, tossing it into the bag. "You know," I say, "for someone who hates McDonald's, you didn't hesitate to steal my fries."

"That was quality control," she says, dead serious. "I had to make sure they weren't poisoned."

I roll my eyes. "You're lucky you're cute."

She looks over at me, grin softening. "You think I'm cute?"

I blink. "Don't push it, dork." I chuckled. I looked at her for a moment before speaking again. "You know, it's kinda nice being back. Just us."

Adora nods. "Yeah. It feels like home."

Something about the way she says it makes my chest ache — in a good way.

She glances at the dashboard clock and groans. "We should unpack before Glimmer finds out we're back and drags us to some welcome-back hangout."

"Or we could pretend we're still stuck in traffic and eat more fries," I suggest.

"Catra..." She sounded like she was gonna scold me.

"Adora, c'mon, we deserve a break."

“You had one. It was called *winter break*.”

“Fine,” I sigh dramatically, “but only because you look too cute when you’re being responsible.”

“Catra.” She shot a playful glare.

“Okay, okay, I’m getting out.” I held my hands up defensively before getting out of the car.

We climb out of the car, our breath puffing in the cold air. The golden light hits Adora’s hair and makes it look like something out of a movie, all soft and glowing and unfair. She slams the trunk shut after grabbing her duffel and throws me a look.

“Stop staring,” she says.

“I’m not staring,” I lie. “Just… appreciating the view.”

She shakes her head, cheeks pink, and starts toward the dorm entrance.

I jog to catch up, the McDonald’s bag swinging from my hand. “You sure you don’t want a nugget for the walk?”

“Catra.”

“Fine. More for me.” I chucked a nugget into my mouth.

She just let out a small laugh as she shook her head.

We finally made it back to our dorm room, and everything was just like how we left it before leaving. Adora drops her bag and stretches, groaning. “Okay, I’m showering first before unpacking.”

I flop face-first onto the couch. “I’m never moving again.”

“Not even for McDonald’s?” she teases, standing in the doorway.

I peek up at her through my hair. “Only if you’re paying.”

She rolls her eyes. “You’re impossible.”

“And you love me for it,” I smirked.

Her smile softens. “Yeah. I really do.”

Before I can come up with a comeback, she disappears into the bathroom, leaving me sprawled across the couch. I smiled to myself as I pushed myself up and grabbed the TV remote.

As I was scrolling through Netflix, I heard the bathroom door open. I didn't turn my head since I was too focused on finding a movie for us to watch.

"Do you know any good movies we could watch?" I sighed.

"Hm, what about Titanic? I still need to make you watch it." She chuckled.

I turned to look at her, and my mouth quickly went dry. She was still in her towel with her hair out and dripping over her shoulders. I cleared my throat before looking back at the TV. "Isn't that movie like three hours long?"

"Yeah, but it's worth it! Can we please watch it?" She said as she walked into her room to get dressed.

I rolled my eyes, "I don't think I wanna sit through a three-hour movie." I chuckled.

I heard Adora shout out, "I bought you McDonald's! The least you could do is watch this movie with me!"

I groaned, "Fine."

I switched to Disney+ since it was on there instead, and I watched Adora come out in more comfortable clothes. She

jumped on the couch, sitting right next to me. "Are you ready to witness the greatest movie of all time?" She nudges me.

"Greatest movie? I highly doubt that." I smirked.

...

"Okay, how is that drawing still even intact?" I gave her a look.

She shrugged, munching on some snacks, "Just for the plot of the movie, I guess."

"Uh-huh." I chuckled to myself.

Later on in the movie, I hated to admit it, but the movie was actually pretty good. "I can't believe I'm gonna say this, but I'm liking this movie." I sighed.

Adora lit up like a little kid, "Really!? I knew you would like it!" She smiled.

I chuckled and looked back at the TV.

'I want you to draw me like one of your French girls.'

That line made me chuckle a bit, "What does that even mean?"

Adora chuckled, "I don't know, probably another way of saying 'Hey! Can you draw me naked?' or something."

I laughed, "Right."

The movie finished, and I was left in tears. I tried hiding it from Adora, but she seemed to of already caught me. "Are you crying?"

"No! I... I just yawned!" I said defensively.

"Wow, a yawn made you cry that much?" She smirked, crossing her arms.

"Whatever! There was enough room on that stupid wooden arch." I sniffled, wiping a tear away.

Adora chuckled softly, "Aw, I didn't know you were so sensitive."

"Don't push it, Princess." I shoved her playfully.

"I would never." She smirked.

We both got up and ready for bed, I turned the TV off and headed for a shower.

...

I walked into my room with fresh clothes on, regular sweat pants, with a sweater since it was freezing in the house. I saw Adora passed out on my bed already, I just smiled and walked over and got into bed with her, wrapping my arms around her and cuddling her as I started to fall asleep.

Chapter End Notes

I am SO sorry for the late post, I will have the next chapter posted soon I promise :)

I hope everyone had a good weekend!

Chapter 21: Chapter 21

Chapter Summary

Another shortish chapter! I hope you enjoy it :)

Summary;

Catra finally decided to reveal their relationship to the friend group.

Adora gets accepted into her dream college!

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora's POV:

There was loud music surrounding us at the New Year's party. Glimmer decided to throw a small party with all our friends as we counted down the hours to the new year. I looked around for Catra. I found her talking to Scorpia and Perfuma. I made my way over and nudged Catra slightly.

"Hey guys! Enjoying the party?" I smiled as I looked at the trio.

"Yeah! Oh gosh, it's so nice of you to invite me!" Scorpia smiled; she looked like she was about to pounce on me for a hug.

"No problem, you're always welcome to our hangouts." I chuckled.

"Wanna go grab a drink?" Catra whispered into my ear.

I nodded, "Sure, I'll see you two around." I walked off with Catra.

There was a pause for a moment; it honestly looked like Catra was struggling to get some words out. I felt a worried feeling rush through my body, “Hey, are you okay?” I placed a hand on her shoulder.

Catra snapped out of her trance and looked at me, a small smile quickly appearing on her face. “Yeah! I’m just thinking about something.” She poured a small bit of a bottle of Jack Daniel’s into a cup and filled the rest with Coke. “I’ve just been thinking about us.”

I raised an eyebrow, “Oh? In a good way, I hope?”

That made her chuckle a bit, “Obviously, dummy. I just think that I wanna tell our friends about us.”

I felt excitement rush through my body, “Oh my god! Really!?”

“Calm down, Princess.” She chuckled.

“Sorry, sorry. What about... You know? Are you sure you want to do this?" I offered her a small smile.

Catra paused for a moment, "She can suck a dick if she finds out," She chuckled. "I love you too much; it's getting hard to control myself around you. And it went well with your parents." She added.

"Oh? I didn't know I was so irresistible." I winked at her.

She rolled her eyes, "Yeah, don't let it feed your ego too much."

I laughed, grabbing a nearby drink. "I think I will." I took a sip while staring at her, "I mean, at least we could do a New Year's kiss now, hm?"

Catra let out a chuckle, "I guess so, Princess."

...

"10. 9, 8 7, 6, 5, 4, 3, 2, 1! Happy New Year!" Everyone cheered.

Catra grabbed my waist, pulling me close to her and smashing her lips against mine. I immediately melted into the kiss, throwing my arms around her neck. I heard some small gasps and whistling as we were full-blown out, making out. Once we pulled away, we both started giggling.

"I knew it! Bow, you owe me $20!" Glimmer shouted.

I heard Bow groan while walking off to get his wallet.

"You bet on us!?" I glared at her.

Glimmer looked sheepish as she scratched her neck, "I was honestly feeling some tension between you two."

Catra just started laughing.

"It's not funny!" I failed to hold back a smile while smacking Catra's shoulder.

"I'm sorry! It's just that... All that sneaking around was pointless!" She continued laughing.

Scorpia chimed in, "How long has this been a thing?"

Catra calmed down, "A Few months now. We started in the middle of last semester."

"Wow, can't even remember what day we made it official." I rolled my eyes playfully.

"Okay, I bet you don't even know!" She countered.

"Actually, I can! We were watching 'To All The Boys I Loved Before' and it was after our... mini fight but! We made it official on that night." I smirked, crossing my arms proudly.

I watched Catra's face go from surprised to a smirk, "You're such a sap."

"Okay, you guys making it official while watching that movie is so gay." Bow walked back with his wallet, handing a $20 bill to his girlfriend.

I rolled my eyes, "Whatever."

It's been a few weeks after New Year's, and we're a week into the semester. I haven't been able to talk to Catra as much since she was really busy with her school work, which is understandable after knowing what her 'mother' was like. We still manage to have some movie nights, but it's rare. Soccer practice has been good. I've been managing to avoid injuries, thank god. Last game, scholarship scouts from the Bright Moon University were watching us. That thought alone made me queasy. I tried putting my best into the game, so I'm hoping I have a good shot.

I walked into our dorm room, and I didn't see Catra anywhere, so I headed to my room to check my application status at a few colleges I applied to. I sat down at my desk and opened my laptop. As I opened the site, I noticed that my application had been updated. I felt my heart race, I dragged my cursor to the refresh button, and looked at the letter.

"Congratulations! I'm pleased to inform you that you've been admitted to Bright Moon University."

I froze, reading it again to make sure I read it right.

"Congratulations! I'm pleased to inform you that you've been admitted to Bright Moon University."

I actually squealed, calling Hope and Mara. It rang a few times before they picked up.

"Hey, sweetie! What's up?" I heard Mara's voice come from the other end.

"I GOT INTO BRIGHT MOON UNIVERSITY! THAT'S WHAT'S UP!" I screamed, a little too excited.

"WHAT!? Adora, that's amazing, I am so proud of you!" Mara cheered from the other end. *"I can't wait to see you at your graduation!"*

"Me too!" I chuckled. I then heard the door open and close. Catra must be home. "I gotta go, Catra's home."

"Okay, sweetie! I am so proud of you. I'll tell Hope as soon as she gets home." She replied.

"Love you!"

"Love you more!"

I hung up and sprinted out of my room to find Catra. I found her placing food on the kitchen counter, and she froze, staring at me like I was crazy.

"Uh, I know you love food, but I have never seen you sprint out of your room like that..." She slowly chuckled.

"Catra!" I squeaked, pulling her into a tight hug.

"Whoa! Down, Princess. What is going on with you?" Catra laughed as she pulled away to look at me.

"I got accepted into Bright Moon University!" I jumped up and down.

Catra's face lit up, "What?! That's amazing, babe! I'm so proud of you." She hugged me tightly.

"There are still other colleges I'm waiting for, but that was my dream one! I'm just so happy!" I cackled, grabbing my food and walking over to the couch.

Catra did the same. As she sat down, she grabbed the remote and passed it to me, "You get to pick the movie tonight."

I smiled and gracefully took the remote, scrolling through Netflix before landing on 'Mean Girls.' I heard Catra make a playful scoff as I picked it. She says she hates it, but she continues to quote the movie with me.

...

I flicked off the TV, the glow of the credits fading from the small dorm room screen. “Okay,” I said, stretching my arms above my head. “You *have* to admit it’s funny.”

Catra groaned dramatically from where she sat cross-legged on the couch, surrounded by a battlefield of empty soda cans. “It’s *so* dumb, Adora. Like, who writes a movie about girls fighting over boys and cafeteria tables?”

I smirked. “You laughed, though.”

“That was out of *pity*,” Catra shot back, standing up and brushing crumbs off her hoodie.

“Oh yeah? Then why did you quote... what was it? ‘You can’t sit with us!’ like five minutes ago?” I smirked.

Catra froze mid-step, a tiny blush creeping onto her face. “That doesn’t count. That’s cultural knowledge. Everyone knows that line.” She said in a defensive tone.

“Mhm,” I said, grinning as I gathered our mugs from the desk. “Sure, cultural knowledge. Next, you’ll tell me you didn’t call Glimmer a ‘Grotsky little byotch’ yesterday.”

“That was contextual!” Catra said, following her into the tiny dorm kitchenette. “And she deserved it for stealing my chips.”

I laughed, setting the mugs in the sink. “You like it.”

“I *don’t!*”

“You *do.*”

“Fine, maybe a *little*,” Catra muttered, crossing her arms. “But only because Damian is kinda funny.”

I smiled at her softly. “See? I knew I’d convert you eventually.”

Catra rolled her eyes, but there was the faintest hint of a smirk. “You’re so proud of yourself for that, huh?”

“Absolutely.”

By the time we finished cleaning up, the clock on my desk read 11:47. The dorm was quiet except for the hum of the heater and the muffled sound of someone’s late-night playlist down the hall. I yawned and started getting ready for bed. Brushing my teeth, untying my hair, flicking off the desk lamp.

When I came back into my room, I froze.

There was Catra, sprawled across my bed—MY bed—half under the blanket, curled up with one of my hoodies clutched like a pillow. Her hair was a messy halo against the pillowcase, and her breathing had already gone soft and even.

I leaned against the doorframe, feeling my heart melting. I whispered, “You were supposed to go to your own room, you dork.”

Catra shifted slightly, mumbling something that sounded suspiciously like, “You can’t sit with us,” before burying her face deeper into the hoodie.

I stifled a laugh, shaking my head. I walked over quietly and pulled the blanket up around Catra’s shoulders. Catra murmured again but didn’t wake, just instinctively moved closer, her hand

brushing against my arm. I hesitated a second, then sighed with a small smile and climbed in next to her. Catra immediately shifted, tucking herself against my side like she'd been waiting for her the whole time.

"Fine," I whispered, brushing a strand of hair off Catra's face. "You can sit with me."

Catra smiled in her sleep, and my chest went warm.

I pressed a soft kiss to Catra's forehead, whispering, "You're so full of it," before closing her eyes and letting the room fall quiet.

Chapter End Notes

Hope you enjoyed this chapter! Sorry for the lack of posting this weekend, been super busy. I'll see you next weekend.

We're also getting close to the end of the chapter...

Chapter 22: Chapter 22

Chapter Summary

TW: Weaver, obviously. Hints of self-harm and emotional abuse.

Adora and Catra go on a double date with Bow and Glimmer!

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra's POV:

I've been getting back into songwriting lately. There's a new song I've been working on, and I'm honestly proud of it. I grabbed my guitar and tried to figure out a melody for it, but I already had an idea in my mind. Adora isn't at the dorm at the moment since she's hanging out with Bow and Glimmer for brunch, so I don't have to worry about keeping it down.

I heard my phone buzzing on my desk, at first I thought it might've just been Adora until I realised what day it was, Weaver call day. I quickly rushed over and picked up the phone. "Hey, Miss Weaver," I said blankly.

"Catra. How's school going?" She responded, her voice still cold as always.

"It's been good, I've gotten my grades up."

"Hm, I can see that. Well done." Weaver nodded, "There is something I wanted to ask you."

I felt my heart race; my mind was racing with thoughts. "Yeah?" I managed to get out.

"Hm, I see you've found Adora again." She replied.

I felt my heart drop, but she couldn't know that I was dating her, right? "Oh, yeah. She turned out to be my roommate, crazy luck, huh?"

I heard her hum, "Yes, lucky indeed. She's a clever girl; you better not drag her down."

I felt a pang of anger rush through me, "I won't."

"Mmhmm, better not. Knowing you." Weaver added.

I snapped, "I'm not a total fuck up, you know?"

Weaver went silent. I quickly felt sick and regretted what I said. "You'd better watch your tone, Catra."

I went quiet. Normally, I would quickly apologise, but this time, I decided that enough was enough. She couldn't hurt me now, I'm away from her. "No, I'm done with your shit. You treated me like a parasite my entire life! I'm done with it and I'm done with you!" I gritted my teeth.

"Catra, I'm warning you."

"No! I'm sick of your 'warnings.' What are you going to do anyway? Hit me through the phone?" I let out a chuckle, "You can't do anything. And guess what? Adora is actually doing amazing, especially with me!"

"I highly doubt that. I bet you're making her feel like shit with all your problems." Weaver chuckled coldly.

I let out a disbelief scoff, "And who gave me those problems? Adora is going to her dream college, and I couldn't be more proud

of her. She's the best thing that's ever happened to me, and I love her!" I quickly went silent after realising what I just blurted out.

"Love? Oh, no. That won't do, she could do much better than... You." Weaver said coldly, "I can't believe you manipulated her into liking girls, or even you. I knew you were disgraceful the moment I laid eyes on you... I only adopted you out of pity. What you're doing is sinful behaviour, Catra. Be careful, next time I see you, it won't be pretty."

Weaver then hung up.

I lowered the phone from my ear, staring at it in my hand. My whole body was shaking, threw my phone across the room. Thankfully, it landed on my bed. I quickly grabbed the lighter and stared at it for a moment, flicking it on and off. I heard a door open from outside my room, and I quickly shoved the lighter back into my drawer. I looked into my mirror, taking deep breaths before walking out.

Adora was putting a bag down on the bench, "Catra!"

"I'm right here." I chuckled as I leaned against my doorframe.

"Oh, hey!" She quickly ran over and hugged me. "I got you some stuff from the cafe, the cheesecake is actually to die for." She chuckled and dragged me over to the kitchen.

"You didn't have to," I smiled.

She rolled her eyes, "Of course I had to, dummy."

My smile faltered a bit, walking behind Adora as she grabbed the stuff out of the bags. I wrapped my arms around her waist and rested my face on her neck.

"You okay, Kitkat?" It's like she could sense how I'm feeling.

"Yeah, just got off a call with Weaver." I chuckled slightly.

Adora immediately turned around to face me, "You okay?"

I shook my head, "I don't wanna talk about it right now."

She kisses my head before wrapping her arms around me, "Okay, another time. You wanna try this cheesecake?"

I chuckled, "Yeah, sure."

"You excited for our double date later?" Adora smirked.

"Duh!" I chuckled before biting into the cheesecake. "Even though I am not excited for Glimmer and Bow asking a shit ton of questions."

"Oh, shush." She chuckled.

We're meeting Glimmer and Bow at this cozy Italian restaurant that Glimmer picked. String lights on the ceiling, fake ivy crawling up the walls, and the smell of garlic butter everywhere. Adora loves it. I can tell because she's already smiling like a dork before we even sit down.

"Do you think they're already here?" she asks, holding my hand as we walk in.

I glance around and spot Glimmer's bright pink hair immediately. "Yeah. Hard to miss the human glowstick."

Adora snorts. "Be nice."

"I *am* being nice," I mumble, but she grins at me.

Glimmer waves us over like she's flagging down a plane. Bow's beside her, looking chill as always, his arm draped over the back of her chair. "Finally!" Glimmer exclaimed, standing up to hug

Adora, then turning to Catra with a teasing grin. "And *you*—look at you! I didn't think I'd ever see you in a dress."

Catra glanced down at her short black dress, shrugged. "Don't get used to it."

Bow grinned widely. "You both look great! Seriously, I'm so happy we're doing this."

Adora beamed. Catra just rolled her eyes, but couldn't help the small smile creeping onto her face.

The waiter came by to take their drink orders, a young guy with dark curls and a warm smile, name tag reading **Mateo**. "Buenas noches," he greeted with an accent that immediately caught Catra's attention. "Can I start you off with something to drink?"

Glimmer blinked, slightly thrown off by the greeting. But before anyone could answer, Catra leaned forward with a small grin.

"Sí, claro. ¿Tienen horchata o solo refrescos normales?" she asked casually.

Mateo blinked, then broke into a grin. "¡Ah! Sí, tenemos horchata. ¿Quieres una?"

"Sí, por favor," Catra said, smiling a little wider than usual.

Adora, Bow, and Glimmer all froze like someone had hit pause on them.

Mateo nodded at the rest of the group. "¿Y ustedes?"

"Uh—just water," Adora said, still looking at Catra like she'd just performed magic.

When Mateo walked away, Glimmer leaned across the table. "Okay, wait—since when do *you* speak Spanish?"

Catra shrugged, pretending to be interested in the silverware. “Since always?”

Bow’s jaw dropped. “You *never* told us that!”

Adora blinked. “You never told *me* that!”

Catra smirked. “You never asked.”

Adora leaned closer, voice a little soft with surprise. “That was… really hot, actually.”

Glimmer groaned. “Okay, *please* don’t start flirting in two languages, my brain can’t handle that.”

"Okay, but seriously. How do you know Spanish?" Adora glanced at me.

"You do know I'm half Hispanic, right?" I chuckled slightly.

Adora rolled her eyes, "No shit, we grew up together, but I never heard you speak it."

I nodded, "After you left the Orphanage, I was put into many different foster homes. I stayed with a Hispanic family for a while, and they taught me how to speak the language and other stuff. They were really lovely, I miss them a lot, but I had to move into another home. And it just had to be Weaver's. Also, I did Spanish lit before I moved to Brightmoon." I shrugged.

The three were so invested in what I was saying, it was slightly weird having all their eyes concentrated on me.

"That's so cool! Say something else, please!" Adora begged me.

I rolled my eyes and smirked, Cuidado, princesa. Quizás lo use en la cama más tarde esta noche."

"What did you say?" Bow asked.

"You wouldn't wanna know, Arrow Boy," I smirked.

Adora paused for a moment, then understood what I meant. Blushing intensely before 'browsing' the menu.

...

The rest of the night was nice, the double date didn't go as horrible as I expected it to be. Of course, Glimmer and Bow barged us with questions, but it was to be expected. Surprisingly, they weren't horrible to hang out with. We both said our goodbyes and headed off to our cars to drive back to the school dorms.

Adora got into the driver's seat and put her seatbelt on. "Had fun tonight?"

"Surprisingly, it wasn't that bad. I was expecting worse."

She smirked, "Told you."

"Sí, sí. Guárdalo en tus pantalones." I muttered.

Adora stared at me for a moment, "Just wait until we get home, you have no idea how much you were driving me insane tonight."

I chuckled, "Can't wait, princess."

Chapter End Notes

Hm, who knew Catra could speak Spanish?

Hope you enjoyed the chapter! The next chapter will be posted soon. :)

Chapter 23: Chapter 23

Chapter Summary

TW: Talks about self-harm.

Weaver pays a little visit.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora's POV:

Last night ended with... I guess you could figure it out. I woke up next to Catra, who was peacefully sleeping. I got out of bed and put some clothes on before heading out to make some breakfast. I was too exhausted to make a proper breakfast, so I just poured out some cereal. I heard noises coming from the room. Later, Catra walked out with an oversized shirt with shorts.

"Hey, Catra. You want some breakfast?" I smiled, holding the box of cereal up.

She chuckled, "Yeah, sure."

I grabbed an extra bowl and poured some cereal out, grabbing the milk. "So, did you enjoy last night?" I smiled, pouring the milk in.

"Which part?" She smirked as she grabbed a spoon.

I rolled my eyes, "The double date, but I won't lie and say I didn't enjoy the other thing." I winked.

She chuckled as she had a spoonful of cereal.

After a small moment of finishing the food in her mouth, she then spoke. "It wasn't as bad as I thought, Sparkles and Arrow Boy aren't that bad."

I nodded, "I'm gonna head to the gym, I'll be back in two hours?" I smiled as I went to my room to get ready.

"Alright, princess. Don't push yourself too hard." She yelled back.

...

When I got back to the dorm, my muscles still ached from the gym. The kind of ache that felt good—earned. My hoodie was half-zipped, hair still a little damp from the shower I'd taken there, and all I wanted was to crash on my bed for five minutes before starting on the essay I'd been putting off. I walked into our dorm but heard a guitar coming from Catra's room.

From behind the room door came the faint sound of guitar strings—soft, careful. Then a voice followed, low and smooth, almost hesitant. I froze, my hand halfway to the doorknob. She never played when I was around, well, except for that one time when I made her.

She was singing.

Her voice was… beautiful. There was a slight rasp to it, like she was afraid to be too loud, but it made every word sound more real.

"I want you to know, I don't need anything fancy.

I just need me and you slow dancing."

I leaned against the wall beside the door, heart hammering in my chest. It felt wrong to eavesdrop, but I couldn't bring myself to interrupt. The song wasn't one I recognised—it sounded like something she'd written herself.

Her voice wavered a little near the end, then faded into the last hum of guitar strings. I waited until I heard her exhale—a long, quiet sigh—before I finally pushed the door open.

Catra was sitting cross-legged on her bed, guitar resting in her lap, eyes wide when she saw me. “Oh—uh, hey.” She blinked, clearly startled. “Didn’t hear you come in.”

I smiled, “Yeah, I noticed.”

Her cheeks flushed a little. “You, uh… You didn’t hear anything, did you?”

“Maybe a little,” I admitted, unable to stop the grin tugging at my lips. “You’re really good, Catra.”

She rolled her eyes, but there was a shy smile fighting its way through. “Please. I was just messing around.”

“Messing around sounds amazing, then.” I sat down on my bed across from her. “You wrote that?”

Her gaze dropped to the strings, fingers fidgeting. “Yeah. It’s stupid. Just something I’ve been working on when I can’t sleep.”

“It’s not stupid.” My voice softened without me meaning to. “I liked it.”

She peeked up at me, her smirk finally winning. “You’re just saying that ‘cause you’re in love with me.”

I snorted, tossing a pillow at her. “Maybe. Doesn’t make it less true.”

"Whatever, do you wanna hear the chorus?" She leaned against her guitar.

"Duh!" I smiled and sat down next to her.

She cleared her throat and started playing the guitar again.

"I don't need anything fancy, I just need me and you slow dancing.

Hell's bending, keeping me captive.

Heaven's here, it's right where you're standing.

Slow dancing."

She had a goofy grin on her face as she set the guitar against the wall, "So, that's it."

I stared at her in awe, "That was amazing, Catra."

She rolled her eyes, "Yeah, yeah. It was nothing." She kissed me before getting up.

I got up and followed her, "Seriously though, you should think about performing for the school! Remember the thing I told you about last semester?"

"Oh, like how they grab random music students to perform for the Prom or School Talent Show? I remember, and it's a hard pass." She smirked.

"Think about it!" I nudged her. "Also, have you heard back from any colleges?"

Catra turned to me, a different emotion on her face. "I don't know, I've been too scared to check."

I nodded, "I'll sit with you tonight if you want?"

"Alright."

We both got interrupted by a knock at the door, and we turned to look at each other, puzzled.

"Did Arrow Boy or Glimmer say something about coming today?" She walked over to the door.

"No, they didn't mention anything--" I got cut off by Catra letting out a small squeal. "Are you okay?" I walked over to her, noticing a tall, skinny, and old woman standing at the door.

"Hm, you must be, Adora. You may not remember me, but I used to work at the Orphanage. Before I adopted Catra." She glared down towards her.

Fuck, what the hell is she doing here? I got to make sure Catra is safe.

"Uh, yeah... I don't remember you. May I ask what you're doing here? Normally, parents don't visit during school times." I said calmly.

"I need to speak with my daughter..." She gave a cold smile before turning to Catra.

Catra gave me a scared look, and I immediately felt protective and stepped in. "Sorry, what about? Couldn't this be done over the phone?"

"This is none of your concern." She glared at me.

I can understand what Catra means now.

"Well, you're in our dorm, so it kinda is my business now." I crossed my arms.

"Hm, I don't understand why someone as perfect as you would associate with the likes of Catra. All she would do is bring you down. You should be careful." She said in a cold tone.

Something in me snapped, "Excuse me?"

"You heard me, she's already ruining you by coercing you to date her." She leaned down slightly.

"Alright, here's how things are going to go. You will get the fuck out of this dorm, or I will call the police. I know what you've done to Catra, and I am not worried about reporting you. And I have pretty good connections to the police since I'm friends with the Bright family. Think about what you do next." I stepped up to her.

She went quiet, shooting Catra a look before speaking. "Very well, see you soon. Adora." And with that, she left.

"Don't ever come back!" I slammed the door, immediately rushing over to Catra and pulling her into a hug.

She started sobbing into my arms.

"It's okay, she's gone. You're okay, Catra." I kissed her head before rubbing her back.

"Adora..." She pulled away a bit; she looked like she was struggling to get something out.

"What? Take your time, you can tell me." I reassured her.

"I burned myself, multiple times." She covered her face.

I felt my heart drop. I pulled her into another hug. "Okay, it's okay. Where's the lighter?" I said softly.

"In the desk drawer." She let out a sigh.

"Okay, let's sit you on the couch." I helped her over to the couch and sat her down.

I walked into her room and grabbed the lighter. I placed it in my pocket before coming back out. "Do you want some water?" I offered.

She nodded, "That'd be nice."

I grabbed some water and walked over to her, sitting down next to her. "Here, now... What do you wanna watch?"

She looked at me a bit confused, "Uh... I don't know."

I could tell that she's confused about how I'm not asking her about the harm. "Okay, do you wanna talk about it now? Or try to calm down after the whole situation that happened?" I smiled gently.

She gave me a small smile; she looked grateful. "I don't deserve you. Can we discuss it later?"

I nodded, pulling her into a cuddle. "Alright! Now, Brooklyn Nine-Nine?"

She chuckled. "Duh."

A few hours later, I paused the show and looked at her. "Okay, I think we should talk about what happened now," I said gently.

Catra's face fell a bit, "I guess it was gonna happen sooner or later."

I nodded, "Can I ask when the burning started?"

She let out a long sigh, "After I found out I failed that math test, the call from Weaver set it off mostly, though."

I nodded slowly, "Alright, I want you to know I'm not mad at you. I never could be. I just want you to promise me that to will talk to me instead of using this as a way out, okay?"

Catra started tearing up, but nodded, "I promise."

I pulled her into a hug, "Everything is going to be okay, I promise. I'm here for you, and things will get better."

...

“Catra,” I said carefully, “you’ve been walking in circles for fifteen minutes.”

She stopped mid-step, running a hand through her messy hair. “You’d be nervous too if your entire future was about to pop up in your inbox.” She sighed but sat down, legs bouncing restlessly. Her hand brushed against mine, fingers twitching like she wasn’t sure whether to grab on or pull away. I decided for her and gently took her hand.

For a second, she didn’t move. Then she squeezed back, tight, like she was grounding herself.

“Do you think I got in?” she asked quietly. Her voice was softer than usual, stripped of the sharp sarcasm she used to hide behind.

I looked at her, really looked at her—at the determination in her eyes, the way she’d worked so hard for this. Late nights studying, skipping hangouts to finish essays, and asking me to quiz her until both of us were half-asleep.

“I *know* you did,” I said. “You earned it.”

She scoffed. “Yeah, tell that to the admissions board.”

Right on cue, her laptop pinged.

Both our heads snapped toward it.

Catra froze. “That’s it.”

I nodded, heart thudding. “You gonna open it?”

“I—uh—” She blinked, like she’d forgotten how. “You open it.”

“What? No way, it’s your email!”

“Exactly! That’s why you should do it. I might throw up.”

I laughed nervously but leaned forward anyway. “Okay, okay. On three?”

She nodded, gripping my arm like it was a lifeline.

“One... two... three—”

She clicked the mouse before I could.

The email loaded, slow enough to be cruel. We both held our breath. Then the words appeared—*Congratulations!*—and Catra let out the loudest, most disbelieving laugh I’d ever heard.

“I—holy crap, I got in!” she shouted, eyes wide. “I got in, Adora!”

"We're going to the same college!" I tackled her to the bed and laughed.

We both laughed for a while before sitting up, "I can't believe it." She sighed.

"I can! You deserve this! I'm so proud of you!" I kissed her cheek.

"Ugh! Get off mee!" She giggled but didn't actually put up a fight.

"Absolutely not! We gotta celebrate, I'll order dinner, and you can pick whatever you wanna do tonight! We could try out the game you bought?" I smiled.

"The Last of Us?!" She grinned.

"Yes, yes. Go set it up while I order." I chuckled.

“Okay, okay, so this part’s easy,” she said, her tongue poking out slightly in concentration as she navigated through a dark hallway in The Last of Us. “You just have to sneak past the clickers. Stealth, baby.”

I leaned over the back of the couch, watching. “Catra, you literally can’t do stealth. You always end up punching something.”

“Excuse me?” she said, eyes wide in fake offence. “I’m perfectly capable of stealth. Watch and learn, princess.”

I smirked. “Sure.”

Ten seconds later, she accidentally threw a bottle in the game at a clicker. The sound drew every clicker within a mile. She yelped, panic instantly replacing her confidence. “RUN—RUNRUNRUNRUN—” she yelled, jamming the buttons like her life depended on it. Joel got tackled before she even made it to the next room.

I couldn’t hold it in. I was laughing so hard I nearly fell off the couch. “Oh yeah, that was *real stealthy.* I’m sure the clickers were totally fooled by your battle cry.”

She turned around and tossed me a glare that didn’t match the smile tugging at her lips. “You wanna try, smartass?”

I grinned, taking the controller when she handed it over. “Gladly.”

She scooted up beside me on the couch, pulling her legs under her and leaning just close enough that I could feel her shoulder against mine. I tried not to get distracted, not by the warmth of her or the faint smell of her shampoo. I focused on the screen.

Except she didn’t make that easy.

As soon as I started sneaking around the corner in-game, she whispered dramatically, “Don’t mess up, Adora. One wrong move and *boom,* we’re dinner.”

“Catra—”

“Click, click, click—” she hissed, imitating a clicker sound right next to my ear.

I jumped, nearly dropping the controller. She burst out laughing.

“Not funny,” I muttered, even though I was smiling.

“Oh, it was hilarious,” she said, still giggling.

I finally managed to get past the infected without dying, and she gave a little cheer. “Look at you, Miss Stealth Queen.”

“Told you,” I said, leaning back smugly.

She rolled her eyes, but her grin softened. “Fine. You win this round.” Then she nudged my knee with hers. “But I’m getting popcorn. Don’t play ahead without me.”

As she stood and padded over to the microwave, I glanced at her — the soft light from the TV flickering across her face, the faint smile she wore when she thought I wasn’t looking.

We’d spent so many nights like this — laughing, teasing, arguing over games or movies — but something about tonight felt different. Maybe it was the way her laughter still echoed in my chest, or how natural it felt having her this close.

When she came back and plopped down beside me again, she passed me the bowl, then rested her head on my shoulder without a word.

I didn’t say anything either. I just kept playing, the sounds of The Last of Us fading into the background.

Chapter End Notes

Song: "Slow Dancing" by Aly & AJ

Hope you enjoyed this chapter! See you next weekend. :)

Chapter 24: Chapter 24

Chapter Summary

College decisions...

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra's POV

A week and a half have passed since getting accepted into Brightmoon University. Now I'm staring at my laptop at 1 am, reading the words "You have been accepted into the University of Horde." After getting the letter a few days ago, I stared at my computer for ages, contemplating my thoughts on this situation. This was my dream college and I got in... But that was before I met Adora again; now my feelings are confused.

After receiving the acceptance letter for Brightmoon, I completely forgot about Horde. All I was thinking in that moment was that Adora and I would be going to the same college together. But now? I have this shoved into my face, making my thoughts fucking jumble. Of course, I wanna go to college with Adora, why wouldn't I? She means everything to me, but THIS is my dream college. I pushed myself in school to try and get in, and now I have.

Horde has an excellent music program, Brightmoon doesn't have one... That's the big thing that is making my decision harder: choosing between my girlfriend and a career I want to pursue.

I heard a knock on my door, snapping me out of my thoughts. "Uh, come in." I quickly closed the tab on my laptop.

Adora walked in, looking tired but also confused. "Why are you up?"

"Why are you?" I smirked.

She rolled her eyes and walked in, "I lost my nose spray." She chuckled.

I chuckled, "Blocked nose? Uh, I think it's on my bedside table?" I pointed towards the area.

She nodded and walked over, finding it and using it not long after. "Oh, thank fuck."

"Relieved?" I smirked.

"Very. Goodnight, you should go to bed soon as well." She kissed my forehead.

"I will, just finishing something up." I smiled.

She smiled and headed back to her room, closing the door.

I shut my laptop, leaving this situation for tomorrow to deal with. I got up from my desk and flopped onto my bed, playing my sleep playlist as I drifted off to bed.

...

I wake up to sunlight slicing through the blinds, right across my face. Great. I groan, roll over, and immediately remember what happened... The letter.

Adora’s already up, humming as she moves around our little dorm kitchen, hair messy but somehow still golden and perfect. She’s making breakfast — toast, eggs, and coffee, like always. The smell should be comforting. Instead, it just knots my stomach tighter. I sighed, grabbed a hoodie to throw on and walked out

into the kitchen. I have to tell her sooner or later; might as well get it out of the way now.

"Hey! I'm making pancakes, believe it or not... And I haven't burned them!" Adora has that dumb grin, which I love...

"That's surprising, princess," I smirked.

"Big day, right? I was thinking after class we could look at Brightmoon's housing stuff online, see if we can request to room together again." She beamed, she's been talking about this stuff for days now, at first I was on board, but after that letter... I can't help but hold my breath.

"Yeah... Big day." I forced a smile; thankfully, she wasn't looking at me.

"Can you believe we actually did it? Brightmoon! We're gonna crush it there." She finished up the last few pancakes, sliding a plate over to me with the bottle of syrup.

She's so happy.

"Adora," I start, my voice quieter than I want it to be. "I, uh… I got another letter last night."

Her fork pauses mid-air. "Another one?"

"Yeah." I swallow hard. "From the University of Horde. Their music program. They accepted me." I rubbed my neck awkwardly.

"Okay, that's cool!" She smiled, but I could tell it was forced. "I didn't know you applied."

"Yeah, it's um... Actually, my dream college." I chuckled awkwardly.

Adora just took a bite out of a pancake, nodding. "Well... If that's where you wanna go." She mumbled.

I sighed, "Yeah."

"But, Brightmoon has music too?" She said, trying to convince me.

"It's not the same." I sighed.

“Catra, Brightmoon has everything we talked about. You already got in there! Why would you even want to go to Horde?” She sighed.

“Because they actually have a music program, Adora,” I snapped. “It’s not just some random elective there, it’s real. They’ve got recording studios, live performance spaces, professors who actually know what they’re talking about.” It's like she wasn't even listening to me.

“And Brightmoon has—”

“Political science and engineering majors,” I interrupt. “You’re going there because it’s perfect for you.”

She frowns. “I thought we wanted to stay together.”

“We did,” I say. “We do. But maybe… maybe that’s not the only thing that matters.”

Her jaw tightens. “So what, you just want to throw away everything we planned? The dorms, the classes, us—”

“Don’t,” I cut in, glaring. “Don’t make this about us like I’m betraying you.”

“I’m not—”

“Yes, you are!” I shove my chair back, the scrape echoing too loudly in the small room. “You’re acting like I’m doing something wrong for wanting my own thing.”

She stands now too, voice rising. “I’m not saying it’s wrong, Catra! I just— it’s *Brightmoon*! It’s safe, it’s close, and we’d be together!

Horde's in the middle of nowhere, and their rep is—"

"Who cares about their reputation?!" I explode. "It's what I *want*! For once, I actually know what I want, and it's not just following you around pretending that's enough!"

Her eyes widen. The silence that follows is deafening.

I didn't mean to say it like that.

But it's out now, hanging between us like smoke from a fire that's already spreading.

Adora's voice drops low, hurt creeping in around the edges. "So that's what this was? Just you following me?"

I rub a hand over my face, frustrated. "That's not—ugh, that's not what I meant. I just— you make everything sound so easy. Like it's all supposed to fit perfectly, but it doesn't, okay? Not for me."

She crosses her arms again, looking down. "I just thought… we'd do this together."

I sigh, my throat tight. "I know. I did too."

She doesn't say anything else. She just stares at the floor, the excitement that filled the room ten minutes ago completely gone.

I want to reach for her. To take it back. To make her smile again.

But instead, I whisper, "I just need to think, okay?"

Adora nods, slowly. "Yeah. Sure."

I walked back to my room, "Thanks for making breakfast..." I closed the door.

After that long morning, we've avoided each other all day. I think we're just having a break from talking at the moment.

I sat cross-legged on my bed, laptop open but forgotten. The email from the University of Horde still glowed on the screen — that bold, mocking *"Congratulations!"* staring back at me like it knew exactly how confused I was.

I'd gotten accepted into their music program last night. The one I'd dreamed about for years. The one I wasn't supposed to actually get. My guitar leaned against the wall beside me, quiet and accusing. Normally, I'd be playing by now, trying to think through the noise in my head. But I couldn't even bring myself to touch it.

Then my phone buzzed on the nightstand, Unknown number. I stared at it for a few seconds before picking it up.

"Uh, hello?"

"Hi! Is this Catra Weaver?" The voice was friendly, cheerful — the kind of voice that made you feel bad for hesitating. "This is Ms Leena from the University of Horde admissions office. We're just following up to confirm your enrollment decision. We'd love to have you in our music program, but the deadline is today."

"Oh. Right. Today."

My stomach dropped. I'd been pretending I had more time.

Leena kept talking, polite and professional, but all I could hear was the sound of my heart pounding. My eyes flicked over to the desk, where another envelope sat open — *Brightmoon University.*

Adora's school.

Adora's *dream.*

She'd already started planning for both of us — our dorm setup, our class schedules, late-night study sessions. And honestly, it all

sounded… nice. Safe. Comfortable.

But then there was Horde.

Loud, chaotic, creative Horde. A place where music wasn’t just a hobby — it was everything.

“Catra?” Leena’s voice broke through my thoughts.

“Yeah, sorry,” I said quickly. “I’m here.”

“No worries! Would you like to confirm your spot, or should we mark you as declining?”

I got up and started pacing, running a hand through my hair. The room suddenly felt smaller, heavier.

In the mirror across from me, I caught my own reflection — hoodie half-zipped, dark circles under my eyes, expression uncertain. I looked like someone waiting for permission to make a choice she’d already made.

I took a deep breath.

“I…"

Chapter End Notes

Cliff hanger? Yes.

Hope you enjoyed this chapter and sorry for it being so short... The next one will be MUCH longer, considering it's... The final one.
I've had fun writing this, considering it's my first fanfic I've written. I'm glad a lot of you have enjoyed it :)

Final chapter tomorrow....

Chapter 26: Chapter 26

Chapter Summary

Final chapter.

Graduation and making up to each other.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora's POV

After the fight, Catra and I didn't speak to each other for a few days. Only been avoiding each other, which fucking sucks. I'm on my way to Glimmers right now to hopefully get some advice from her. Bow is most likely going to be there as well, knowing him, he's always at her dorm, so he should probably just live there at this point. I knew I was in the wrong after the fight... Of course, Catra should go to her dream university. Why should I stop her from doing that?

I knocked on the door. Not long afterwards, Glimmer opened it. She was surprised at first but quickly melted into a welcome smile. "Adora! Didn't know you were coming over today!"

"Yeah, sorry for not giving a heads up, I just need some advice right now after doing something stupid." I walked in and leaned against the kitchen counter.

"You okay, Adora?" Bow quickly joined in, *where the fuck did he even come from?*

I sighed, rubbing my face. "Catra and I got into a fight, and it could've been completely avoided if I were less of a coward and

more supportive."

Glimmer raised an eyebrow, "Explain."

"I found out a few days ago that Catra got into another university, 'University of Horde.' And I didn't handle it very well because I was a complete coward and was afraid of being away from her again, ever since she came back into my life... Everything has been amazing. She's the best thing that could've ever happened to me, and I completely fucked it after getting mad at her for changing her mind about coming to Brightmoon with me." I let out a breath I didn't know I was holding.

"Shit, that's a lot," Bow mumbled.

"Yeah, I don't know what to do. Ever since then, we have been avoiding each other for a few days. I don't even know if she was accepted to attend her dream college since we haven't talked! I obviously wouldn't be mad if she did because I want her to be happy." I groaned.

"Well, graduation is tomorrow, you know? I think it would be best to sort out your shit before then. Talk to her, Adora. All she needs is support from you." Glimmer sighed.

"I know... But she's headed off to Perfuma's tonight, so it's kind of difficult." I groaned, putting my head in my hands.

"Call her then! Tell her that you want to talk to her." Bow jumped in, "Just because she's not at the dorm doesn't mean you can't talk to her."

"Fine, fine. I should go before it gets too late. See you guys tomorrow." I smiled softly and hugged them both.

...

I arrived back at the dorm, I heated some leftover food and plopped down onto the couch and watched cheesy rom-coms. After a few hours, I stared at my phone. I was contemplating on if I should call Catra or not... What if she doesn't even answer? What would be the point in that?

I don't know how it happened, but the phone appeared in my hand and magically started calling Catra; no turning back now.

"Hello?" Her voice spoke through the phone.

I all of a sudden felt nervousness rushing through me, "Hey! How... How are you?" I said awkwardly.

"Um, good. Just chilling with Scorpia and Perfuma." She replied, a hint of nervousness in her voice also.

"Is it okay if... We talk? Maybe you can come back here?" I asked.

There was a short pause before, "Okay, I'm on my way back now."

I let out a breath I didn't know I was holding, "Cool, cool, cool, cool."

I heard a small chuckle, "Did you just quote Brooklyn Nine-Nine?"

"Maybe?" I giggled a bit.

"See you soon, dork."

Moments later, the door opened. Catra walked through and chucked the keys into the bowl on the counter. "So, what's up?" She crossed her arms and leaned against the counter.

"I should start by saying sorry." I sighed.

Catra looked puzzled, but didn't say anything.

"Getting mad at you for wanting to go to your dream college was stupid. I wasn't being supportive. The fact was... I was just scared, ever since you came back into my life... I've never felt happier. I guess I was scared of losing you again. Of course I want you to go to the college YOU want to go to, I shouldn't stop you from doing that and honestly? I would be so proud of you."

Catra was tearing up. It was a rare sight to see. "I... I'm sorry for avoiding you. This whole fight was so stupid. You mean the whole world to me, Adora. It was the worst few days of my life. Talking to you is what makes my day better."

I walked over to her and pulled her into a hug, "I love you, Catra. I love you so much."

"I love you, too. I should probably tell you something as well." She sighed and pulled away.

"What?" I looked at her, worried.

"So, I got a call from the University of Horde... Asking to confirm if I was attending." She sighed.

"Yeah? What did you say?" I smiled.

"I said yes." She smiled.

I hugged her again. "Good, I would've punched you if you didn't." I chuckled.

She chuckled into my shoulder, "I'm glad I did."

"I'm proud of you, Cat." I kissed her forehead.

On the day of graduation, I am so fucking nervous.

I stare at myself in the mirror with my robe and hat on, soaking it all in. Today I officially graduated from high school, and it's a lot to take in. I heard a knock on my door, and not long after, Catra walked in.

"Wow, princess. You're looking good for someone who is about to graduate." She wrapped her arms around me from behind and kissed my neck.

I chuckled, "I can say the same for you."

"Nervous?" She looked at me in the mirror.

"A little, yeah. New life after this." I smiled at her.

She kissed my cheek and started to head out, "10 minutes until we go... You are almost ready, princess?"

"Yeah, just about. Just gotta do my makeup." I giggled before heading to the bathroom.

I saw Catra roll her eyes, "You look hot without makeup."

"Really? Cause every time I have eyeliner on, I can see you drooling." I smirked.

Catra opened her mouth but shut it soon after, "Whatever."

Once I finished my makeup, I walked out to see Catra scrolling on her phone. Even in the most normal moments, she looks so beautiful, the focus on her face is so cute and the way the light from the phone screen shows the freckles on her face. "You ready to go?"

"Yep. I'm excited to leave high school behind." Catra smirked, putting her phone away.

...

The sun was too bright for this early in the morning. I squinted over the field of folding chairs, graduation caps bobbing like flowers in the breeze, and tried not to trip over my gown.

“Ugh, how many identical black robes does it take to lose my mind?” Catra groaned beside me, tugging at the stiff fabric like it was personally insulting her.

“Hey, don’t tear it,” I said, nudging her shoulder. “We haven’t even graduated yet.”

“Exactly,” she said, baring her teeth in a grin. “Once they give me that diploma, I’m setting this thing on fire.”

Typical Catra. Half-serious, half-joking, and completely impossible to predict.

We wove through the crowd, the smell of freshly cut grass and sunscreen thick in the air. Parents and teachers called out congratulations, cameras flashed, and the loudspeaker squealed as someone tried to fix the mic.

“Do you see Glimmer and Bow anywhere?” I craned my neck. Glimmer had promised she’d save us seats near the front — something about “perfect photo lighting.”

Catra shaded her eyes with her hand. “Nope. Just a bunch of nerds in identical hats." She groaned.

I looked around the field and finally spotted Glimmer's bright hair, “There!” I said, grabbing Catra’s hand before I could think about it. We darted between rows of chairs, dodging tassels and robes, laughing when we almost collided with Principal Moon herself.

“Sorry, sorry!” I said, my face burning. Catra was still laughing when we reached our friends.

Glimmer squealed and pulled me into a hug, her pink hair bouncing. “You made it! I thought you two were gonna show up late again.”

Catra smirked. “Hey, we were early. Just… dramatically early. Like fashionably late, but backwards.”

Bow chuckled, adjusting his cap. “That’s not how that works.”

“Sure it is,” she said, leaning against my shoulder like she always did when she was pretending not to care about something.

The ceremony started then — the speeches, the awkward pauses, the applause that went on too long. I barely heard any of it. I just kept glancing sideways, watching the way sunlight caught in Catra’s hair, how her grin softened when she wasn’t trying to look tough.

I thought about all the years that led here: the fights, the late-night study sessions, the stupid cafeteria food fights. The way she’d stayed by me even when things got messy.

"Adora Grayskull!" My name got called out, and I suddenly felt like I was going to die.

I slowly walked across the stage, taking slow, deep breaths. Suddenly, I heard a loud voice coming from the crowd.

"Go, Adora! That's my girl!" Catra shouted.

I started blushing furiously, giving an awkward smile to Principal Moon, who just had an amused look on her face. She shook my hand and whispered, "I am so proud of you, Adora."

I almost started bawling my eyes out right then and there, but I smiled. "Thank you."

She gave me my certificate and faced the camera to get our photo taken.

As I sat back down, Catra was already up on the stage. I decided to get my revenge. "Woohoo! Go, Kitkat!"

Catra quickly shot me a glare. I know she hates me calling her that in public, but I didn't care. I was so proud of her in that moment, seeing her getting her photo taken and walking off the stage.

Later, we all stood up, ready to throw our caps into the air. Catra was doing her squeaky laugh as she threw hers into the air. I just admired her as all the caps fell around us; it honestly felt like the entire thing was in slow motion.

“Adora, quit spacing out,” Catra said, elbowing me lightly in the ribs. Her black gown was unzipped halfway, showing the red tank top underneath. Typical. She looked way too good for someone who’d just spent an hour sitting in the sun. “They’re gonna run out of cupcakes if we don’t move.”

I grinned. “You’re really thinking about cupcakes right now?”

“Graduation is exhausting,” she said, stretching like a cat, “I need sugar to recover.”

We wove through the crowd, parents taking pictures, teachers wiping their eyes, students hugging like they were never going to see each other again. I spotted Glimmer first, pink hair glittering in the sunlight like she’d hidden actual stars in it. She waved us over, Bow beside her, holding two plates of food like he was running a catering business.

“There you are!” Glimmer shouted, throwing her arms around me. “I was starting to think you got lost.”

“I was dragged away for photos,” I said, shooting Catra a mock glare.

“Dragged,” Catra repeated with a smirk. “You begged me to take them because you said, and I quote, ‘We’ll want to remember this forever.’”

Bow laughed. “That sounds like you, Adora.”

Perfuma drifted over next, handing out daisies she’d somehow conjured from thin air. “Congratulations, radiant beings!” she said, looping a flower around my wrist. “You both look so full of new beginnings.”

“Mostly full of sweat,” Catra muttered.

Perfuma ignored her. “You *glow*, darling. It’s the light of transition.”

“Or the sunburn,” Mermista said dryly, appearing with Sea Hawk in tow. He was crying. Loudly.

“My brave crew!” he sobbed, clutching Mermista dramatically. “Setting sail into the great unknown of adulthood!”

“Please stop,” Mermista groaned.

I laughed so hard my eyes stung. We’d been through so much together, dances, group projects...

Then I heard a familiar voice calling my name.

“Adora!”

I turned just in time to see Mara and Hope weaving through the crowd. My mum was waving like she was still trying to flag me down from the bleachers, and my other mum was holding her phone up, taking photos with her free hand.

“There’s my graduate!” Mara said, pulling me into a hug that nearly knocked my cap out of my hand. “We are *so* proud of you.”

Hope smiled more softly, touching my cheek. “You did it, kiddo.”

“Thanks, Mom. Both of you.” I glanced back at Catra, who had politely... and somewhat awkwardly stepped aside. “You remember Catra, right?”

“Of course,” Mara said, grinning. “Our honorary second daughter.”

Catra chuckled, rubbing the back of her neck. “Uh, hey.”

“Congratulations,” Hope said warmly. “You’re basically family at this point. You’ve been at our dinner table.”

Catra’s smirk softened. “Thanks. For… all of it.”

I reached for her hand without thinking, and she squeezed it back — gentle, grounding.

Around us, our friends were laughing, taking selfies, talking about the future like it was some kind of open sky waiting just beyond the parking lot.

And for once, I didn’t feel scared of it.

The stage, the speeches, the awkward hugs — it all melted into this single, perfect moment: the sun dipping low, Catra’s hand warm in mine, and my moms smiling like they already knew we’d be okay.

Whatever came next, college, jobs, messy adult life, we’d face it the same way we always had. Together.

Catra looked over at me, eyes glinting gold in the light. “Hey, Adora,” she said quietly.

“Yeah?”

"I love you, dork."

"I love you too." I wrapped my arms around her and kissed her lips.

The room looked smaller with everything packed up. Funny how four years could fit into a few cardboard boxes and an old duffel

bag. Catra's posters in her room were the last to come down: a band lineup, a few movie prints, one badly photoshopped picture of a cat playing guitar that she swore was "ironic." The walls looked too plain without them.

I folded another hoodie into my bag and tried not to think about how quiet it was. No music, no laughter, no Catra humming under her breath while scrolling through her phone. Just the sound of tape pulling and a fan rattling in the corner.

"So," she said as she walked into my room, her voice light but her eyes not quite meeting mine, "you excited to be Brightmoon's next star athlete's future doctor?"

I snorted. "Sports medicine, not an actual doctor. And yeah, I guess. It's weird, though. I'm gonna miss this place."

"This place?" Catra smirked. "You mean the shoebox with the leaky window and a closet that tries to kill you every time you open it?"

"Exactly that one."

She laughed, low and warm, but it faded quickly. "Guess I'll miss it too." Her tone did something to my chest. That tiny crack in the middle of her voice, the one that said what she wouldn't.

I tried to sound casual. "You're gonna love Horde. You'll have an actual recording studio instead of that old laptop mic you used here."

"Hey, that mic has character." She chuckled slightly.

"Yeah, like static and feedback."

She smirked, tossing a rolled-up T-shirt at me. It hit me square in the chest. "Don't make fun of my art."

"I'm not! I'm just saying—"

"Adora..." She sighed.

I looked up, and there she was — standing in the last golden light coming through the window, her graduation bracelet still tied around her wrist. Her eyes were warm, but nervous. That didn't happen often with her.

"I know we're gonna be… y'know. In different places. Doing our own things." She shifted her weight, scuffing her shoe against the carpet. "But I don't want this to be one of those 'drift apart and text once a year' kind of things."

I chuckled and pulled her into a hug, "Trust me, I will be spamming you every day. You won't have to worry about that, Kitkat."

"Ugh, I still can't believe you shouted that stupid nickname when I was on stage." She shoved me playfully.

"You secretly loved it, admit it," I smirked.

"Whatever."

Silence lingered between us, not uncomfortable, just full. Like a hundred unspoken things were floating in the air.

"I'm going to miss you so much." I let out a sad chuckle.

She smiled sadly, "Me too, but at least it's not across the country? Just a few dumb hours. We'll be okay."

"I know, it's just gonna suck not waking up next to you."

"Promise me one thing," she spoke up.

"Anything."

"Don't forget to call."

I smiled through the ache. "You couldn't get rid of me if you tried."

We both laughed for a bit.

Catra gave me a smirk, "You know... Since we don't have to officially leave until tomorrow..."

I looked at her, confused, "Hm?"

"We could make the most of it on our last night together?" She giggled.

I rolled my eyes, "You'll try anything to get into my pants."

"Exactly." She pulled her into a passionate kiss.

I quickly picked her up and carried her over to my bed, giggling between kisses.

It was just us, and I would want to stay in this moment forever. I'm going to miss her so much.

Chapter End Notes

It is officially done! I had a lot of fun writing this story,, and I'm glad many of you enjoyed it too. Obviously this was my first time writing it so I'm not the best at it.

Who knows... Maybe this story might continue in the future?

Thank you for reading this story! :)

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